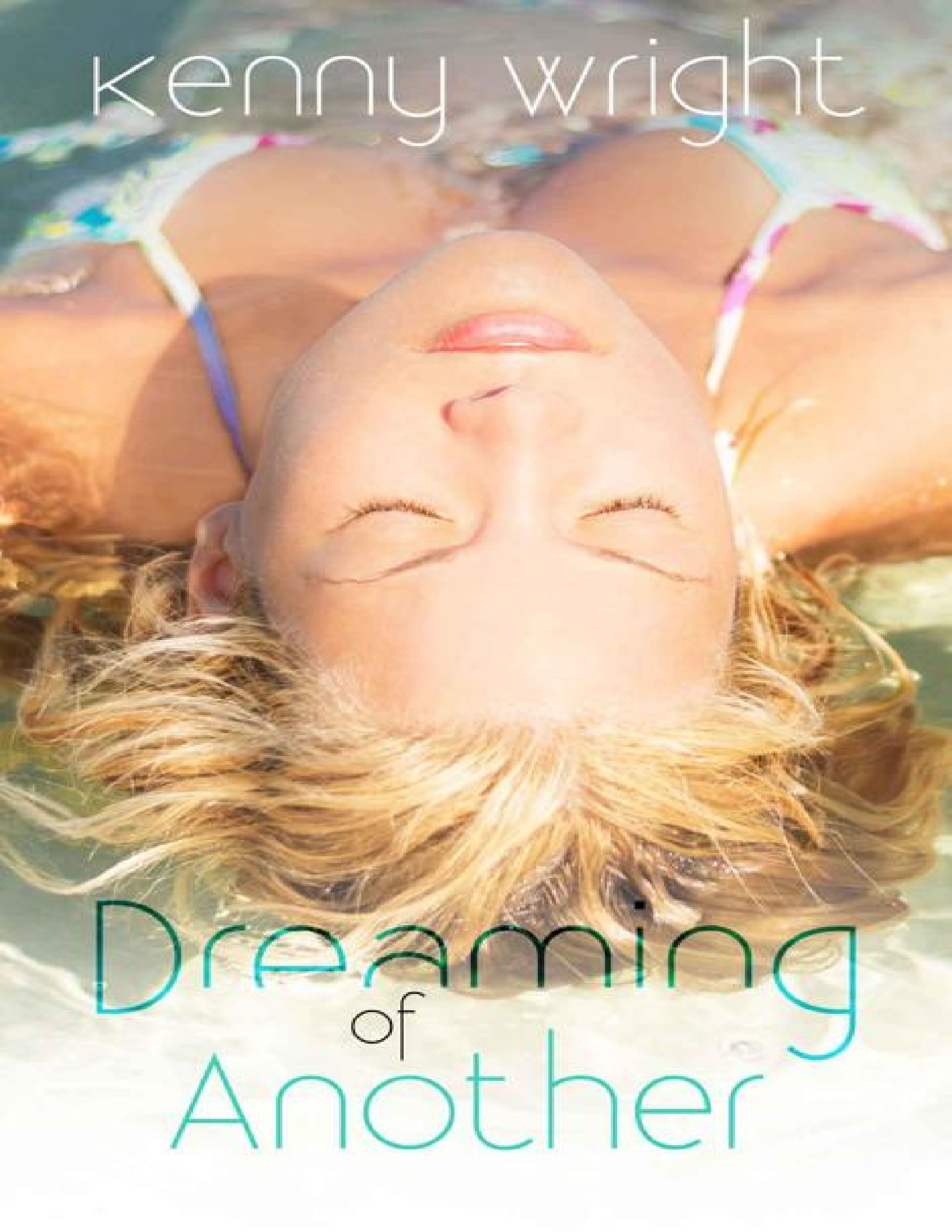




kenny wright

Dreaming
of
Another

Dreaming of Another

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Dreaming of Another

kenny wright

Chapter 1:

The Dream

She rose out of the pool like it was a swimsuit shoot, pushing her long, blond hair against her head as water streamed down her creamy body. The turquoise string bikini could barely contain her lush breasts, and as she pulled herself from the pool, all I wanted to do was pull the loopy bows at her hips.

I didn't need to. She did it for me—first the bow at the small of her back, releasing her tits. She had caramel-hued nipples that sat high on her ripe swells, buoyed as only a 20-year-old's could be. I wanted to sink my face between them.

With her bikini top hanging like a necklace in her cleavage, she looked at me with her radiant, blue eyes.

I ached for her.

She approached, her hips swaying, leaving wet footprints on the hot concrete. "Hey," she said.

"Hey—"

I couldn't get out another word before she pulled me in for a searing kiss. I loved these kisses. They always lingered, long after she was gone.

Brigitte pulled back, swiping her finger along my chin. "Watch this, Stevie."

Her smile was full of mischief. I tried to say something, but couldn't. I knew what came next. My chest tightened in anticipation.

She sauntered past me. I tracked her, taking in the way her bikini bottoms clung to her juicy ass. I could practically feel it in my hands.

My thoughts were cut short as she walked right up to a guy, fit and trim. He wore a pair of swimming trunks and a shit-eating grin. Brigitte put her arms around him, looked over her shoulder at me, and winked.

"Brigitte!" I cried.

But it was too late. My girlfriend leaned into this other man as he folded her into his thick arms. Their lips met. Panic clawed inside of me.

They melted into one another, tongues swirling, hands roaming. He had his hands down the back of Brigitte's bikini bottom. I reached down,

and found myself...hard?

RAH RAH RAH! screamed the alarm.

My wife's warm body passed over me as she reached for the alarm herself, easily shutting it down. Chrissy smelled familiar, the scent of home and happiness.

"You were dreaming of her again," Chrissy said. She didn't look upset, although she never did. She was just making an observation, like she was announcing that it was going to rain today.

Even still, my first instinct was to deny. "Was not." Then quickly: "Dreaming about who?" Smooth.

Her tone was the one she usually reserved for arguing with our children. "You said her name. *Brigitte*."

I winced at my ex's name. The dream was fading fast, but I could still feel the panic as I watched her kiss another man.

Chrissy interpreted the wince as guilt. She reached under the sheets and found me hard. "And this is only morning wood?"

While I was still waking up from sleep, Chrissy was already bright eyed. She'd always been like that, more the morning person than me. Right at that moment, those intelligent brown eyes were saying, *Busted*.

She was right, it wasn't just morning wood. I'd had this dream about a half dozen times, and as fucked up as it was, I woke up turned on, every single time. Still, I wasn't ready to have that conversation.

"Okay, so maybe I *was* dreaming about her. I'm sorry, I can't help it. I'm not doing it on purpose!"

"So you swear you're not having a secret affair with Brigitte?" Chrissy asked it with a smile. We'd had this conversation already—first seriously, then playfully.

"Like I said, I haven't seen her in over fifteen years. As far as I know, she could have had five kids and weigh 300 pounds."

That wasn't exactly true. I'd looked her up on Facebook a few times, and she was just as gorgeous as ever. The act of cyber voyeurism also made me feel guilty, even though I knew that it was a perfectly normal thing to do. I didn't friend her or anything, and I didn't do it often.

Chrissy rolled off of me, slipped on her glasses, and grabbed her phone. I watched her work with purpose, temporarily distracted by how attractive she was. This kind of reflection usually followed my dreams of Brigitte. Chrissy and I had been together for close to fifteen years—married

twelve of them. She was part of my every day, and like the stuff of every day, it was easy to take her for granted. But whenever I dreamt of my college girlfriend, I always woke up with a fresh set of eyes on the world.

And Chrissy was always the most startling. I swear, she was more attractive now, at 37, than she'd been when I first met her. Over the years, she'd gone from cute to beautiful. Her cheeks were more defined. Her petite body more womanly. Even her strawberry blond hair seemed richer.

She tapped something on the screen, then smiled brightly.

"What are you doing?" I asked.

"Looking Brigitte up on Facebook, of course. Her last name's *Falk*?"

"Yeah." Actually, last time I'd checked, she'd gotten married and changed her name to Chastain, but I didn't want to admit that I'd looked her up.

A moment later, Chrissy found her. "Well, now it's *Chastain*. Looks like she's married herself a Frenchman. Jealous?"

"Of course not."

"And it looks like she's definitely not 300 pounds." Chrissy's brow furrowed as she flipped through what looked like pictures. "Wow, she's gorgeous. This is the woman you've been having dirty dreams about?"

I grabbed my glasses. "Let me see."

Chrissy turned the phone on a photo of Brigitte in a bikini. Unlike my dream Brigitte, the suit was white and the woman wearing it older than the girl of twenty I remembered, but she looked great.

"Yeah, that's her," I said.

"Now I see why you keep dreaming about her. How can I compete with this?" Chrissy took the phone back and flipped through the album.

"There's no competition, Chris," I said, nuzzling her neck. She was still warm from the night's sleep, her skin soft beneath my lips.

"Oh, my," Chrissy said. I felt her breath catch where I kissed her neck.

"What?"

"Maybe I should start dreaming of Mr. Brigitte Chastain. Yummy."

She offered me a glimpse. It was a wedding photo. Brigitte wore a short, strapless white gown and a veil, a smile lighting up her face. She hung off a black guy in a tux—her husband. His smile as wide as hers, his teeth glossy white against his rich, mocha skin. He and Brigitte made an attractive couple, her blond hair and pale skin a nice contrast to his darker tones.

I glanced at Chrissy, who seemed to be living out a fleeting fantasy. Those confused emotions of my dream returned, only it wasn't my ex-girlfriend in the arms of another man.

"Now I'm the one who's jealous," I said, forcing it to sound playful.

"Then I definitely plan on dreaming of..." She read his name. "...Marc here."

She stared at her phone a heartbeat longer than I was comfortable with, then set it down. "Or are you going to give me something else to dream about?"

We hadn't had morning sex in forever. Seemed like there was always a reason to get up and start the day—work, kids, whatever. But the kids were still asleep, and I could skip my morning shower.

I pulled Chrissy to me. "Mmm, I think I'd like to try," I said.

We kissed, our glasses clicking together before we could get beyond anything but a light peck. Chrissy laughed, pulling back to remove hers as I took off mine.

"Nerd kiss," she giggled.

Sans glasses, when we kissed again, it was anything but a nerd kiss. It was deep and wet, the kind of kiss we used to share all the time when our bodies were new to each other. She climbed into my lap, rolling her hips across my erection as we kissed. My hands automatically went to the bottom of her t-shirt, tugging it upward. Chrissy took the hint, sitting up enough to pull it off.

Topless, I stole a quick glance at her bare breasts. Small and perky, they still sat high on her chest and had even plumped up after the two kids. Chrissy had always been self-conscious of their size, but I loved them.

Chrissy slipped off of me long enough to work her way out of her panties. I took the moment to pull my shirt off, then kick away my pajama bottoms. For one hurried moment, we were back in parent-mode, trying to be as efficient as we could in the small window of time that we had.

Then Chrissy was back on top of me. She wrapped her hand around my cock and placed it against her trimmed muff. She was wet and as ready for me as I was for her.

"Ahh..." she sighed as she sank back onto me. We were out of practice enough that it took a few short strokes before I was fully inside of her. After that, though, we quickly found our rhythm.

“Why don’t we do this all the time?” Chrissy’s voice was a strained whisper in my ear.

“Because we’re dumb?” I didn’t know, but as Chrissy moved up and down my length, as her breasts dragged along my chest, I vowed not to make that mistake again.

“I bet Brigitte and Marc don’t go a month without sex,” she said.

“You thinking about Marc, huh?” I couldn’t help feeling that twinge of...something. Jealousy for sure, but also something more uncomfortable.

Chrissy spoke over my thoughts. “Only because you’re thinking about Brigitte.”

At my ex’s name, I thought of the photo of her in the white bikini. I focused on that because it was easier than the other. Her curves had only accentuated over the years. Between her narrow waist, wide hips, and full breasts, she was more of a wet dream than a real person.

I thought of the time we were together, the summer we’d shared. Brigitte loved to fuck more than anyone I’d been with, before or since. She gave everything when we were together and demanded that I do the same. I remember one afternoon, just before sophomore year began. We had access to her parents’ summer home for a week—without her parents—and I don’t think I had as much sex in between all my previous lovers combined, including a very active freshman year. She’d ride me to several orgasms until I came, suck me back to life as she told me how amazing my cock felt in her mouth and how she couldn’t wait to take it in her ass, and then we’d go again. Her pussy, her mouth, her tits, her ass, nothing was off limits. It wasn’t just that. She didn’t just grant access, she welcomed it.

And her enthusiasm wasn’t limited to just my cock. I squirmed at the thought, my cock hardening despite the tumultuous memories that stirred.

Chrissy felt it, but misinterpreted the reaction. She stared down at me with an expression I couldn’t read—something between amusement and disbelief. “You really are thinking about her, aren’t you!?”

“No.” It wasn’t a lie.

Chrissy rolled her eyes. “I bet Marc can really manhandle Brigitte. You didn’t see the photo of him shirtless. Mmm...”

She was just teasing me, but nevertheless, it felt like a fist had tightened around my gut. It made me queasy, but then there was that timid excitement that I would never understand.

“I’m going to have to study that picture if I want to start dreaming about him,” she said.

I thought of Brigitte again—me fucking her from behind as she screamed my name. Only suddenly, it wasn’t Brigitte going crazy on my cock, it was Chrissy. And it wasn’t my cock at all, but Marc’s.

I ran my hands over her body, cupping her ass—urging her to ride me faster. Panic seized me. I was about to come. I tried to fight it back, but I knew I couldn’t.

“Chris,” I groaned, lifting my hips to meet hers. Her pussy slid wet and snug around my cock. I closed my eyes, trying to block out the sensation. I saw Marc there, his ebony skin glistening, sleek and powerful, driving forcefully inside my wife.

“Oh, Chris!” A heartbeat later, everything went weightless. Everything stood still. And then I was exploding inside her.

Chrissy moaned quietly above me. She bent low, pressing her body against mine as she rode out my orgasm. “Yes, baby,” she sighed. “Oh, yes...”

In the soft moments after orgasm, we kissed again, slow and languid. I hugged her to me, stroking my thumb along the small of her back.

“Well, that was fun,” Chrissy said. “Let’s do that more often.”

Chapter 2:

BJs

We didn't talk about Brigitte—or Marc—much immediately after that. Regular life once again imposed itself. We remembered that we had full lives and rigid routines. Chrissy and I both worked, although my IT job allowed me to work from home—which meant I also became the *de facto* primary caregiver. I dropped the kids off at daycare in the mornings and picked them up in the afternoons. I made sure dinner was on the table when Chrissy finished up at the advertising firm where she worked. And by the end of the day, I was always exhausted.

That wasn't to say that I didn't think about Brigitte—especially after our last session. I found myself on Facebook again, looking through her photos.

That one photo I'd seen of Brigitte in the bikini wasn't an anomaly. My ex-girlfriend looked like a swimsuit model. It was insane. Even when we were dating, I'd felt like she was out of my league. If I were to meet her for the first time now, I'm pretty sure I wouldn't be able to hold a conversation with her. It would be like trying to carry on with Scarlett Johansson.

Not that I regretted where my life had taken me, I was careful to remind myself. I loved my life. I loved my kids. And I loved Chrissy deeper than I ever thought possible. Even the prospect of living a life without her easy laugh and quick wit hurt.

Still, a fantasy was a fantasy, right? And Brigitte was a bona fide fantasy.

I'd looked at her photos in the past, but never studied Brigitte's profile. Now I was curious: where was she living, what had she done with her life? Based on the limited bio I got from Facebook, along with her recent posts, she appeared to be a clothing buyer for Neiman Marcus. She lived in New York, was married to Marc Chastain, and apparently took a lot of photos of herself out at bars with various girlfriends. In short, she lived a very different lifestyle than me and Chrissy.

Not that any of it was surprising. Brigitte was cut from a different cloth than me and my wife. The four months or so that we'd dated had been the most whirlwind experience of my life. Brigitte was the first girl I dated who actually enjoyed giving blowjobs. I received more wake-up hummers in those few months than I had in twelve years of marriage. And she didn't just enjoy giving them, she got off on giving them.

I remember one conversation we had after a morning session. She'd come up after sucking me off in the morning, smiled, and said, "I love cocks."

I remember laughing because I had no idea how else to respond (she was also the first girl I was with who regularly used the word "cock").

"What do you like about them?" I eventually asked.

"I like holding them. I like watching them plump up when I stroke them. I love feeling them grow stiff in my mouth." By the time she was done with her explanation, I was already beginning to stiffen again myself. A moment later, she demonstrated her love of cocks by dropping back between my legs.

As I browsed her Facebook page, I ended up looking at the "Add Friend" for the longest time. Brigitte and I had been close once, certainly—closer than many of the "friends" I had on Facebook—but there was something guilty about friending an ex-girlfriend. Like how would I feel if Chrissy was friends with Lucas Hughes, one of her college boyfriends?

I ended up closing the browser every time. That was a stone not worth turning over. Two weeks after the last dream, though, Chrissy brought her up again.

"So what was she like when you dated?"

The kids were in bed and we were in the kitchen, washing dishes together.

"Brigitte, I mean," she added when I didn't immediately answer.

"Um... you know. Most of the time we went out, we were working at Camp Idylwood, so it's not like we went on dates or anything."

"So you mostly just had sex with each other," Chrissy said with a cheeky smile.

"Um..." This felt like a trap.

"Oh, come on, Stephen, I went to college too. I'm not going to judge something that happened in your young and reckless days."

"Fine, we had a lot of sex."

“Bastard!” She leaned back on the counter and folded her arms in *faux* anger. Her smile gave her away. “So was she better than me?”

“I *knew* this was a trap.”

“Fine, not a fair question. But she was good?”

I turned and collected her in my arms. “For the record, you’re the best I’ve had, period. I’m totally serious. I’ve never connected with anyone as deeply as with you.”

“But she was good?”

I blushed, looking away. “I mean, yeah. Especially at that point in my life, she was, um, fun.”

“What’s fun mean?” She put her finger on my chin and directed me to look at her.

“Just fun. You know, she was always up for it. That sort of thing.” *To say the least.*

“Oh come on. You can do better than that.”

Chrissy leaned against the counter, not even pretending to wash the dishes. I finally stopped rinsing plates and pans and turned to her. “Are we really having this conversation now?”

“What conversation?”

“Our pasts. We’ve never really talked about them. And it’s been, like over fifteen years.”

Chrissy started laughing. “Are you trying to pull some sort of statute of limitations on your sex life? Now I really want to know. What’re you hiding, Stephen?”

“I just don’t want you to get jealous is all.”

“Have I ever gotten jealous?” she asked. She wasn’t a jealous person, true, but everyone had their limits.

Chrissy sidled up to me, touching my chest. Her gaze lingered on my chest before she lifted it to meet mine, staring up at me through her lashes. She was beautiful. “I mean, you’re having regular sex dreams with this woman and I’ve handled that pretty well. So come on, tell me what was fun about her.”

Chrissy wasn’t going to relent, so I decided to offer the least incriminating detail that immediately came to mind.

“Well, she...” I was having trouble looking my wife in the eye. “I’m pretty sure that she actually loved giving blowjobs.”

“Every college boy’s dream come true.” Chrissy tugged at my lapels.

“Every *man’s* dream come true.” This started getting easier.

“Is this your subtle way of telling me you want more BJs?”

“Hey, you’re the one who asked—” I started to say defensively when I felt her hand on the front of my pants.

“I may not *love* giving them, but I love the effect they have on you.”

I just stared at her. Chrissy giggled. She took me by the hand and led me into the den. At the sofa, she pulled me into a nice, deep kiss. She collected her petite body against me, my cock rising at the promise of what came next.

“Why don’t you get comfortable,” she said with the filthiest of smiles. She guided me onto the sofa and lowered herself between my legs.

I started to say something like, *You don’t need to do this*. It was a knee-jerk reaction I got whenever I felt like I was putting Chrissy out. But this time I held my tongue. It felt selfish. Maybe it was my own memories of Brigitte, I don’t know, but I so needed this blowjob.

Chrissy pulled down my zipper, using her free hand to rub me. “This how she did it?”

Chrissy looked up at me with her stunning brown eyes. I just nodded, more as a *please continue* than any reflection on how Brigitte used to go down on me. My wife held my cock to the side, tilted her head, and drew her tongue up the shaft. It felt wet and soft and wonderful. I groaned. She did it again. I groaned louder.

“Did she like teasing you?” Chrissy asked.

I nodded.

Chrissy flicked her tongue across the tip of my cock, hitting that sweet spot just under the crown. I gasped. Chrissy swirled her tongue around the head, her eyes on her work like a challenge to tackle.

“That feels good, honey.”

Chrissy didn’t wait any longer. She wrapped her soft lips around my shaft and swallowed me into her warm mouth. Watching Chrissy suck down on my cock was a beautiful thing. It brought out her cheeks, her eyes, her crisp beauty. She looked up at me.

“That’s good,” I said. “I love it when you look at me while you do that.”

Chrissy slurped off of me. “You like eye contact?”

“It’s sexy.”

“Did she do that?”

“She did.” And now that I was thinking about it, that was one of the defining things about Brigitte. For Brigitte, a blowjob wasn’t just physical, it was a whole experience. She got inside my head. She made me feel like nothing else mattered.

Chrissy bobbed up and down on my cock, looking at me the whole time. The connection was palpable, akin to having sex. She wasn’t just sucking me. She was measuring my reactions. She was adjusting to them. And she was watching how much I got off on it.

She pulled back again. “Okay, that’s pretty hot,” she said.

The admission sizzled.

“What else did she do that you liked?”

“I don’t know.” But I did, and all Chrissy had to do was raise an eyebrow to get it out of me. “She sometimes went without hands.”

Chrissy processed the request, like working out the best way to drive to the grocery store at rush hour, then pulled her hair back, out of her face. “Like this?”

Without holding me, she captured my cock in her mouth, tonguing the tip. At first, it was a little awkward and stilted. She dipped too deep and gagged. Determined, she tried again. It was better, but her bobs still came jerky.

Pulling back, she stared down at my spit-slick member. She put her hands on the floor beneath her, took a deep breath, and tried again. This time, it only took a few sucks before she found her stride. The eye contact was gone, but the vision of her bobbing on my cock was amazing. Her lips stretched around my shaft, her cheeks caved in with powerful suction, and she compensated for the lack of hands with her tongue.

I couldn’t help it. I reached down and ran my fingers through her soft, strawberry blond hair. She looked up at me, her gaze cutting up through her lashes.

It wasn’t a Brigitte blowjob. It was better because of the woman giving it. I opened my mouth to tell her that I loved her—or maybe that what she was doing felt so good—when I noticed that one of her hands wasn’t just resting on the floor. It was rubbing the front of her jeans. If I listened, I could hear the *swish-swish* of the friction.

Glancing back into her large eyes, heavy-lidded with her own lust, I lost it. I grunted—all the warning I could afford—then exploded.

Chrissy went into Chrissy mode. Her hands flew back to my shaft, taking control back as she received my pulsing come. She swallowed—she always had—which was awesome, but I couldn't help thinking about the many times that Brigitte had pulled out and taken it on the face. Brigitte was just a slut like that.

"Sorry about my hands there at the end," Chrissy said once she'd finished swallowing. "Based on how you tell it, it sounds like Brigitte had a lot more practice than me, even at twenty."

It was a dig, I knew, but it tweaked something inside of me. I tried to ignore it, and hoped that Chrissy didn't notice my reaction. Instead, I focused on her first statement.

"Don't apologize for anything that you just did. That was awesome."

Chrissy beamed, pulling herself off the floor. We snuggled. "So what else did she do that was awesome?"

Why did I suddenly think of the tail end of my dream—a topless Brigitte in another man's arms? I banished it and answered with a joke. "She didn't ask me what my ex-girlfriends did."

Chrissy laughed.

"Fine, fine."

"Why the sudden curiosity?"

"I'm just trying to understand who this woman is who you keep dreaming of."

"I haven't in a while." It was as defensive as it sounded. I didn't want to go down this road. No good could come of it.

"But you have." She tugged at my shirt, and I realized that I was still mostly clothed—and Chrissy hadn't taken a thing off. "So hands free is hot?"

"Yeah."

She nodded. "Feels wild, too. A little more out of control than I'm used to. But in a good way."

We undressed. She slid into my lap. I could feel how wet she was, her pubic hair sodden with it. She rubbed along my length and I sprang back to life.

"Any time you want to be wild—in a good way—just let me know," I said.

Chrissy laughed, kissing me softly. "How about right now?"

We made love on the couch in the living room. Not wild by Brigitte standards, but for a couple with over a decade of marriage between us, it was pretty wild.

Chapter 3:

Summer Love

A week later, Brigitte came up again, this time on our way out to visit Chrissy's parents. The kids were dozing in the back and Chrissy was checking Facebook when she looked up.

"How did you and Brigitte meet?" she asked out of the blue.

"Summer camp."

"Right, you told me that before, but how did you meet? Hook up, I mean."

"Developing a little obsession, are you? You didn't Facebook friend her, did you?" I asked.

"No," Chrissy said with a laugh. "Not sure how I'd explain the connection. Is there an option for *wife of former lover*?"

"You're thinking of LinkedIn."

Chrissy giggled. "And yeah, we don't care about her professionally. So come on. Summer camp. Summer love. Give me some details."

"Okay, so we actually dated in the summer after my freshman year, although we'd known each other for years. You never went to camp, so you wouldn't really know. But camp was like that. Same bunch of kids being shipped out summer after summer."

"I'm familiar with the concept," Chrissy said flatly. "So you were summer bosom buddies."

"Nah. Just like regular life, there were cliques. I wasn't in Brigitte's, so mostly we knew each other's names."

I still remember lusting after her from the first time I laid eyes on her. I wasn't alone, of course. She'd developed early.

"Then we both signed up to be counselors that summer. The counselor group was much smaller. Plus, we both went to NC State—something neither of us really knew until then—and our fate was sealed."

"Oh, come on. Don't hold out on me now, Stephen. If you want to leave it all up to chance and circumstance, fine, but at least tell me more about those circumstances."

“There wasn’t much to it. Very quickly, all the counselors began pairing off. Funny how that happens. I didn’t want to be stuck with Brenda Galliger, so I made a play for Brigitte.”

Chrissy laughed. “So self-preservation won you the babe.”

“I like to think my good looks had something to do with it.”

My wife placed a hand on my arm and squeezed. “Don’t worry, I saw photos from back then. You were pretty cute.”

“You know I can hear the past tense, right?”

“Oh, don’t be so sensitive. I meant that you were *cute* back then. You’re *handsome* now.”

Not to be vain, but I had to agree with her. I always felt awkward back in my teenage years—even my early twenties. College was good for me. That first year had given me enough confidence to start talking to Brigitte about music and movies.

“So you guys paired off,” Chrissy prompted. “You must have been the envy of all the guys.”

“I did get some stares, sure. Particularly from the guy stuck with Brenda Galliger.”

“Poor Brenda.”

“Anyway, it just sort of *happened*. There wasn’t really romance involved. It was camp, so we couldn’t even go on dates. We just hung out after the kids were asleep, drank, smoked pot, and hooked up.”

“You’re not a very good storyteller,” Chrissy said with a laugh. “Maybe I *should* friend Brigitte. Then I could ask her about it myself.”

I shook my head and sighed. I still didn’t understand her curiosity.

*

When I wasn’t dreaming about Brigitte, I was thinking about her. In particular, I thought of those first few weeks that summer, when I felt like I was making it all up as I went along. I didn’t date women who looked like Brigitte, yet there I was, walking along the edge of the lake, her hand in mine—or even better, camped out under the stars, naked and sweaty inside a shared sleeping bag.

I’d always been attracted to Brigitte, but in the way I was attracted to the models in a *Sports Illustrated: Swimsuit Edition*. They were hot in a superficial way. I liked the look, sure, but I never fantasized about having a

conversation with them. I never wondered what kind of movies they liked, or the kind of music they listened to. My fantasies mostly revolved around imagining her without clothes.

But when I walked into camp stables one morning and saw Brigitte shoveling hay out for the horses, for the first time since meeting her, I knew that I wanted to do more than just imagine her naked—not that I’d ever preclude that. She was wearing a frayed pair of Daisy Dukes and a fitted plaid work shirt, covered in sweat, her hair back in a long, functional ponytail. She’d looked hundreds of times sexier in her bikini and sunglasses, but the girl working hard was actually real. And that meant I could talk to her about real stuff.

“Need a hand?” I remembered asking.

“I’d love one. Grab a pitchfork there.”

I did. “I’m Stephen, by the way.”

“I know who you are,” she’d said. I still remember how tickled that made me feel. One of those swimsuit models had looked back at me through the pages and acknowledged my existence.

After that, we didn’t just tear our clothes off and fuck in the barn. This wasn’t a porn movie—despite a 20-year-old me *really* wishing that it was—so things stayed innocent...at first. We hung out more around the bonfires. We sat next to each other during training. When we ate lunch and dinner in groups, we made sure that we were in the same one.

And then, one humid, late afternoon, Brigitte asked me if I wanted to hike with her. We walked along the lake ridge, beyond the perimeter of the campgrounds, then up a steep rise. An hour later, we were standing on a grassy bluff with the rest of the valley spread out before us. It was the most beautiful thing I’d ever seen...until Brigitte stepped in front of me.

She pulled me into her arms. Said: “Hi.” I didn’t have a chance to let doubt and insecurity play that game of *should I or shouldn’t I?* Brigitte solved all of that by kissing me first.

And what a kiss. Deep. Wet. Volcanic. I’d never been so instantly turned-on in my life. She was just a couple inches shorter than me, so I barely had to dip down to meet her lips or experience the playful dance of her tongue. I kissed her without thinking about what came next. Enjoy the journey, someone once said, and what a journey it was.

When it ended, I was left feeling empty. I remember standing there, head still tilted, lips still puckered. Or maybe that’s just how I felt. Brigitte,

in that perceptive way of hers, knew how to snap me out of it. She stepped back and pulled her t-shirt over her head.

I'll never forget it. She wore a white cotton bra with a little, pink bow nestled between her mammoth tits, and there was nothing cutesie about it. Shimmying out of her shorts, I saw that her thong matched the bra. The whole thing proved that white cotton could be just as sexy as the laciest, raciest of lingerie.

"You're still dressed," Brigitte said. "Waiting for me to help?"

She sauntered up to me and I remember thinking, *Hips shouldn't be able to move like that.*

"Good thing I like you."

I had about a half second to respond and couldn't think of anything intelligent to say beyond, "I like you, too."

Then my shirt was over my head. I worked out—or had been working out while still living on campus—and my upper body hadn't softened much since the semester had ended. Brigitte liked what she saw, touching my pecs with her fingers. "I like a smooth chest," she said, glancing up at me.

"So do I." I winced as soon as the words left my lips.

Brigitte only laughed and said, "You're in luck." She unfastened her bra, letting her full breasts spill forth. "I don't have any chest hair, either."

As I stared at her beautifully round swells, Brigitte went to work on my shorts. "You can touch them if you'd like. They'd like that."

I reached out, cupping the soft tits. They were warm beneath my fingers, and her caramel nipples were hard. I'd touched breasts before—I wasn't a virgin at the time—but these were works of art. I couldn't help myself, palming them and lifting them high.

"That's nice," she sighed. "Most boys are over-eager. They seem to think that they like to be strangled."

She opened my shorts, pushing them off. We returned to kissing, now that all we had left was our underwear. Brigitte found me hard through my boxers. "Nice and big," she whispered. "You know how to use that?"

"I haven't had complaints," I managed to say with as much false bluster as possible given the situation.

"Let's find out."

She pulled me into the grass, kissing me as she arranged me on my back. When her hand slipped inside my shorts, I nearly came. I groaned, staring out at the lake. A canoe cut along the glassy surface, far enough

away that I couldn't tell who was in it. I tried to force myself to think about that canoe when all I really thought was, *Don't come, don't come*. I was pretty certain that a premature ejaculation would end this relationship before the summer had barely started.

So I decided to buy some time. I rolled Brigitte onto her back. She squealed, seemingly unprepared for me to take charge. I went with that. I kissed her, drawing confidence from my position over her. Moving to her neck, I used every trick I had in my book—as short as it was.

“Your skin's so soft,” I whispered in her ear. “Hope you don't mind if I take a tour.”

I walked my kisses down her neck and across her collarbone. My hands circled her breasts, once again marveling at how soft they were. My mouth arrived a moment later, and for the first time in my life, with Brigitte propped up on her elbows and her chest thrust forward, I could say that I worshipped a pair of breasts.

I took her earlier comment about over-eager boys to heart. I teased her with my tongue, swirling her long nipples to make them hard, then flicking them rapidly until she practically bucked against my mouth. “You do that well,” Brigitte sighed. “I think I'll keep you.”

The comment bolstered me. I kissed lower. Her navel was pierced, a silver bar capped with a green jewel peeking out of her cute belly button. I nipped at it, but my true destination was lower. I could smell her excitement, tangy and new beneath the crisp smell of the lake and the trees around us. My stomach fluttered. I pushed on, my hands practically shaking as I reached for the edges of her thong.

I pulled, mesmerized by the smooth sweep of her lower tummy. The smell of her excitement grew. I pulled lower. Her trimmed blond landing strip guided the way to her smooth, plump pussy lips. So beautiful. I stopped breathing. My mouth opened, ready to taste her when—

RAH RAH RAH!

“No. No, no, please,” I grumbled.

Chrissy was there, her sweet face filling my blurry vision. I could see her smile even without my glasses. “Brigitte again?”

“Just five more minutes?”

“I don't think dreams work like that,” Chrissy said. “But now I'm curious. What were you dreaming of?”

“Our first time.”

“Ooh, intriguing. Do tell.” Her hand slipped beneath the sheets and into my boxers. “Was it at camp? In front of a big bonfire?”

“Outside. Overlooking the lake.”

“Sexy. We haven’t had outdoor sex in a long time,” she said.

“Have we ever?”

Chrissy laughed. “*Never* is just a really long time.”

“We should make up for that. Check it off the marital bucket list.”

“Ooh, first time I’ve heard of this,” Chrissy said. Her hand continued to stroke me. “What else is on that list?”

“I hadn’t really thought about it until now.”

“You mean not in terms of a list. But I bet you’ve got some fantasies you haven’t told me about.”

This was dangerous territory. I’d been married long enough to know that. I decided to play it safe. “You’re all I need.”

“Uh huh. And yet here you are, dreaming about having sex outside with some blond goddess.”

“I can’t help what I dream!”

“I know. I know.” She kissed me lovingly. “You seemed pretty upset when you woke up. What were you dreaming about?”

“Why don’t I just show you?” I said.

Chrissy raised an eyebrow. I kissed her neck, just as I had Brigitte’s in my dream moments before. Rolling her on her back, I kissed down her throat. She was still warm from the night of sleep, and where dream-Brigitte smelled new and exciting, my wife smelled like home—familiar and welcoming.

I unbuttoned her pajama top like a present to be savored. I glanced up at her, smiled at the look of anticipation on her face, and opened the shirt. Chrissy’s skin was as pale as Brigitte’s, although my wife’s has a dusting of freckles that reaches the tops of her small, perky breasts. Her nipples were soft, surrounded by pale, almost non-existent aureole. I knew that when I sucked on those beautiful tips, they’d pucker up and ignite my wife like a switch being flipped.

But I didn’t do that immediately. I’d learned a trick or two in the years since that encounter beside the lake—and I knew exactly how to get Chrissy worked up in particular. I laid off her nipples at first—with my mouth, anyway. Instead, I gently worked them with my thumbs as I

continued to kiss and nuzzle her neck. I felt her pulse quicken. Heard her breath grow shallow.

“Did you tease her like this?” Chrissy asked breathily.

“Maybe.” I kissed down her clavicle. Her breath caught. “Or maybe I just went for it.”

Chrissy released a hushed moan as I captured her nipple in my mouth, swirling it with my tongue. “Mmm, hope you—ah—teased her a little.”

She laced her fingers through my hair as I worked her tits. I grazed my teeth along them, just enough to draw a sharp gasp before switching back to the softer prod of my tongue.

“That feels so good,” Chrissy whispered, squirming as I switched breasts. Her grip tightened in my hair. She was ready.

Kissing off the lower slope of her breasts, I crossed down her stomach and ducked under the sheets. I pulled her pajama bottoms over her rounded hips, baring the glistening sight of her pussy. This time, the alarm wouldn’t deny me.

Chrissy kept her light brown pubes trimmed, but had never done any more grooming. I didn’t really mind, although as I drew my tongue along her sex, I couldn’t help but think about Brigitte and her tidy sex. Brigitte had been the first girl I’d been with who did any kind of shaving, and I had to admit I preferred the look.

“Mmm, that’s nice,” Chrissy moaned above me. “So...so you had her on her back? Outside?”

I kissed across her mound, finding her clit swollen from the breast play. “Yeah. Water lapping against the shore and the smell of grass and everything.”

Lapping her clit gently, I pushed two fingers into her. She arched over me, moaning as she easily accepted my digits into her dripping wet pussy. She always got excited when I played with her nipples before sex, but this morning she seemed extra turned on. Was she imagining herself in Brigitte’s position?

“You know, Brigitte liked playing with her nipples when I did this.” I don’t know what possessed me to say it—call it a hunch—but the suggestion immediately stuck. Chrissy cupped her tits in her hands, her thumbs circling her nubs.

I’d never watched Chrissy masturbate, but I couldn’t help but think this must have been how she did it. My stomach fluttered at the thought. I

returned to eating her sweet pussy as her orgasm built.

“There...there,” she moaned as I found her g-spot with my fingers. She twisted up and away, fighting to delay her climax just another moment.

I pressed my fingertips against her g-spot—not hard, but enough. No more delaying. She grit her teeth, clutched the bedsheets, and closed her thighs around my head.

I loved making Chrissy come. For the most part, she was a reserved woman, comfortable in her sexuality, but quietly so. She came like that, passionate, concentrated, yet quiet.

I didn’t let up. I swept my tongue rapidly across her clit as I pressed on her g-spot. Her moans caught. She squeezed my head harder, her hands coming off her tits and back into my hair. At first, I thought she was pushing me into her pussy. Then I realized she was trying to pull me off.

“Enough, enough,” I heard her say once she released me from her thighs. She was laughing. “Now I remember why I fell in love with you. Do I have Brigitte to thank for that?”

“She may have taught me a thing or two.” I emerged from under the sheets, my face sweaty, my hair damp. “I got a lot of practice.”

Chrissy had the decency to blush a little for me. “Well, if I ever meet her, I’m going to have to give her a hug.”

“Ha. I’d like to see that.”

Chrissy rolled her eyes. “So is *that* something on your...marital bucket list?”

The marital bucket list. I winced. Shouldn’t have brought that up. There was danger in heading down that path. I had a lot of dirty things that I’d love to do with Chrissy but would never admit to—degrading things that she’d never agree to. Coming on her face, her tits, her ass. Hearing her talk dirty to me while we fucked. Shaving her bush. Taking her out for the night dressed in something slutty. Watching her fuck another man.

That last one knocked me off balance. I bundled it in with the others and buried them all. It sounded like I wanted to turn her into a whore, and even in the safety of my own head, I was ashamed.

So I went with the easy answer—the one she hand delivered. “Sure, I’d love to see you with another woman.”

As I said it, I wondered how many other men defaulted to this answer because they didn’t want to admit something naughtier. Was that why our culture thought it was the number one male fantasy?

Don't get me wrong, I'd love to see Chrissy get it on with another girl, it just wasn't at the top of my list.

Chrissy laughed. "Well, good thing you've got such vivid dreams."

"You know, you've got permission to explore that side of your sexuality if you ever wanted."

"Uh huh." She slid out of bed. "I'm taking a shower. You're on coffee duty."

"How's that fair? I just did all the work."

"Were you not just dreaming about having sex with another woman? I'll take *all your work* as a sufficient apology."

I flopped onto my back and Chrissy giggled and went into the bathroom.

Chapter 4:

Cosmo

The Brigitte chapter in my life wasn't all erotic memories and wild sex dreams. There were parts that still made me cringe when I even started to think of them. So I did my best not to think about them—not to think about our return to school, to think about how things ended.

The erotic stuff was more fun, anyway. Chrissy and I didn't talk about her constantly, but she—and her antics—did come up more frequently than ever. The side benefit was that Chrissy started employing some of the things I mentioned. Her blowjobs were now heavy on the eye contact, and she'd started talking about wanting to take a camping trip next summer—without the kids.

So when she brought up Brigitte, I started to see the benefits of confessing some of the raunchier details. Chrissy gave me the perfect opening about a month after the dream of my first time with Brigitte.

We were at *Medici's*, a semi-upscale wine bar and restaurant in our neighborhood. It was Date Night, something we tried to do every month—which meant in reality that we'd missed the last three. Chrissy rarely drank, but tonight she seemed to be making up for lost time. We were a bottle in when she leaned over and started it.

"So I was reading *Cosmo*—"

"*You* were reading *Cosmo*? As in *Cosmopolitan* the women's magazine?" I interrupted.

"Well, I was skimming the headlines on the cover as I checked out at the grocery store."

"That sounds about right."

"Doesn't matter. Anyway, one of the articles was something like 5 *Things About Your Man's Sex Life That You Didn't Know*."

Oh boy. I looked around. At least we were hidden away in a semi-private alcove.

"So I'd like to hear five things about your sex life that I didn't know."

I studied my wife. She looked good tonight. *Medici's* was casual chic, which meant jeans and a blouse were acceptable. Chrissy had an ass that

could fill out a pair of jeans, and while there wasn't anything inherently sexy about her loose blouse or the bright red scarf she wore, I liked the refined beauty she projected. It made me think how much she'd changed in the past fifteen years, when our fashion sense didn't go much beyond t-shirts and jeans.

"Having a hard time picking just five?" Chrissy asked.

"Hm?"

"Things in your sex life that I don't know about."

"Oh. Sorry, I was just admiring how beautiful you are."

Chrissy's smile was wide. "You're not so bad yourself. Makes me wonder about the pre-us period."

I reached across the table and took her hands, running my thumb across her diamond ring. We'd had this conversation before, although that had been a more tentative exploration of my past sex life. I wondered where all these questions were coming from. Was it true what they said about women peaking sexually in their late thirties, early forties? Chrissy was 37. That put her right on the cusp.

"Okay, mister, now what are you thinking about? And you better not give me any bologna about how you were thinking about me."

I laughed. What could I say? "Okay, so if we go down this road, it's not just my secrets coming out. I want to hear yours too."

I'm not sure that statement was 100% accurate, but I was on the spot, so it just came out. When Chrissy actually looked nervous, my curiosity was piqued. Until now, I'd always thought it was only me with something to hide.

She said, "Fine. Deal. But you first."

"So five things? Like all at once?"

"We could alternate."

"Okay." I took a deep breath and contemplated where to begin. I was at a loss—not necessarily because there was a wealth of options, but more because it was so open ended.

Chrissy helped me out. "How many partners have you had?"

I did a quick catalog. Three in high school. Seven freshman year. Brigitte. And then only one drunken hookup before I met Chrissy. "Twelve, plus you."

"That's thirteen for real then? I'm not doubling that number or anything, am I?" The horror in her face at the idea of 26 sex partners was

telling. I needed to be careful what I confessed here.

“No, twelve plus you is the honest truth. Want me to go through them?”

“No need. But just so I know, if I’m number thirteen, what’s Brigitte?”

“Eleven.”

Chrissy whistled. “She ruin you for all other women?”

“Until you came along,” I said. Her joke was closer to the truth than she knew, but not for the sexy reasons she probably had in mind. “And that’s three questions already.”

“What a sec, those were just clarifications to the first question,” Chrissy protested.

“Sounded like questions to me.” I laughed as she rolled her eyes at me. “Same question as you. How many guys?”

“Four.” That’s the number I’d put together based on her having three serious boyfriends before me. Then she added wickedly, “Plus you.”

I raised my eyebrows. “Have you ever had a one-night stand?”

“Technically, it’s my turn to ask the question, but I’ll give you a freebie. Nope, never had a one-night-stand.” She looked pleased with herself for having a secret.

“Another woman?”

“Ha, you wish. So tell me why Brigitte ruined you for all other women. Besides the obvious blonde, big-boobs thing.”

I sighed. Here we go again, stirring up the past. Truth was, the answer was complicated. We had a messy end. She broke my heart and it took me a long time to get over that. But that wasn’t a *Cosmo* answer, nor was it one that Chrissy wanted to hear. So I have the easier—and still legitimate—one. “I’ve never been with someone who loved sex like she did.”

“So you like sluts?” she said. I couldn’t tell if Chrissy was mad or not.

“I guess I did when I was twenty,” I laughed, trying to lighten the mood. “Oh, come on, this is the past we’re talking about. No judgments, please.”

Chrissy shook her head, pretending to rise above that. “I’m not judging. Just trying to understand. What...what kinds of things did she do that you liked?”

Ah ha. So this was the heart of what Chrissy wanted to know. I saw it in the way her hands twisted her napkin and furtiveness of her stare.

“Well, she just liked it. I don’t know.”

“I like sex,” Chrissy said. “But I don’t think it’s the same.”

“Not really.”

“So help me understand what was different with Brigitte?”

I poured myself another glass of wine as I pondered how to explain why Brigitte was a slut. That got me thinking of the label of slut, and how packed with judgment the term was. In a nutshell, that was the issue.

“First of all, it’s not fair to call her a slut. She loved sex, and did things that almost all other girls didn’t for fear of being labeled that.”

“Like?”

Like fuck a guy as I watched, I thought. My throat went dry, my body hot.

“I don’t know,” I stammered. “Like...talking dirty. Remember that thing about eye contact during oral?” It got easier to talk about as I built momentum. “Brigitte understood that sex isn’t just about physical parts rubbing against each other, but there’s a huge mental component as well. She knew what a turn on it was to hear her beg to be taken a certain way, or how good something felt.”

“I do that,” Chrissy said, getting a little defensive.

“You do, and I love it,” I said carefully.

“But?”

“Just the words she used were more...extreme.”

“And you liked that?” Chrissy slid closer.

“Yeah.”

She looked at me, her hand sliding into my lap. “So if I said I like your nice, hard cock, that would turn you on?”

I actually jumped in her hand. She giggled. “That answers that.”

“My turn to ask a question,” I said. Chrissy released me, much to my disappointment. “You dated three guys seriously. So who was the fourth?”

This close to her, even in the dim lighting, I could see Chrissy’s blush. “My Psych 101 TA.”

She turned away, her cheeks pink. I didn’t know what to say, but my silence must have been enough for her. “I know, I know. Terrible, right? I was a freshman, coming off a major high school relationship. Victor taught our Psych discussion group, and God was he hot. Twenty-five, dark hair, was into things like rock-climbing and cycling.”

“Sounds like lust at first sight.”

“And then some.” Chrissy laughed. “He seduced me, and I totally knew it.”

“You had to come to his office hours for some private instruction?” I joked, but I felt an odd stirring inside—not purely jealousy, but arousal, too.

“Not quite like that. I was the best student in the class—”

I laughed. “Of course you were.”

“But Victor did pay more attention to me than anyone else in the class, making sure to tell me when I made a great point, or clarifying something. Sometimes it felt like we were the only two in the room, having a private discussion on id versus ego.”

“So how did you move things to the next stage?” I was riveted.

“Well...” Chrissy smiled and took a breath, swirling her wine without drinking it. “Victor asked me to stay behind after class one day. It was the last class block of the day—the 6:30 to 7:45, or something like that. I stayed. He shut the door and locked it.” She was staring at her wine, lost in the memory.

“I knew what was happening, but played coy. Asked him what he wanted to talk about. He just walked up to me, and...” She seemed to remember that I was there. She glanced up at me and said, “And he took me.”

My brows went up. “Right there? In the classroom.”

Chrissy nodded, like she could hardly believe it herself. “And then after, back at his apartment.”

“Wow...” I didn’t know what else to say. Even more confusing, I was uncomfortably hard. “Was it a one-time thing?”

Chrissy snatched her wine and took a sip, already shaking her head. “No, we hooked up on and off through the semester. I think I rationalized it because it wasn’t like I was doing it for an A. Plus, I’d never done anything like that. It was so...casual. I don’t know.” She reached across the table and took my hand. “I’m sorry, Stephen, I should have told you.”

Hearing about my wife getting plowed by some 25-year-old stud stirred up a mixture of jealousy and arousal that I had no right to feel, yet I couldn’t deny. Chrissy and I had been together for so long that it was hard to think of a time before us. Even our discussions of Brigitte and my past felt like we were discussing another lifetime. Had the woman across from me really done that?

“Don’t apologize. The past is the past,” I said at last. I tried honesty, “Plus, I think it’s pretty sexy.”

“Yeah?”

“Yeah. I don’t really get why, but it turns me on.” The wine had apparently loosened my tongue.

It was Chrissy’s turn to raise her eyebrows. “Really?”

“You know, what guy wouldn’t be excited to hear about his wife’s sexy past?” It was a half-truth, but I wasn’t ready to acknowledge the full extent—even to myself.

“So it’s not just the idea of a young Brigitte that gets you going, huh?” She slid close to me again, her hand covering my erection. “You *are* turned on. Interesting.”

Something about the way she said it made my stomach squirm.

“So if I told you how Victor liked to fuck me on my back on his desk at the front of the class, that would excite you?” She giggled when she felt my cock jump in my pants. “Or the time we snuck into the lecture hall one night and did it right up there in front of all those empty seats? I was so scared, but so turned on.”

Listening to this, I had trouble breathing. She had to be making this up. She just had to.

“Or, my favorite time—and our last time—we were at a reception for the winter gala at the college president’s mansion. I was there because I was president of the college dance club. Victor was there because all faculty was invited. He looked so good in his black suit and skinny black tie.” Chrissy licked her lips. “We ended up hooking up in one of the upstairs bathrooms, me leaning against the sink, looking at him through this ornate, gilt-framed mirror.”

“You’re shitting me.”

“I’m not.” Chrissy giggled. “But you don’t have to believe me if you don’t want to.”

I wanted to believe her. I so did, but it was damned hard. It just didn’t sound like her. “And after that, you stopped...hooking up?”

“Yeah. I saw him around campus, but that was about it. It was a fling, and by the end of it, I knew it was a fling. You had Brigitte, so you know what I’m talking about.”

I had Brigitte. The past stung. I wish I’d have been as wise as my wife, but I wasn’t. I buried that thought as quickly as it arrived and nodded.

“Yeah.”

“It’s funny. I’ve always been ashamed of that. Silly now that I think about it, but I was scared of what you’d think of me.” She squeezed my erection one last time before letting me go. “Now that I know that you’ve been pining for your wild ex-girlfriend, I should have guessed you’d be into it.”

“No, it’s not like that.” My reaction was so knee-jerk that I didn’t even know what the “it” in the statement was. I seized the first one that came to mind. “I haven’t been pining for her. I don’t know why I dream, but it’s not a choice.”

“What would Victor in all his Psych 101 wisdom say about this?”

“How about we not go there?” I said with a toothy smile.

“Then back to the *Cosmo* Game. How many questions do I have left?”

“Negative one, I think,” I said. Talk about out of the frying pan and into the fire.

“How about one more. Now that I’ve shared with you my big, dark secret, you tell me yours.”

For a fleeting moment, I thought of the end of my relationship with Brigitte, and all the disturbing thoughts it had wrought—even now. But that was another conversation for another time.

Instead, I said, “We had a threesome.”

“Somehow, I knew you were going to say that!” Chrissy blurted, then quickly covered her mouth as she drew stares. “How much have we been drinking? Time to switch to water.”

“Definitely water.”

“So a threesome? With another girl, right?”

“Actually, no. Another guy.”

“Really?!” She covered her mouth, her eyes wide over her hand. She giggled. “Wow.” She giggled some more. “Wow! Now that, I wasn’t expecting.”

“It was in the last week of camp. The kids were all gone. Just the counselors and the camp admins were left. It was actually with one of those admins that it happened. Brigitte had been flirting with him some throughout the summer, but she did that with everyone.”

Chrissy hung on my every word. “And that didn’t make you jealous?”

“Oh, I was incredibly jealous. But I was also getting it regularly from Brigitte, and she didn’t seem to be getting bored of me or anything, so I

figured it was par for the course of having a sex bomb girlfriend.”

Chrissy watched me thoughtfully, but didn’t say anything. I worried that I was hurting her somewhat. She was pretty easygoing when it came to this stuff, but we all have our limits.

“Anyway, in that last week, things ramped up between Brigitte and Seth. I think I had blinders on, because when she dragged me up to Seth’s private cabin, I thought we were there to get commended on a job well done or something.”

Chrissy didn’t laugh like I was expecting. She was focused on the story.

“Just before we went in, Brigitte turned to me and said, *If you’re uncomfortable with any of this, just say the word and we’ll stop. Okay?* No other explanation than that. So when Brigitte kissed Seth as soon as he opened the door, I was stunned.”

I still remember that visceral moment like it had just happened. I wanted to vomit. I wanted to run screaming from that cabin. But I couldn’t stop watching them—watching my girlfriend’s tongue slide along another man’s. And when Brigitte turned to me and we did the same thing—when her hand brushed along the front of my pants—I was so hard.

“Did you and Seth...?”

It took me a moment to understand what Chrissy was suggesting. “No, no, no. None of that. It was strictly the two of us on her. But we were all over her.” I looked at Chrissy, who had this adorably hungry look on her face. “At one point, I remember watching her get...fucked by Seth...” The F word, even after all these years, felt like a punch to the gut. “...while she went down on me, and thinking that this had to be some kind of crazy dream.”

“How did that make you feel?” Chrissy asked.

“All kinds of things. It was surreal, most of all. Like having an out-of-body experience. By that time, Brigitte and I had been together most of the summer. I knew her body pretty well. But seeing her with another guy was...was like watching a porn or something. It didn’t feel real, but it was.”

“That’s intense.”

I laughed. “Totally.”

“I think that I’m ready for the check,” Chrissy said.

“Me too.”

*

We raced home—well, as fast as the Uber driver could take us. I thought about making out with Chrissy in the backseat of the black Lincoln, and judging by the way her fingers twitched on her skirt, she was thinking the same, but years of marital decorum won out in the end.

We paid the babysitter, made sure she was on her way down the block, then tore each other's clothes off.

Maybe Chrissy was thinking about Victor. Maybe she was thinking about Brigitte and our threesome. But whatever it was, she was on fire. I entered her with one fluid thrust. She arched beneath me, her legs wrapping around behind my back.

"Fuck me, Stephen," she moaned. I did, driving into her with long, hard strokes. She encouraged me, digging her heels into my back with each lunge. That was new, and that made it exciting. Emboldened, I fucked her harder, forcing a grunt with each swift thrust.

It was the kind of fuck that reminded me of Brigitte—a wild, unrestrained session where we kept pushing ourselves faster and faster, harder and harder. Thinking about Brigitte in turn made me think of our threesomes and the charged feeling of watching her take it from another man.

"I love your cock, baby!" Chrissy dug her heels in harder. My fantasy morphed. It wasn't Brigitte getting fucked by Seth as I watched. It was Chrissy and her TA—and it was the Chrissy of today, not the bright-eyed coed from the past. "Fuck me. Hard-der!"

Chrissy clutched the bedspread with one hand, her body thrashing beneath me. With her other, she grabbed my shoulder, her nails biting into my flesh.

I felt her come, felt her heels pull me into her, felt her pussy clench around my burrowing cock. I went with it, slowing my thrusts as I rode out her gasping climax.

Then, before she could fully recover, I pulled out, flipped her onto her stomach, and pulled back on her hips. With her knees folded under her, I entered her again. She wasn't expecting it. She moaned loudly before she could restrain herself.

This was how Brigitte and I were. One orgasm was never enough for her, and she'd trained me to fuck her until neither of us had anything left to

give. We didn't cuddle. We didn't slowly drift off to sleep. We passed out, hot and sweaty. Tonight, I wanted to have that experience with Chrissy.

I surveyed Chrissy's tight little body, pale, lightly freckled, damp with exertion. What would she say if I spanked that round ass of hers? Brigitte liked to be spanked, but she also had always begged for it. Brigitte also liked her hair pulled. I wondered how Chris would react if I seized a clutch of her damp, strawberry blond hair and pulled back. Would she have the same pleasure-pain reaction that Brigitte had? Or would it just be pain? Would it kill the mood?

I decided not to test it. I just fucked her in silence, caressing her ass and her lower back. She began meeting my thrusts with her hips, rocking back on her knees. She was into it. She liked the rougher fuck.

Is this how Victor fucked her?

I took a deep breath, slowing my thrusts and refocusing. I needed to get away from that dangerous line of thinking. I went back to our dinner conversation, and the deal we'd made. "Five things that I didn't know about your sex life. If my count is right, I only got two of yours: that you had four sex partners, and that one was a TA. Three if we count the exhibitionist thing."

Chrissy raked her fingers through her hair, glancing at me over her shoulder. She started to readjust, to sit up. I pressed down with a hand on her back, burying my cock to the hilt as I pinned her to the mattress. If we shared one of those soul-searching looks, I don't know that I'd be able to ask what I wanted to ask. I would have come to my senses. That lust-fueled fever would have broken.

"Am I the biggest cock you've had?" It was an absurd question that a rational me wouldn't have claimed even thinking. But I wasn't a rational me.

Chrissy moaned something I couldn't understand. I leaned into her, driving my cock even deeper.

"What was that?"

"No," she whispered.

It was the answer that I feared, yet hoped for. The paradox punched me in the stomach.

"Who? Your TA?"

"Mmm hmm." She started bucking her hips again. I felt something tickle my balls. It took me a moment before I realized that it was Chrissy's

hand.

“So that’s why you kept going back to him?”

“Not...not the only reason.”

“But it *was* a reason.”

Chrissy gasped. Her hand wasn’t teasing my balls; those touches were incidental. She was playing with her clit.

I pressed. “You like big cocks?”

“Yes. I liked it. That what you want to hear?”

“You couldn’t get enough of his big cock?”

“Steve, fuck me. Please. I’m so, so close.”

“Think about him. Think about Victor.” I sat up, bracing myself on her back, once again fucking her in long, deep thrusts.

“You ran into him today. At work.” I didn’t know where this story was coming from, but it sent a surge of excitement through me. “He asked you for a drink. For old times.”

“Stephen, I’d never—”

I spoke right over her—fucked right over her. “You accepted. For old times, you told yourself, but all through drinks, you couldn’t stop thinking about his cock. When he invited you back to his place, you said yes.”

“No,” she whined, but her fingers were furiously rubbing her clit, her knuckles thrumming against my swinging balls.

“And now here you are, getting filled with him. Fucking him. Getting off. On *him*.”

She cried out a no. Or maybe it was just a moan. I couldn’t tell past the roar in my ears as my own climax arrived. I pounded her from behind, my balls seizing. I squeezed my eyes shut, seeing Chrissy’s faceless lover in my position, fucking her from behind, filling her with his illicit come. My orgasm hammered even harder with that vision, beating me down.

Chrissy joined me, her body flexing, her throaty cries hushed yet as intense as ever. Was she thinking about Victor, too? Was she living the fantasy? My fantasy?

I didn’t like that line of thinking. It was confusing, but I didn’t have that fantasy. This was all for her. To get her out of her shell. To get her fantasizing.

I rolled off her, flopping in a sweaty heap to her right. She stretched her legs out, but remained flat on her stomach, breathing hard.

“Well, that was different,” she said at last.

Shame felt like a wet blanket being draped over my body. I wanted to curl up into a ball and make it all go away. “I’m sorry.”

“No, don’t apologize. It was hot. Just...different.”

I chose to ignore the part where we just imagined her with a former lover. “I don’t know what got into me. The wine, maybe?”

“How about our confessions?” She cuddled up beside me, too exhausted to even kiss my lips. Instead, she kissed my shoulder. The silence hung between us. I wanted to fall asleep. To forget all of this. But I couldn’t. She said, “Do you really think about me with other—”

“No,” I said. “Of course not.”

I didn’t. I couldn’t.

“If you want to talk about it—”

“That was for you, honey. We’ve been spending so much time talking about my past, reliving my history, that I wanted to see how you felt when we did it with you.”

It wasn’t exactly the same thing, but it was close enough.

“Just so we’re clear, if I ever ran into Victor—or anyone, for that matter—I’d never accept a drink with him.”

I nodded, knowing it to be true. Then, she added, “Without telling you about it, that is.”

My heart skipped. My stomach squirmed. Chrissy giggled. “Sweet dreams, Stephen.”

She was asleep within a minute. Me? It took me a long time to join her.

Chapter 5:

The Invitation

The invitation arrived a few weeks later, gold foil script on creamy, white paper. I was taking a break from a particularly challenging coding issue, sorting our mail in my home office, when I opened the thick, square envelope.

“You are cordially invited to the wedding of Cornell Mann and Elizabeth Burke.”

Elizabeth Burke. Lizzie Burke. Now there was a name I hadn’t heard in a while. While Brigitte was the embodiment of the wild first half of college, Liz represented my quieter, more mature upper class years.

And unlike Brigitte, I’d actually kept up with Lizzie. She came to our wedding. We still exchanged Christmas cards. She actually was a friend on Facebook. But I hadn’t seen her since before the kids, besides posts here and there, and honestly had almost forgotten about her until the invitation arrived.

Lizzie had been a friend of Brigitte’s. Initially anyway. She was the only one of her friends that I actually kept after our break-up. She was also the only other person I slept with after Brigitte, up until I met my wife.

It had happened only once, during the winter break of our junior year. A lot of cranberry and vodkas had been consumed. From what I remember, though, it was a great experience, just one we both chose to write off in the light of the next morning. I felt guilty in the weeks after—like I’d used her to get back at Brigitte or something. When I saw them hanging out in the cafeteria at the start of the next semester, though, I realized that it was me with the hang-up. We actually went on to become better friends after that.

I checked the date and location of the wedding. January, a good three months away, and on St. Thomas in the Virgin Islands. Pretty nice. Still, I did have one concern.

I logged onto Facebook and looked her up. She’d cut her dark hair shorter—a long bob that didn’t quite reach her shoulders—but still looked good. I opened up the messenger and shot her a quick question.

Stephen: Just got your invite. Congrats! Is Brigitte going to be there?

I got my response less than a minute later.

Liz: She's the Maid of Honor, of course!

Well, that settled that. I promptly filed it away. No way was I going to that.

*

Or so I thought. A week later, Chrissy found the invitation while going through the stack of junk mail we'd accumulated.

"Hey, did you see this?"

She was sitting at our dining room table—a beautiful mahogany piece that we'd inherited from my grandmother and restored. We'd always dreamed of hosting dinner parties here, but it mostly served as a work space for Chrissy. The mail was neatly stacked into three piles: to keep, to toss, to be sorted. She was checking out the address on the invitation's envelope when I walked into the room.

"Your friend Lizzie is getting married." She flipped the invitation over. "Ooh, St. Thomas. Yes please."

"Want to go to the Virgin Islands? We can go on our own."

"Interesting answer, Stephen. I sense a story."

"Not a very interesting one. It's been a long time since I saw her. I'm surprised we were even invited."

Chrissy narrowed her eyes. "Nope, you're definitely hiding something. She came to our wedding—"

"That was twelve years ago."

"For a destination wedding, I'd definitely do the same. And besides, wasn't she, like, your best friend back then or something?"

"Not best friend. But we were close."

"So you were sleeping together," she said, mostly as a joke. When I didn't immediately deny it, though, her eyes lit up. "You did!"

"It was nothing. A mistake."

"So was this before or after Brigitte?"

"After. And it only happened the one time."

"Interesting. But that can't be the reason you don't want to go to this wedding. I mean, you would have objected to her coming to our wedding." She thought about that a moment. "I think I should actually be upset with you. You should have told me you two hooked up back then."

“Seriously, it was a mistake. I swear. Other than that one blip, we were friends, and that’s how I thought of her.”

“Okay,” Chrissy said. “So we’re back to the original question. Why aren’t we celebrating the nuptials of your good friend?”

“She’s friends with Brigitte.”

“The plot thickens. Your college love life was a lot more dramatic than I thought.”

“Says the woman who slept with her professor.”

Chrissy rolled her eyes. “TA. It’s way different. Anyway, we’re talking about you. I take it Brigitte doesn’t know about that drunken mistake?”

“No, she probably does.” Chrissy stared at me, trying to wrap her head around what I was saying. I added, “We were broken up.”

“They were friends, Stephen! That’s not how things work.”

“For Brigitte, it must be. They’re still friends. In fact, Brigitte’s the Maid of Honor.”

“Huh.” Chrissy looked puzzled. “I don’t get that, but okay.”

She flipped through the invitation, pulling out the RSVP card. When she started scribbling on it, I asked, “What are you doing?”

“Letting them know we’ll be going, of course.”

The idea of my wife meeting Brigitte filled me with dread. “What about the kids? Tickets down to St. Thomas’s aren’t cheap.”

“My parents can watch them.” Chrissy finished filling out the RSVP card and tucked it into the envelope. She saw my reluctance. “What’re you afraid of, dear? If anyone should be freaked out, it’s me.”

That was true. “Aren’t you?”

“Oh, your ex scares the heck out of me.”

Chrissy stood, trailing her fingers on the glossy table top as she rounded it. She wore a pair of black yoga pants and a loose sweater tunic—the one I jokingly refer as her burlap sack look. She was skinny and petite enough to make it work.

“But?”

“But I’m also kind of fascinated by your past,” she said. “I mean, I knew you had a life before me, but it was all abstract, you know?”

“Yeah, ditto, actually,” I said. My thoughts went to her story about Victor the TA, and my stomach got all squirmy again. “But doesn’t it kind of make you jealous?”

“Does it make you?” She shot back. She didn’t let me answer. “It does, but only a little. Mostly, I’m just intrigued. Like I discovered an old chest in the attic with all these things from the past. Only it’s not my chest, it’s yours, and I’m learning all kinds of new things about my husband.”

I laughed lightly, although I felt laid bare. “Anything you want to share?”

“Not yet. I’m still working something out.”

“Anything I can do to help you?” I couldn’t keep the sarcasm from my voice.

She actually took the question seriously. “What was the threesome like?”

Her question caused my cock to stir. Had she been thinking about the threesome since I confessed it a couple weeks ago? Did she have that fantasy of her own? She’d never indicated that, but she’d also maintained that she didn’t have fantasies at all—not exciting ones, anyway.

“Like I said before, it was pretty surreal.”

“No, don’t go all cognitive on me. What was it *like*. How did it make you feel watching Brigitte...fuck another guy.” The F-word still caught on Chrissy’s lips.

“It was crazy.” I let out a heavy sigh. “And pretty exciting. I always knew that she enjoyed sex. But seeing her in action like that left little doubt.”

I didn’t even need to close my eyes to see Brigitte and Seth going at it. There was nothing tender about what they were doing. Seth was on the sofa, Brigitte straddling his lap, and both were rutting like it was a rodeo. We’d been going at it for awhile, and I was spent. Seth had one more in him and was determined to make the most of it. They were covered in sweat, their bodies slapping with each rapid undulation. Seth thrust his hips up to meet Brigitte’s driving hips, her pussy dancing along his cock.

“Must have been something,” Chrissy said, drawing me out of my daydream.

Suddenly I was embarrassed, caught daydreaming once again of my ex. I reached out and touched Chrissy’s hip, running my hand up her side.

“It was something alright.”

She slid into my lap, kissing me lovingly. It was the same position that I’d watched Brigitte and Seth enjoy so long ago, only Chrissy’s approach came with all the tenderness that I’d grown to love over the years.

“Sounds to me like you liked watching.” Chrissy pulled her top off. She wasn’t wearing a bra beneath—not unusual, other than that we were doing this in the dining room, not the bedroom. The kids had gone to sleep ages ago. “Sounds like someone has a bit of a voyeur streak in him.”

“And you may have an exhibitionist streak. Didn’t you do it in a lecture hall?”

“At the very front of one, yeah. But it was empty.”

“I bet you imagined it wasn’t.”

“Maybe.”

I sucked on a nipple, drawing a quick gasp from Chrissy before I pulled off. “So I like watching, and you like to be watched. That’s an interesting predicament.”

For one fleeting moment, I imagined Chrissy in the room with Seth—only in the vision, the sofa was at the front of a lecture hall, and I was the only one in the seats.

Even thinking the idea I was about to suggest got my heartbeat racing. Chrissy saw my nervousness, too.

“What are you thinking?” Chrissy asked.

Heat flooded my face. I couldn’t go there. I spoke before I had a fully formed plan. “You know what we’ve never done?” I paused; giving myself time to formulate a plan. Chrissy looked at me, prompting me to continue with those wide, brown eyes of hers. I took the plunge. “We’ve never played with ourselves in front of each other.”

Chrissy’s face went bright red. Mine would have been the same color had I not just gone short of breath thinking of her with another man. She spoke slowly. “You want to try?”

“If you do.”

She wrapped her arms around my neck. “Is this something that you and Brigitte did?”

“Yes.”

That seemed to resolve it for Chrissy. She nodded, took a deep breath, and pushed out of my lap. “Did she like to be watched, too?”

Chris sat on the table, right in front of me, hooked her thumbs in her yoga pants, and peeled the tight material off. Beneath, she wore a black exercise thong that looked so flimsy across her sex. Her tangy excitement intoxicated me.

“She loved to be watched,” I said, stealing a glance up at Chrissy. Mostly, though, I watched her free hand as it swirled across her near naked body.

Chrissy had painted her nails a pale rose color, I noticed as she traced them up through the valley of her breasts. I wondered when she did that, and why hadn’t I noticed. Those painted nails teased her right nipple, pinching the pale cap. It snapped to life as she released a soft moan.

Sitting just a couple feet from her, my cock tightened against the front of my pants. I wanted to join her. Wanted to dip my head between her thighs and lick her panty-clad pussy. Instead, I watched, enraptured.

She switched nipples, reaching across her chest to go for the other. A quick glance up showed her eyes closed, her head tilted enough to the side that her strawberry blond hair fell across one pale shoulder. The supporting hand behind her was balled up in a fist, like she was trying to punch through the mahogany.

Chrissy had a semi-regular workout schedule that kept her body toned. I could see her abs tighten as she slid her free hand down her stomach. She paused just at the top of her thong.

“Did she play for the two of you?” Chrissy asked. For me and Seth.

It was so long ago, I honestly couldn’t remember. But I knew what my wife wanted to hear. I looked up at my wife, fixing her with a stare. “She did.”

Chrissy bit her lip. Her brow was furrowed. I continued. “She told us to take our cocks out and play with them as she touched herself.”

Chrissy’s chest rose and fell rapidly. She looked at me with expectation. I half-wished she’d tell me to do the same, but she seemed content to let me take the initiative on my own. I unbuckled my pants and slid out of them, along with my boxers. My cock sprang free.

“That for me? Or are you still thinking of the threesome?” Chrissy asked.

Are you? I almost replied. “For you. You’re so hot.” Her fingers traced the seamless hem of her panties. “Go on. Touch yourself. You know you want to.”

She seemed to be waiting for my permission. With that, she plunged her hand inside the thong. Her eyes fluttered shut. Her moan bit through the hushed room.

I could see her fingers moving beneath the sweat-wicking material, knuckles forming peaks and valleys as she played with herself. My cock was in my hand. I don't remember doing that. I pumped slowly, feeling just how close I was. This was intense.

"That's it, baby," I encouraged. "Just do what comes naturally. Don't think about me."

Her fingers grew more vigorous, pulling at the panties. I caught a glimpse of her trimmed pubes, of the pink of her slit. She had two fingers buried inside of her and her thumb seemed to be working her clit. I wanted to tear the thong off, but I didn't want to disturb the moment. It was so fragile. So very fragile.

Chrissy did it for me. She lowered herself all the way onto her back, freeing up her left hand. In one quick motion, her panties were off and her glistening pussy uncovered. She bent her knees, resting the arches of her feet on the edge of the table. Free to use both hands, she worked her clit with her right as she plunged two fingers into her pussy with her left.

What got my blood pumping more than the visuals of her masturbating, though, were the sounds she was making. The coos. The gasps. The tight moans. What was she thinking about? What was she getting off on?

I stopped stroking myself all together. I just held on, squeezing my shaft as I fought to stay on the brink.

Chrissy lifted a hand to her tit, smearing it with her girl-juices. She pinched. Arching her back off the table, she spread her legs wider, once again fingering herself with just one, deft hand.

"Ah!" A single moan rang out through the house. Then, with a deep, fortifying breath, I watched her whole body tighten up, bowing up, head back. She rammed three fingers deep inside her as her thumb jammed her clit harder than I would have been comfortable doing.

Through gritting teeth and flaring nostrils, she came quietly. I almost—*almost*—joined her. I don't know how I didn't. I pulled my hand away from my cock before I exploded, seeking to delay. Not wanting to waste this.

Chrissy relaxed, reclining down to the table, now coated in sweat. She breathed quickly. Her eyes were still closed.

I climbed up on the table, sliding up between her legs. She opened her eyes just as I placed my cock against her pussy. Smiling at one another, I

pushed home.

We groaned together. That felt so good. So wet. I wasn't going to last long, but at least her excitement minimized the friction.

She placed a hand on my ass, encouraging me to take her. My mouth found hers, kissing her loosely as my hips rose and fell. We couldn't maintain it. Our lips fell away. I buried my head in her shoulder.

"You think her husband shares her?" Chrissy's voice was ragged in my ear. "You think she shares her husband?"

Her questions triggered something deep and primal inside of me. I'd been so focused on Brigitte and my memories that I hadn't even considered her present life. She was married to a handsome playboy who was built like a running back. Chrissy had clearly thought about him more than me. Was she thinking about him now? Did he fuck her hard? *Hard. Hard!*

"Stephen, baby," Chrissy cried. "Slow down, baby. Slow—uh—down."

I regained my senses. Reality returned—the smooth mahogany table, the dining room—and with it, my climax. I sank in deep, my balls tightening. My brain turned to fuzz as I buried my face in Chrissy's hair and grunted.

"Oh, Stephen," Chrissy whispered. "Oh, yes..."

She was coming again, her moans mixing with mine. I managed a whispered *I love you* in there, and when the moment had passed, I kissed her cheek because my body couldn't rally enough to move more than that.

After lying there, basking in the warmth of our climax, I rolled onto my back. We looked up at the chandelier, and its softly glowing bulbs. Two of the six were burned out.

"I love that we can still surprise each other," Chrissy said. "This is fun."

"Yeah." It also scared the hell out of me.

Chapter 6:

The Break-Up

This time of year is always busy. Between our son's birthday, Halloween, Thanksgiving, Christmas, and New Year's Eve, the two and a half months before the January wedding passed in a flash. If anything, having to plan for a vacation—our first in years—just accelerated things.

Chrissy and I didn't bring up Brigitte all that much, although the dreams of my ex had started coming more frequently—and, despite my hazy remembrance of them, I was pretty sure I wasn't always the guy with her.

At Thanksgiving, we went home to my parents' house for a great big turkey feast. My brother and sister came, along with their families. A few cousins still in the area joined us for the meal. We drank a bunch of cheap beer. We ate too much of everything. We watched a lot of football.

It was fun, but like every year, my favorite part was when it was over and the house was once again quiet.

My dad may have been still up, snoozing in front of the TV as the third NFL game played itself out in hard-hitting heroics. Mom and the kids were down. Chrissy was reading a book in the living room.

I wandered into the den, where the fire had burned down to warm cinders. My parents had installed bookshelves in this room a few years earlier. I moved to them, finding row after row of photo albums—both the modern, printed kind you order from Apple or Shutterfly, and the more traditional ones with actual photographs. My mom was meticulous about putting these together for every major occasion—even now, in an era of digital photo libraries.

On her shelf, sure enough, was an album of the summer I worked at Camp Idylwood. My heart trembled as I pulled it down. I sat on the floor, cross-legged, and opened it.

The first few pages were of our family together at the start of summer break. We looked so young. I laughed at my sideburns and my sister's side ponytail. My parents weren't old—at the time just a few years older than me and Chrissy were now. I looked at my dad, who I'd always viewed as an

older, wiser role model. Did he have his own flaws? Did he have a wild sex life that Mom never knew about?

I flipped the page, ready to move past the subject of my parents' sex life. After some photos from a beach trip we took early that summer, I got to my time at Camp Idylwood. And there, in the second cluster of photos, was a 21-year-old Brigitte.

She was softer back then—softer in the way everyone was at that age. Her face was rounder. Her body—in a camp polo and shorts—was svelte, but not the gym-honed perfection that graced her Facebook album these days. Her smile, though, was the same: wide, welcoming, radiant.

A younger me stood beside her, looking too cocky for my own good. We weren't holding hands. My arm wasn't around her. But I saw the connection between us—saw the way she was looking at me as I stared over at the camera.

"Hey, watcha looking at?"

I jumped at Chrissy's voice. I hadn't heard her come into the room. She crouched down and I was suddenly ashamed of this photographic trip down memory lane.

Chrissy saw what the album was, looked at me, then wrapped her arms around me, hugging me from behind. "I see. Look at you two."

I felt awkward. I stiffened. "Sorry. I couldn't resist."

Chrissy laughed softly. "I was going to do the same thing, actually."

I wasn't sure if she was being honest, but I took the photo out anyway. She reached out, touching the shot of me and Brigitte.

"So was this before or after The Walk."

"After."

"Look at the way she's looking at you. You must have left an impression."

"Well, this isn't awkward."

Chrissy laughed. "You're so young. Look at all that hair."

I touched my head now, running it across my high forehead and the widow's peak that got higher and higher each year. "Are you saying that you'd leave me for this younger man?"

"Nah. He looks a little too arrogant for my tastes."

"Ha. Well, he thought pretty highly of himself."

"So what happened? The guy I met a few years later wasn't."

I looked at Brigitte and almost said, *She happened*. Instead, I copped out. “I grew up.”

I stood up, my knees creaking, and moved over to the fire. Chrissy stayed where she was, quietly flipping through the album as I added a new log.

“Wow, it was beautiful there,” she said.

“Yeah.” I poked the fire, watching the new log slowly catch. It was a beautiful thing to witness.

“Even the cocky version of you was good with kids.”

“Har har.”

I listened to the crackle of the fire and the rustle of Chrissy flipping through the album. I couldn’t exactly remember which photos my mom had chosen, but I didn’t think there were many of Brigitte.

My dad poked his head in the room, looking half-asleep. “I’m headed to bed, kids. Make sure that you shut the fireplace doors if you head up before that burns down.”

My dad always reminded me how critical context was. He could call a couple 37-year-olds “kids” and make it totally work.

“Thanks, Dad,” I said.

Chrissy got up and gave him a hug. “Thanks again for making this day so great. For everyone,” she said.

My dad blushed. I think he had a crush on my wife. To me, he said, “Have I told you that you’ve got a keeper here?”

“Only for the last 15 years,” I replied.

“Goodnight, you two. And you’re very, very welcome, my dear.”

When he was gone, Chrissy joined me by the fire, the album at her side. She put her head on my shoulder and watched the flames with me for a quiet moment. At last, she said, “You two looked good together.”

“We were young.”

“Not every young couple is that attractive. But that’s not what I’m talking about. You looked good *together*. Into each other. The way you tell it, it was a summer fling. But I’ve been thinking about this. It didn’t end after summer. And now that I look at these photos... It wasn’t just a casual thing, was it? You had feelings for each other, didn’t you?”

This was not a conversation I ever wanted to have with Chris; even after a decade-plus of marriage, it wasn’t easy. But she’d asked, and I gave

her the honest answer. “Yeah, it wasn’t just a casual thing. Would have made things easier if it had been, though, there at the end.”

I stared at the fire, absently caressing the smooth skin of Chrissy’s ankle. She let me gather my thoughts.

“Until I met Brigitte, I’d just been having fun. Even in high school, I didn’t really have anything steady—certainly not serious. I was having fun. In no rush to settle down. Then I met Brigitte.” I shook my head, like that would ward off the heavy emotions I was stirring up. “I thought I’d hit the jackpot. She was fun, gorgeous, smart, and seemed to be as into me as I was with her. I seriously thought—”

“What?”

I blushed at what I was about to say. “I was actually thinking about rings.”

I didn’t need to look to know Chrissy was staring at me wide-eyed.

“I know, right? But that’s where my head was. She was a dream come true. Might as well put a ring on it.”

“Wise, Beyoncé.”

“I was twenty. What can I say?”

“So what happened? How did you...why did you—”

“Break up? She cheated on me.” Saying that was like uncorking a part of myself long bottled up. I hadn’t uttered that truth in years.

“Oh, I’m so sorry, hon.”

I laughed bitterly. “Don’t you think it’s odd that my wife is consoling me for a break-up that happened seventeen years ago?”

“Hey, I can’t help it. That’s just me, you know?”

And that’s why I love you, I didn’t add.

She said, “And if she were here right now, I’d scratch her eyes out.”

I laughed again, this time with less spite. “Honestly, it’s more complicated than that.”

“So explain.”

Could I really do this? I didn’t understand it fully myself. I took a deep breath and looked at Chrissy. She was studying me. That required another deep breath.

“So you remember the threesome I told you about?”

“How could I forget?” Chrissy sucked in a breath. “She cheated on you with him. I knew it. Seemed too convenient to set up a threesome like that.”

“What are you—oh, no. It wasn’t with Seth.” Although I’d never considered what Chrissy was saying. Made sense now. “Let me finish. This isn’t easy.”

“Sorry. I’ll shut up.”

“So that wasn’t our only threesome. Brigitte was kind of hooked. I’ve told you that she loves sex. Well, she really loved getting it on with two guys. When we got back to school, we did it a couple more times, each with different guys. It was her way of reassuring me that she loved me.” I winced at the L word. I’d been trying to avoid it.

Chrissy’s face darkened, her eyes flaring open. A moment later, she was back in control, her expression inquisitive again. I quickly continued.

“Anyway, it was never easy for me, but also strangely hot. Addictive, even. She probably would have cooled it if I’d asked, but a dark part of me liked watching her...do that.” I licked my lips, uncomfortable as ever with that kink.

“Then, we met Cole. I should have shot him down as soon as Brigitte introduced us. He was a tennis player, tall, broad shouldered, blond haired—basically my worst nightmare, and my girlfriend wanted to fuck him.”

Of all the moments in my life that I regretted, not pulling the plug on Cole ranks up there. I’m not sure if anything would have changed—the break-up was probably inevitable no matter what, but Cole helped it go down with fireworks.

“The *first* threesome that we had—yeah, first—was amazing. Brigitte couldn’t get enough of Cole, and I couldn’t stop watching. She usually kept up, even with two guys, but we wore her out. Or, rather, Cole wore her out. The second time, I did little more than watch. The third time...I guess they forgot to invite me. I walked in while they were going at it.”

“Oh, Stephen...”

“I still remember it so clearly. I was supposed to do this group project, but we decided to meet the next night. So I decided to swing by Brigitte’s. To surprise her, you know? She had a place off-campus, but I was basically living there too. So much that she’d given me a key. I walked in and heard the moans. She was so loud when she had sex, there was no mistake that it was her.”

“That must have been terrible,” Chrissy said. She laced her fingers in my hand and squeezed.

I should have just agreed. Some things aren't meant to be shared. But I was feeling raw and open. "It did, but..." I shook my head. "You know what's crazy? I didn't leave. Not immediately."

"Like, you broke them up?"

"No. I...I watched."

Chrissy didn't look as surprised as I would have thought she'd be, although she *was* surprised.

I said, "I can't explain it. Maybe I wanted to torture myself or something. They were really going at it. So uninhibited. So... so..."

"Hot?" Chrissy offered.

I gulped. "I guess, maybe. Yeah. Part of me thought that way."

Chrissy studied me, her face completely unreadable. I suddenly wished I'd held my tongue more than anything. I flushed bright red, my face getting hotter than the fire could ever make it.

"You liked watching her with another man. I've heard that's a pretty common male fantasy—"

"Oh, no! I don't. I mean..." I sighed. "I mean it was all part of who Brigitte was. I know, it doesn't make much sense, but she was so...sexual."

"So you forgave her? What, did you join in?" For the first time since I'd started this retelling, I detected a hint of resentment. I needed to diffuse that.

"No way. I got out of there. Broke up with her the next day." I remember *that* encounter, too, and how hard it had been for both of us. Brigitte wasn't a particularly emotional person, but she'd bawled that day. She'd actually come to me first, confessing what she'd done. She'd misread me completely. When she realized that I was more upset than turned on, she'd done everything to win me back. But I'd spent the night before drinking, drowning in self-loathing. We were done before she'd even opened her mouth.

I looked at Chrissy, who was still processing it all. I didn't like where she may have started going, so I pressed on with the story. "After we broke up, I had a lot of time to think about it. I'll confess, it took me a long time to get over her."

"When did you hook up with her friend, Lizzie?"

"Touché, but I swear, it was a total lapse. Because of that, I kept away from most girls in general, even the friendships."

"Yeah, you said that. She really did a number on you."

Chrissy was upset, but I couldn't really blame her. This must have been hard. "I'm sorry, Chris. I was a dumb kid. I seriously didn't think I'd ever meet anyone I could love again." I smiled at my wife. "Then I met you."

"Aw, how sweet." She smirked at me. "Now I understand why you settled on me. You were bored out of your mind."

"Are you kidding me? If I remember correctly, the first time I saw you, you were delivering a spoken word poem that you'd written, with a three-piece jazz band playing behind you. Not exactly boring."

Chrissy softened, giggling. "Little, white girl reading beat poetry in a room of strangers. My first and last time doing that."

"You see? It was fate that I wandered into the coffee shop on that night." I pulled her close. "*To walk, to play, to shout at the stars and receive an answer not from the gods, but from the one at my side.* I'll never forget those lines."

"That's because you memorized them for your wedding vows," said Chrissy. She laughed. "The line could only be written by a college kid."

"Well, I thought it was beautiful."

She nuzzled my nose with her own. "Says the guy in IT."

We'd had this conversation before. It didn't offend me, and I kind of saw her point, although I found all the poetry she wrote beautiful.

"Maybe it's all about who's delivering the lines," I said, kissing her. I pushed my tongue past her lips, excited to feel her own doing the same. In the background, the fire snapped and popped.

"I remember seeing you walk in that night," she said. "I'd already been so nervous just to be up there in front of everyone, but now I had this hot guy I wanted to impress."

"So you thought I was hot, huh?" The story has been retold many times, of course, and she'd described me as *handsome*, a *tall and dark stranger*, even a hunk. But never *hot*. It wasn't a word Chrissy used, and somehow, that made her word choice sexier.

"Mmm, so hot." She touched the lapels of my shirt, then glanced at the fireplace. "Think your dad's asleep yet?"

I grinned. "He was probably asleep before he made it up the stairs."

Chrissy drew me in for a long, deep kiss. When she broke away, her eyelids were heavy with lust. "I'll get some blankets. Why don't you put another log on the fire?"

I just smiled as she stood and tiptoed out of the room. She wore a pair of tight jeans that turned her ass into a work of art, and a turtleneck sweater just tight enough to hint at sexy. I was a lucky guy. Turning, I grabbed two logs. This fire would roar.

Chrissy returned a moment later, a hand-knit blanket and pillow in her arms. She'd taken her glasses off at some point, and her hair was a loose cascade around her shoulders. She lowered herself to her knees in front of me, the firelight warming her face. I reached out, touching her delicate beauty.

We smiled at one another shyly, like the two kids that my dad had called us, and kissed. How could something so familiar feel so new and exciting?

She pulled back long enough to grab the bottom of her sweater and tug it off. I stole a look at her white satin bra as I unbuttoned my shirt and pulled it off.

"I love your shoulders," Chrissy said, touching the upper arms that I worked so hard to maintain.

We sank back onto the blanket as our lips found one another again. I was on top, my arms on either side of her head. With only the fire to light the room, her strawberry blond hair turned red. I kissed her neck as she sighed happily.

We stripped one another slowly. Lovingly. The fireplace had set the mood. Chrissy pulled my cock free, hard and thick as it was. She held it in her small hand, stroking it as we drank in each other's nudity. Her nipples were swollen. Her pussy wet. She placed me against her and I pushed in slowly, taking my time.

"That's so good," she said. "That's never going to get old."

We kissed. We undulated before the fire, sweat building slowly on our bodies, turning them into glowing, glistening works of art. It was a change of pace from the frantic sessions we'd shared recently. This was the stuff of dreams.

It was the kind of experience that Brigitte and I had never shared, even when I was convinced that I wanted to spend the rest of my life with her. We'd never made love. We'd never had this kind of connection.

Chapter 7:

Christmas Gifts

Chrissy works at a marketing firm—Fresh Ideas—and like so many other companies, they have a holiday party every December. It was always a good excuse to get a babysitter and have a night as a couple, not as parents. This year, though, we decided to test run shipping the kids off to the grandparents' house for the night, since we'd be leaving them there for three days in January when we traveled for the wedding.

We'd never done that before—the kids hadn't even slept over at a friend's house, so this was huge. Chrissy was a nervous wreck. She acted like we were leaving them for a month, rather than a night. She packed an individual suitcase for each child, filled with a contingency for every possible situation. Each child got two toothbrushes, two set of pajamas, three sets of clothing, toys, their pillows, the white noise machines, the monitor for the youngest, and a typed, detailed set of instructions for the care of each child.

"You know your parents have done this before, don't you?" I told Chrissy as she was zipping closed the suitcases.

That only earned me a glare. I backed off after that.

She didn't relax until the kids were physically out of the house and with her parents, and even then, she seemed nervous. "They're going to be fine," she said, as though still trying to talk herself into it.

"They're going to get spoiled rotten, stay up late, and eat candy for dinner. Yes, they're going to be fine!" I laughed. "It's only one night, hon. We can do this."

Chrissy hugged me. "I'm being neurotic, aren't I?"

"Maybe a little." I sidled up close to her. "So what are you going to wear tonight?"

She pulled back to look at me. "You know, I've been so focused on the kids that I haven't even thought about that." Inside, I was disappointed, but not surprised. Then, she added, "Although you know? I did pick up a few things from Nordstrom's last week. Maybe that would work."

Chrissy never randomly shopped for clothing. It wasn't a thing she did. My interest was piqued. "Oh yeah? You just happened to be at the mall?"

"Hm, yeah." She pretended to think about it, casting her eyes down. "During lunch. Actually, I think I may have taken the afternoon off, too." She looked up at me through her lashes, the picture of innocence.

"Something tells me that tonight's going to be fun."

Chrissy smiled brightly. "Oh, speaking of, I made a few appointments before then. At Aveda. It's been a while since I've had my hair done."

"Aveda, huh?"

"Mmm hmm. I figured I'd give myself an early Christmas present."

"That the kind of gift I can open early?"

Chrissy laughed. "You better!"

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Chrissy returned from the salon looking spectacular. I barely recognized the stylish woman who swept into our home, looking vaguely like my wife. Her strawberry blond locks had been cut and styled in a tousled bob that didn't quite reach her shoulders, burnished and glossy and just *wow*.

"You look great," I sputtered.

"Thanks. I told her to just do whatever she wanted," Chrissy said. It wasn't just that she had a new haircut. She seemed to have more confidence, too. "Now please get your suit out of the bedroom. I'm going to need it to get ready."

We'd been married for twelve years. We no longer did things like give each other privacy to dress. But like a dutiful husband, I obeyed, pulling out my suit, shaving kit, toothbrush, and cologne.

Chrissy kissed me softly, smelling like the lotion from the salon. "Thanks, hon. Let's Uber it tonight. No sense in worrying about a DD."

I got ready in the kids' bathroom, which was fine by me. Face shaved, teeth brushed, suit on, I still finished before Chrissy had emerged. I studied myself in the mirror, turning this way and that. Maybe I was just in denial, but even though I was slowly losing my hair, I thought the high forehead gave me a distinguished look. I didn't have a bald spot, just a receding hairline.

I touched my face, wondering once again whether I should grow a beard. Chrissy always shot me down—"But I like your nice jawline"—but I'd always thought I'd look pretty distinguished with a clipped beard.

I swung by the bedroom door and called in. "Almost ready?"

"Yeah, why don't you order us the Uber car. I'll be down in a few."

I pulled out my phone and ordered our ride, then waited. A couple minutes later, Chrissy emerged, wearing a long, black coat that she'd already buttoned up, along with a red pashmina scarf.

"Do I get a peek?" I asked.

"When we get to the party."

"You're killing me."

She smiled. "Good."

As the black Town Car whisked us into the city, all the worry of the past few days—the kids, my parents, the preparation—fell away.

"You smell good," I said. She'd put on her date night perfume.

"So do you. Mmm, I love that cologne. Reminds me of when we first started dating."

I wore it so sparingly that it was the same bottle that I had back when we met. Seated as she was, her coat opened around her legs up to her knees, and I was surprised that I didn't see her dress.

What I could see were her shoes, which I didn't think I recognized. Black and shiny, they were taller than almost anything she owned, with a slender, graceful heel and an open toe that showed off her red painted nails. My pants grew tight just looking at them.

I rested a hand on her knee, touching the silky, nude stocking. "Feels like we're dating, too."

When I pushed my hand higher, she stopped me, flicking her eyes to the driver up front. "What kind of girl do you think I am?"

"Definitely feels like we're dating again." I laughed, taking my hand away. "Fair enough. Later."

The holiday party wasn't at the office, but in one of the upscale steakhouses downtown. The marketing company had rented the whole restaurant for this celebration, inviting not just the staff and their spouses, but their clients and guests of clients as well. We arrived just as the sense of holiday cheer had begun to settle in.

"Can I take your coats?" the host asked as we stepped in from the cold.

"Thank you," Chrissy said, turning her back to him.

I watched without trying to be obvious. She shrugged out of her coat, revealing a little black dress that epitomized “sexy meets sophisticated.” While it wasn’t short in Brigitte terms—as I’d come to start thinking of it—it was definitely short for my wife. With wide straps that sat just off her shoulders and a silhouette just tight enough to show off her curves, I couldn’t stop staring.

“Sir? Your coat?” The host followed my eyes, then nodded in approval. I gave him my coat as jealousy and excitement churned inside of me.

“You approve?” Chrissy asked, linking her arm in mine.

“It’s very nice.”

“The saleswoman told me that every girl needs a LBD. I figured it was a good investment.”

I nodded. “Definitely good. You know what? I’m feeling a little exhausted. Why don’t we head home?”

Chrissy giggled. “Come on, goof. Let’s go find some mistletoe instead.”

Since I primarily work from home, I don’t get a whole lot of adult interaction. Not as much as Chrissy, anyway. I loved events like these because it let me hold a conversation with someone other than my wife that didn’t have to do with princesses or Transformers. I also knew most of her coworkers, so the chatter came easily.

We had a plated dinner. The CEO made remarks about what a great year they had, and how appreciative he was of his staff. There were door prizes and superlatives, which everyone got—Chrissy’s was Most Likely to Get You To Laugh. It was all good fun, the kind that I’d expect when clients were present.

After dinner came dancing. Besides the general socializing with a group of people she liked, this was always Chrissy’s favorite part of the night. I enjoyed dancing with her, too, but I was as content watching her move to the music. She grew up doing ballet and tap; she knew how to flow to the rhythm. She made it look easy—and when I was with her, she made it *feel* easy.

But I didn’t have the energy to keep up with her. She spent about half the time dancing with her coworkers—primarily female—in a big, laughing group. In fact, that’s what most of the dance floor was, anyway, other than the occasional couple skirting along the periphery.

As I sidled up to the bar and ordered myself another whiskey and Coke, I watched her dance. She had a sassy smile on as she shook her hips with one of her friends in marketing, then the two burst out laughing.

“You’re a lucky guy,” said the man behind me in line.

“I am?”

I turned to find a fit Asian man about my age. “You’re Chrissy’s husband, yeah? She’s pretty amazing.”

“Thanks.” Not knowing what else to do, I stuck my hand out. “Stephen.”

“Tom Park. I’m one of the clients.”

“Nice to meet you, Tom.”

“Don’t take this the wrong way, but the meetings when Chrissy is there are always the best. She has a way of making a meeting on data-driven marketing seem fun.”

“Sounds about right,” I said. I thought of my wife in a room with Tom Park and felt a tingling in my gut. “We’ve been married twelve years and she still amazes me.”

“I bet. Well, I’ll let you get back to her. Nice meeting you, Stephen.”

I didn’t immediately rejoin Chrissy. Instead, I found a spot behind one of the abandoned dinner tables to watch her more closely. I watched Tom, too, although he melted back into a crowd of executives standing opposite the dance floor. I thought about Chrissy and Tom in a meeting, laughing with one another, and again felt that tingle. On the spectrum of giddy excitement and queasy jealousy, the sensation hovered right in the middle.

I scanned the dance floor, wondering how I’d react if another man joined the throng with my wife. Would it push the needle closer to jealousy? Or excitement? Even as I pondered it, I realized that I wanted to find out. So instead of rejoining her, I decided to hit the bathroom and give her more time to be approached.

I didn’t really need to go, so I filed into a stall, sat down, and pulled out my phone. Inevitably, I loaded up Facebook and navigated to Brigitte’s page. Her latest post was about Lizzie’s wedding, and how excited she was to be a part of it. There was a picture of her in her bridesmaid’s gown, and like everything she wore, she pulled it off like she was modeling it for a catalog. The off-the-shoulder coral pink dress was tight across her torso, the short skirt draping off its high waist. It was the kind of bridesmaid dress designed for a beach wedding for very beautiful people.

The door to the bathroom opened. Two guys entered, laughter filling the small space. “Lots to look at,” one of them said.

“You know what I love about marketing? That it’s dominated by women.”

The other came right back: “Not just women, but really good looking ones.”

They unzipped and started peeing. I froze up. My stomach fluttered. My heart rate spiked. Should I cough? Make a sound to indicate that I was there?

“Really wish this had been staff and clients only. Sucks that the husbands are around.”

“Tell me about it.”

I tried to visualize who these two were, but couldn’t. They must have been clients.

“So who would you go after if they were alone?”

The peeing stopped. The urinals auto-flushed. They moved to the sinks. “Well, if you’d asked me last week, totally Catalina.”

“Of course.”

Catalina was hands down the hottest employee at Fresh Ideas. She had a killer body, looked like a Latin soap star, and had all the confidence that came with those traits. She was the Brigitte of this office.

The guy went on. “Hold on now. After tonight, I think I’m totally with you. Team Chrissy all the way. Out of the glasses, with her hair—”

“And that dress—”

“Yes! Damn, dude. She’s always been adorable. But tonight—”

“She’s a hottie.”

Como what?!

“I knew you’d come around,” the first guy continued. “Catalina’s sexy, don’t get me wrong, but there’s just something about Chrissy.”

I’d stopped breathing—felt dizzy.

“She’s got that girl next door thing going, but can definitely let her hair down. Her husband’s a lucky SOB.”

“Lucky he’s here, you mean. Otherwise, one of us would be learning whether the carpet really does match the drapes.”

I think I would have snorted at that one had I not been so shocked. The guys left laughing. I was left sitting on the toilet, my heart racing, my cock erect.

What had just happened? What had I just heard? I sat there for the longest time trying to wrap my head around it. There was a “Team Chrissy”? They were wondering whether she was actually a strawberry blonde?

By the time I finally settled myself, exited the stall, and splashed water on my face, my confusion was overwhelmed by a smile that I couldn’t control. Those guys were being macho assholes, objectifying Chrissy and Catalina like possessions that could be had if only their husbands weren’t around. But they were also harmless. Not only that, but they were completely unbiased—and they’d independently picked my wife over a total fox like Catalina to objectify. I couldn’t wait to tell her. She’d get a kick out of that.

At last, I left the bathroom, wondering if anyone had noticed that I’d been gone so long. No one did. It was as if nothing had changed. The party was still in full swing. A crowd still mobbed the bar. Chrissy was still dancing with her clutch of female friends.

I stood at the periphery again, just watching her. She’d been this sexy, vibrant thing before I’d overheard those two guys talking, but that was nothing compared to how she looked to me now. It was like seeing her for the first time—or maybe seeing her through the lens of those two guys.

She looked up at me through the crowd, her smile lighting up her face. Those eyes would get me every time—large, heartfelt, and beautiful. It was her eyes more than anything that had drawn me in that night at the poetry reading. When she’d looked at me across the room—like now—I was smitten.

Chrissy whispered something to her coworkers, who followed her gaze toward me. She’d said something that brought a laugh from the group. Chrissy hip-checked one of them, then broke free and approached me. She was once again on display in that new, little black dress, and I remembered the overheard comments of those two guys. They were right, she was definitely the one I’d take home tonight. Ever better, I actually got to.

“Hey there.” I stood and collected her in my arms. “Having fun?”

“Too much. My feet are going to kill in the morning.”

I thought about her tall heels. “Totally worth it, though. You look great out there.”

“Such a dutiful husband. I’ve trained you well.”

I considered telling her about what I'd overheard, but decided to hold it for now. "It's true. That dress is great."

"Then you're going to like the one I got for the wedding."

I sucked in a deep breath. "Yeah?"

"Oh, yeah. I don't know that I'll be able to wear a bra in it."

"You're full of surprises."

In her heels, Chrissy was almost tall enough to look me in the eyes. "Full of them, yes."

My heart skipped a beat. "Want to get out of here?"

Chrissy hesitated for just a moment, glancing back out at the dance floor. She enjoyed dancing, so for a moment, I was pretty certain I wouldn't be able to compete. Then she looked back at me and nodded. "Yes."

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I hailed a taxi in the chilly night air, catching one almost immediately. We slid into the car, cuddling together for warmth.

"You have fun tonight?" Chrissy asked, resting her head on my shoulder.

"Yeah. You?"

"I did, but my feet are killing me. I don't know how some women handle heels like this all the time." She slipped them off. Curling her feet up beside her caused her dress to ride up. I caught the hint of a stocking top. Chrissy almost *never* wore stockings.

She caught me looking and giggled. "See something you like?"

"I see something interesting, that's for sure."

"Give me your phone. I'm going to check in with my mom. Make sure they got down without a fuss."

I kissed her neck. "What's wrong with your phone?"

"I decided not to bring it." She held up her clutch. "It was lipstick, or the phone. These aren't the most practical of accessories."

I sighed and pulled out my phone. "I heard the funniest thing in the bathroom tonight."

"Oh yeah?" She powered my phone on, tapping in my passcode. I felt a sudden queasy panic as she did so.

"Yeah, I overheard these two guys talking about—"

“Well, this is interesting,” Chrissy said, interrupting me. “This what you were looking, as you were sitting over there, not dancing with me?”

“Huh?”

She turned the phone, showing me the last thing I’d looked at on my phone: a picture of Brigitte in her bridesmaid dress. Shit.

“N—no. I mean, I was just on Facebook, and...” This was bad.

“You’re following Brigitte?” Chrissy didn’t seem mad, exactly, although she seemed too calm for this to be a good line of questioning.

“No, I’m not following her.”

“So you’re just kind of creeping on her. Like a stalker.”

I didn’t want to get defensive, but I couldn’t help feeling like I needed to be. “Hey now, don’t tell me you haven’t done it.”

“So if I look in your Facebook messages, I’m not going to find anything incriminating?” She didn’t throw the question in my face like an accusation, exactly, more like a detective trying to get to the bottom of things.

“No. Go ahead and check if you don’t believe me. I’m sorry that I looked. I was just...curious. That’s all.”

Chrissy looked at the photo a second longer. “It’s a nice dress.”

Before waiting for a response, she called her mom to check in with the kids. I chewed on the inside of my mouth as I listened to her checking in. We drove the remainder of the trip in silence.

When we pulled up to the curb, Chrissy thanked the driver and slipped out, leaving me fumbling to pay as quickly as I could.

“Good luck, man,” the driver said.

I’m even getting pity from a cabbie. “Thanks.”

He grinned. “Chicks like that are usually worth it.”

I laughed, despite the situation. It was funny because while pretty girls like Brigitte came with this kind of emotional baggage, Chrissy never did. She didn’t throw fits. She wasn’t passive aggressive. She wasn’t any of that.

I met her at the door, where she huddled, shivering. Keys in hand, I hugged her first. “I’m sorry, Chris.”

She turned into me, hugging me back. “I know. I just...hate how insecure she makes me feel. I’m not that kind of girl.” Her quick laugh sent a cloud of breath around us. “But she’s so beautiful. And you’ve been dreaming about her. And, and I can’t help it.”

“Hey, don’t go there.” I brushed her cheek, cool and smooth. “I can’t help the dreams, but seriously, it’s all in the past.”

“I know. I *know*.” She groaned to herself. “Let’s continue this inside, maybe?”

I shivered. “Good idea.”

The house was dark except for the colored lights of the Christmas tree in the living room. Chrissy tossed her purse on the hallway credenza.

With her back to me, she said, “I’ve looked her up on Facebook, too.”

“I knew it.”

Chrissy looked at me over her shoulder. The tousled hair was going to take some getting used to. “Although I have to say, her husband’s much more fun to look at. Did you see their photos from Ibiza last summer?”

I had, mostly because they featured Brigitte in a bikini. I hadn’t paid much attention, but now that I thought about it, Marc Chastain was in many of them, shirtless and fit. Thinking of Chrissy drooling over Marc’s hard body brought the same queasy thrill that I’d felt listening to those guys in the bathroom.

I stifled it. “Right now, I’m more interested in checking out what’s under this dress.” I reached for the zipper that ran down her back.

“Is that so?”

Pulling at the zipper, I said, “Yep.”

Beneath, she wore a black strapless bra. I pushed the dress off her shoulders, where it caught briefly on her hips before pooling around her ankles. In addition to the bra that I didn’t recognize, she sported a matching thong and a pair of nude thigh highs with wide, lacy tops. I ran my hand gently down her side, resting it just above her thong.

“This part of the present, or more wrapper?”

Chrissy laughed. “What a male thing to say. Why don’t we call it both.”

I slid my hand up her spine to the clasp of her bra. “Speaking of things men say, I never got to tell you what I overheard tonight.”

She held her bra clutched to her small breasts one teasing moment longer before letting it fall to the floor with her dress.

“Seems like you’ve got a following among your male clients.”

Chrissy giggled. “Ha, I think they were actually talking about Catalina. Our names start with the same letter.”

“Har har.” I spooned up behind her, filling my hands with her soft swells. “I’m not joking. They actually picked you over Catalina. One guy actually said that he was now on *Team Chrissy*.”

Chrissy looked over her shoulder at me, brow raised. “Really? You sure?” Then: “Who was it?”

“I didn’t catch their names. I was in the stall.”

“Sneaky, sneaky.” She turned into me, pulling her tits out of my fondle. Our lips found one another’s, kissing heatedly. She pulled back just as things started going. “So how did it make you feel, hearing that?”

Aroused. Excited. Turned on, yet sick to my stomach? How could I tell her that?

“Proud,” I said instead. “After all, I’m captain of Team Chrissy. It’s nice to hear others want on.”

Chrissy stared at me long enough that I squirmed. That was probably the wrong thing to say. I should have acted more upset—

“So despite how things ended with Brigitte, hearing those guys doesn’t throw you into a jealous rage? I find that interesting.”

“You’re not Brigitte.” I winced at the comparison. I’d meant it to be a compliment, but instantly heard the opposite, so I tried clarifying. “It’s pretty cool, going home with the woman everyone wants.”

Her smile was cryptic. “Come on, let’s do some more unwrapping.”

She led me by the hand to the sofa in front of our tree, with only the colored lights illuminating her near-naked body. She untied my tie, once again looking up at me with that wide gaze. “So what else did they say about me?”

That surprised me a little. Chrissy was as excited by being talked about as I had been listening. “They loved your hair,” I said.

Chrissy yanked my tie off. “Me too,” she said. “You have no idea how many compliments I got tonight. I think I may keep it like this.”

“Fine by me.”

She went to work on the buttons of my shirt.

“One said that he always thought you were cute, but tonight...”

“Yeah?” She pulled open my shirt, peeling it off my arms.

“Tonight, he wished that you’d come alone so that he could take you home.” My breath caught as Chrissy sank to her knees without being prompted. She worked open my pants, her eyes never leaving mine. “He wanted to find out if the carpet matched the drapes.”

Chrissy giggled. "You men are so cute with your analogies." Dragging my boxers down, she took my cock in her hand and pumped me slowly. For the most fleeting of moments, I thought about watching Chrissy do this to another man. The jolt was unmistakable. Chrissy felt it down my length.

"What are you thinking about?"

"Nothing," I said, too quickly.

"Maybe something like this?" She wrapped her lips around my cock, slithering her tongue around the sensitive glans.

I groaned. "Yeah, that."

Pulling back, she said, "Or maybe you were thinking about me doing that to one of those guys."

I considered lying, but the evidence was in her hand. I couldn't deny it, so I said nothing.

Chrissy smirked. "Go on imagining whatever you want. My imagination will be at work, too."

With that, from her knees, she started blowing me. She kept looking up at me, but who was she thinking about? Me? Or a random client? Tom Park's face came to mind. He was fit and charming, the kind of guy who probably played the field. Was he one of the guys in the bathroom? I didn't know his voice well enough to tell.

After establishing a steady rhythm, Chrissy moved her hands from my cock to my ass. She steadied my hips and began bobbing her head along my shaft, quicker, deeper. She'd learned this art since we'd talked about it. Even when I hit the back of her throat, she kept things hands free, adjusting without pause.

Had she practiced this on more than just me? Once again, Tom Park was there, only this time, they were in Chrissy's office. She was on her knees, dressed in her feminine brand of business casual, sucking his dick as he ran his fingers through her hair. It occurred to me that one of the reasons her new cut was so sexy was that she looked like she'd just been fucked. Fucked by Tom Park?

"Oh, Chris," I groaned. It was all the warning I could muster. My knees went weak. My balls tightened. In vivid detail, I imagined a strange cock sinking into Chrissy's pussy. The image burned into my brain as I came.

Chrissy swallowed, her hands still on my ass, controlling the thrusts and spasms. Watching her throat muscles work to drink down my

excitement would never get old. Sinking back onto her feet, she finally released me.

Her normally sweet voice was hoarse. "So who did I just suck off?"

"Me."

Chrissy didn't believe me. That mischievous half-smile told all. "We can keep playing this game," she said. She pulled me into a deep kiss. I tasted the residuals of my come. It wasn't my favorite thing to taste, but if that was the price of the blowjob, I'd take it every time.

Following the kiss, she added, "I was thinking about Marc Chastain."

I tasted metal in my mouth. She was teasing me. She had to be. But it didn't make it any less sexy. "You're messing with me."

She lowered herself onto the sofa, pulling me with her. Her hand was on my cock, soft and slippery from her mouth. "You don't believe me? But the idea excites you, doesn't it?"

She squeezed my cock, and goddamn it, the thing started to harden again.

"You'd be here, too, hiding in the next room. Watching as I went to my knees and sucked his hard cock."

I grew again, despite all the odds. I felt like a twenty-year old, not someone pushing forty.

"In my fantasy, I'd just won him over to Team Chrissy. Not an easy feat with Brigitte Chastain as my competition. So sucking his cock is the least I could do, right?"

Who was this woman? And how much did she have to drink tonight?

"Think Marc would also want to know if the carpet matched the drapes?" She took my hand, placing it at the top of her thong.

"Chrissy..."

"He'd have to keep on wondering. You see, before I got my hair done, I had all the carpeting taken up."

At first, I didn't know what she was talking about. My mind was too overloaded with the situation to process more. She guided my hand beneath her thong, though, and where I expected to encounter her soft fur, I found nothing but smooth skin.

I looked up at her, wide-eyed. Chrissy just smiled. "How disappointed do you think he'd be?" she asked.

"Well..." I was practically shaking. This was something I'd always fantasized about, but had *never* mentioned to Chrissy. How did she know?

“A guy as hot as Marc,” she said, turning up the heat. “I bet he’d expect it, actually.”

“Yeah, the pig.” Trembling, I pushed two fingers into her bare pussy. She was soaking wet.

“Why don’t you pretend to be him and go check it out,” she said. The role-play broke down. There was my wife again. Kind of. She stared at me as I shifted back on the sofa and positioned her lengthwise. Grasping the sides of her thong, I pulled it off, revealing the smooth perfection that I’d felt a moment earlier. For the last decade and a half, as long as I’d known her, she’d always had a trimmed thatch of pubic hair. To see something so familiar not only styled differently, but completely bare, blew my mind.

I didn’t hesitate before diving between her thighs. I needed to feel it with my lips. I needed to run my tongue along the glistening slit and those beautiful, plump lips, now wickedly hair-free.

Chrissy gasped. “So...ahhh...sensitive.”

And so smooth, I thought. It was incredible. I slashed my tongue across her velvety mound, drawing more and more moans. Encouraged, I added my fingers to the tease.

Chrissy spread her legs wider, lifting one onto the back of the sofa as I traced chaos on her clit. She lifted her hips, forcing more of her pussy against my mouth. I curled my fingers up, finding the textured g-spot as I clamped my mouth over her sweet mound and sucked gently.

She jerked, throwing her head back and crying out. “Yes! Yes!” Her hands shoved me against her, her thighs shutting in around me. I didn’t relent, eating her through her orgasm, fingering her, flicking her clit, using my lips and mouth, my nose, my knuckles—everything I had to drive her higher.

“Okay. *Okay!*” She relented, suddenly pushing me away. “Too much. Too much!”

I gave her one last lick before sitting back. She was laughing when I was finally able to hear again. “Wow, that was...” She ran her hands through her hair. “Wow.”

I crawled up onto her, hesitating before kissing her. I didn’t go down on her a lot, but I always made sure to wipe my face before kissing her after. But she’d just kissed me, hadn’t she? I decided to go for it, pushing my tongue deep. If she objected, she didn’t show it. Instead, she kissed me back, just as intensely.

“Thank you...Marc.”

My heart clutched. A fist tightened in my gut. “Chris...”

“It’s okay, my husband is cool with it. In fact, he has this secret fantasy of sharing me.”

“No—”

“Oh, yes. He doesn’t think I know, but I figured it out.” She rolled us so that she was on top of me. Her fingers encircled my cock. “It gets him so excited thinking about me fooling around with other guys.”

She placed my cock against her pussy, stroking my once-again hard shaft with the smooth lips of her waxed pussy. I drew a breath that kept coming and coming. I wanted to sink into her softness, but she kept teasing me, using me like a dildo.

I looked up at her, our eyes meeting, heavy-lidded. She bit her lip and batted her lashes. I started to tell her how good it felt when she said, “So what do you say, Stephen? Mind if I get a little naughty in the Virgin Islands?”

She sank down on me. Her pussy felt like wet silk caressing my shaft. I exploded before I was fully inside of her, her question ringing in my ears.

Mind if I get a little naughty? I thought of walking in on Cole and Brigitte. Of watching how taken she was with Cole’s driving cock. She lived for that cock. She was a whore for it. Was that how I wanted to see Chrissy? This time, would I be able to handle it?

I rolled off of her, sputtering for air. Chrissy giggled beside me. “That a yes?”

I sighed. I didn’t know. I said as much. “I don’t know.”

She rolled onto her side and kissed my shoulder. “But it’s a fantasy.” She wasn’t asking. “To share me with another man, like you did with Brigitte.”

“We were young—”

“I know. And you were immature. And it eventually broke the two of you up. I’ve considered all of that. I don’t want to risk this. Us. But that doesn’t mean that it turns you on any less.”

Finally, after months—possibly years—of denial, I owned up to it, both to Chrissy and myself. “You’re right. I’m weird, I know.”

“No.” She kissed me softly. “No, not weird. We can’t help our fantasies, anymore than we can help our dreams.”

“I don’t deserve you,” I said. I drew her into a deep kiss, hoping to capture even a fraction of the love I felt for her in that moment.

When it ended, we were both out of breath. “Probably not,” she said, nuzzling my nose. “But I’m stuck with you, so what can I do?”

We kissed again.

“Oh, I know. When we visit the Virgin Islands, I could bring Marc over to Team Chrissy, no matter what it takes,” she said. “Nightie night, Captain.”

Chapter 8:

St. Thomas, VI

Christmas came and went in a blur. On New Year's Eve, we met up with some friends who had kids the same age as our own and had a family night in. And then it was the run-up to the big trip to the Virgin Islands—and more to the point, the further exploration of my fantasy.

I had a couple of dreams in those last few weeks. One was the standard one of Brigitte rising out of the water and untying her bikini. The other, though, was a haunting one of *what if*.

In the dream, we hadn't broken up. I was mature enough, confident enough to embrace the way her desires fed into my fantasies. Instead, I'd asked her to marry me, and she'd said yes. It was the present. We were both at the height of our careers. We lived in the house that I'd purchased with Chrissy. But we'd never had children—Brigitte didn't want them and I'd gone along with her wishes. Instead, we lived a lifestyle I'd often fantasized about when my kids in real life were being needy and I couldn't carve out even a minute of my own time. Brigitte and I went to dinner parties with other married-yet-childless couples. We took trips around the globe. We owned expensive cars and had expensive taste in wine. But the detail that stuck with me long after I'd woken and most of the details had faded was how I felt about her—I was deeply, profoundly in love with her.

The feeling wasn't real. I knew it wasn't. What happened had happened for a reason. Brigitte and I weren't a good match for one another.

That was the problem with the hypothetical. It didn't care about the constraints of reality or rationality. Hypotheticals specifically exist outside of those boundaries. In my dreams, I could wonder about that “perfect” life with Brigitte and for one moment, it felt real.

But my biggest fear? The one that kept me up at night—the one that had me conniving ways to get out of this trip? What if, after all these years, when I saw Brigitte again, I was just as madly in love with her as I had been at twenty-one?

“Our numbers are on the fridge. I left detailed instructions in that notebook on the kitchen counter. Um, what else—”

“Chrissy, we’ll be fine,” Chrissy’s mom said. Her Michigan accent was more pronounced than my wife’s, adding an air of earnestness to everything she said. “We raised you and your brothers, didn’t we?”

“Well, I was the only one to turn out perfect.”

Her mother’s laugh was nearly identical. “Go. Have fun on the beach. Don’t worry about us at all.”

“Thanks, Mom.”

“Thanks, Deirdre,” I said. “I’ll make sure she relaxes.”

The Christmas party experiment had worked, but in the end, we decided it would be better to have her parents stay at our house for the three nights we’d be gone, rather than sleep over at theirs. The kids could sleep in their own beds, play in their own parks, and eat in their own kitchen, with as minimal disruption as possible.

In fact, the disruption was so minimal—and seeing the grandparents was so exciting—that they barely acknowledged us when we kissed them goodbye.

“I think they’re going to be fine,” I said as we wheeled out bags out to the car.

“Oh, I know. It’s just hard to leave.”

I draped my arm around her. “For the next three and a half days, you’re no longer a mom. This life will be here when we return. Now let’s have some fun.”

*

It was 33 degrees at the airport when we left. It was 84 when we touched down in St. Thomas. That was the kind of thing that you could only prepare so much for when it was just a concept. Stepping into the heat of a foreign land really drove the point home: “We’re officially on vacation.”

It also made me wish that I hadn’t traveled in jeans and a sweater. Even without the sweater, in just a t-shirt, it felt oppressive. Being much smarter than me, Chrissy had traveled in a sundress, a pair of suede boots, and a winter coat. She stashed the coat with our luggage, exchanged the boots for sandals, put on her contacts so she could wear her sunglasses, and was ready to have fun.

“I can’t wait to get on the beach!” Chrissy said excitedly.

The taxi ride out to the hotel resort was breathtaking. The trees were different. The smells were different. Even the sounds were not like home. Everywhere we looked was worthy of a postcard. I don’t think I’d ever seen such crystal clear water, or white sandy beaches, or so much green.

We left the small town that passed as the main city, the view opening up to the sweeping arm of a crescent beach below. I turned to Chrissy. “Time for you to explore your telecommuting options.”

She laughed. “Seriously.”

We gawked at paradise for a few more minutes before Chrissy said, “So you nervous?” We both knew what she was referring to—my first meeting with Brigitte in over fifteen years.

“Honestly, yeah.”

Chrissy squeezed my hand. “Me too.”

“Why?”

She stared at me without answering right away. “I’m about to meet the girlfriend that my husband still dreams about, who was apparently some kind of sex goddess. Do you really have to ask?”

“Sorry.” She had a point. “It’s probably going to be anticlimactic anyway. Like, we’ll see her and she won’t even remember me.”

Chrissy snuggled against me. “I seriously doubt anyone could forget you. And besides, no matter how high a pedestal you’ve put her on, she’s still a person, and the early twenties are still formidable years.”

Maybe that’s what I was afraid of.

We arrived at Azure Cove Resort on the far side of the island with the sun still riding high. Attendants in white uniforms met us at the front door, taking our luggage and opening the doors to the airy atrium lobby with its red terracotta floors. A parrot was perched on the check-in desk. I thought it was fake until it squawked at us. Chrissy laughed.

“Welcome to St. Thomas,” said the man behind the desk. “My apology, but your room is still being prepared. We can have your things taken up while you enjoy a drink in our restaurant—on us.”

Chrissy looked at me with a smile, hugging my arm. “Sounds great,” she said for us.

“Says the woman wearing something appropriate for this weather,” I said.

“And whose fault is that? Come on, let’s get that drink.”

When I think of hotel restaurants, I think of the ones in upscale hotels back home—trendy establishments with dim ambiance and chic demeanors. I was completely unprepared for the restaurant at Azure Cove, although I shouldn't have been. Most of the restaurant was actually on the veranda looking out over the ocean, and while the white tablecloths gave it a high-end feel, it was more quaint than trendy. In other words, for us, it was perfect.

A late lunch crowd was sprinkled among the tables. The hostess led us to a spot right along the edge of the veranda, where we had a view of the pool below and the beach beyond.

"A server will be right along," she said.

"Okay, so maybe I *will* explore telecommuting," Chrissy said with a laugh.

"Yup, this is pretty much paradise. I think we've found it."

Our server came along, dressed in a white linen shirt—short-sleeved and untucked. I caught Chrissy looking him up and down as he introduced himself as Kay and asked us for our order. Kay was a good-looking guy, young, fit, with the darker complexion of the Caribbean.

"I'd love a strawberry daiquiri, Kay," said Chrissy.

"I'll take a pina colada."

"Coming right up," Kay said before disappearing toward the kitchen.

"Yeah, this is *definitely* paradise," Chrissy said. Then blushed.

That blush prompted a stirring inside me that wasn't entirely bad. Before I could frame a thought around the feeling, though, I saw a man enter who looked familiar enough to give me pause. At first, I couldn't place him—tall, black, handsome. He had close-cropped black hair with a part shaved down the left side, and an otherwise clean-shaven face. The khaki suit and tie-less shirt gave him a wealthy look in a very European way.

"Marc Chastain," I said as the name came to me. Brigitte's husband. I didn't mean to blurt it aloud and froze when I did.

"Where?" Chrissy asked, following my eyes.

Whether he heard me say his name, or just sensed two people looking at him, he looked at us with the same confused recognition I'd just felt. Then he smiled—the same white and welcoming smile I'd seen on Facebook—and crossed over to us.

"He's coming this way," Chrissy squeaked.

I was similarly stunned. This felt too surreal. Or too real. Or something.

“Allo,” Marc said when he was within range. His French accent wasn’t thick, but my American sensibilities were still having a hard time processing that accent coming from a black man. “We’ve not met, but I know of you two. I’m Marc Chastain, and you are Stephen Warren, *oui*?”

His accent was oddly British, beneath the French. But that made sense, since he probably learned English from a British—

Chrissy drove her elbow into my side, snapping me out of my wandering thoughts.

“Sorry, yes. I’m Stephen. That’s, um, me.”

“So that makes this beautiful woman Christine?”

“Chrissy.” She looked flustered. “Pleased to meet you, Marc. How do you know us?”

“Same way you recognized me, no doubt. Facebook?” He took Chrissy’s hands and shook them as one. “*Vous êtes ravissante.*”

Chrissy’s blush deepened. “I don’t know what that means, but thank you.”

To me, Marc offered his hand and gave me a handshake just a fraction too firm to be comfortable. “I must say, Stephen, you have great taste in women.”

It was hard *not* to read into a statement like that, so I read into it. I did not like this man.

“Thanks. Speaking of which, where’s Brigitte?” *Brigitte*. Just saying her name to someone other than Chrissy felt clumsy.

“She’s doing some bridal things.” He looked at his watch. “Right about now, they’re probably getting massages. May I join you two?”

I nodded, but I got the feeling that he would have sat anyway. When he took the open seat next to Chrissy, a tiny spike of jealousy worked its way through me. I looked toward the hotel, hoping that maybe our room would suddenly become available—that somehow, we could get out of this situation.

“So how long have you been here?” Chrissy asked.

“Just a couple days. We flew in on Tuesday.” Marc looked around. “It’s so calm here, although honestly, a little boring.”

“Not like New York,” Chrissy said.

“Or Paris. Or, if we’re talking islands, Ibiza.”

Chrissy laughed, looking at me as if to say, *He's so not like us.*

"What?" Marc asked, smiling good naturedly as he wondered whether he was the butt of some joke.

I answered for Chrissy. "When the most exciting thing to happen at night in the last year is changing sheets because your kid can't stop puking, then this place is like the most exciting spot in the world."

"It's all relative, I suppose," Marc said with a smile. His eyes drifted to Chrissy before snapping back to me. "But maybe we can make this holiday a little more exciting than that."

I looked at him sideways, but before I could puzzle the comment out, our drinks showed up. "Will you be joining them, sir?" the server asked.

"Yes. A Bellini please. And a carafe of water."

"Right away, sir."

Marc looked at the two of us. "Don't wait on me. Drink up. You're on holiday now."

"To being on *holiday*," Chrissy said, adding a British accent to the colloquialism.

"Here, here," I said, clinking glasses.

Chrissy sipped her daiquiri and looked out at the ocean. "How can you get bored of that view?"

"Perhaps I was being harsh. What I should have said was that there's only a small nightlife, and after awhile, it gets boring to just lounge on the beach. Personally speaking, I mean."

"But can't a nightlife also get boring?" Chrissy asked. "Going out every night. Drinking too much. Stumbling home. Being hungover the next morning. Seems like stuff for when we were younger."

"First of all, isn't it you Americans that say, *You're only as old as you feel?* Maybe we should go out tonight." He looked at me, too, adding, "All of us."

Chrissy said the thing that I was thinking, although mine would have been less of a flirty challenge. "Didn't you just say that there's nowhere to go here?"

"I said it was small. But there are still a couple of bars downtown."

I couldn't remember the last time we'd gone out like that—beyond the odd holiday party, which didn't really count. Then again, the last holiday party had proved really interesting.

“We’ll think about it,” I said. Worried that I’d disappointed Chrissy, I explained, “We haven’t even had a chance to settle in and enjoy all this. I’m still in my cold-weather clothes.”

“I’m also not sure how late I’ll be able to make it tonight,” Chrissy added. “We’re old.”

I was glad that Chrissy was on the same page as me.

Marc raised his hands, palms out. “Of course. No pressure either way. This is a holiday.”

Marc’s drink arrived. “Would you two like another round?” asked the server. Checking my drink, I realized that it was almost empty already.

“I’m good,” I said, at the same time Chrissy said, “Yes please.”

She looked at me and shrugged, like she was saying, *We’re on vacation!*

Before I could change my order, though, the server was gone again.

“How about another toast,” Marc said, raising his champagne cocktail. “To Elizabeth and Cornell, may they live happily ever after.”

Funnily, I kept forgetting their wedding was the reason we were here.

“Cheers to happy endings,” Chrissy said.

“So do you and Brigitte—” Still felt weird to say. “—see Lizzie a lot? Er, Liz, I guess is what she goes by?”

“That’s funny, Brigitte sometimes calls her Lizzie, too. And yes, we see her a lot. Actually, Brigitte introduced Cornell to Liz. Fun couple. We’re all in New York. His family’s from Connecticut and Brigitte has worked with them.”

“And what do you do, Marc?” Chrissy asked.

“A little of everything,” he said, leaning back into his chair.

“So you’re from a wealthy family and are living off your inheritance?” Chrissy had a way of saying stuff like that without being offensive. I think it was her sweet voice and that Michigan accent. Marc only laughed.

“No, my parents are still alive. There’s no inheritance. Yet.” He chuckled again. “I invest in businesses, mostly in the fashion industry. I buy things that interest me. Sometimes, they make me money. Sometimes, they do not.”

“Doesn’t sound like you’re very business savvy,” said Chrissy.

Marc grinned. “Maybe I’m just lucky.”

I was starting to feel like someone eavesdropping on their conversation. That spike of jealousy wasn’t so little anymore. Marc seemed

to sense it, turning to me. “What about you, Stephen. What do you do? You don’t put much on Facebook.”

“I’m a software developer. We build custom CRMs for small businesses that don’t want something off-the-shelf but can’t afford something like an Oracle solution.” I heard myself spewing techno-babble and stopped. How banal must I sound to Marc? “Anyway, I get to work from home, which is a nice perk.”

“Definitely. Sometimes I wish that I had that luxury,” Marc said. I couldn’t tell if he was humoring me or not. “And you, Chrissy? You’re in marketing?”

“Yeah. I sell other people’s good ideas.” She giggled. “But I do it pretty well, if our numbers are any indication.” She clapped her hands over her mouth. “Sorry, this daiquiri must be stronger than I thought.”

Right on queue, her refill arrived. The server also handed me a keycard. “Sir, I overheard you mentioning that you wanted to change out of your jeans, so I checked on your room. It’s ready if you want to head up.”

“Thanks,” I said.

“The drinks are on the house. There’s no tab to settle.” He checked on Marc’s drink, saw that it was still mostly full, and left.

Annoyed that he hadn’t asked me if I wanted another drink, I tucked the keycard into my jeans and picked up my water.

“Please, change into something more comfortable,” Marc said. “I’ll keep your wife company.”

My gut constricted at the thought—leave Chrissy alone with Marc? They were already flirting, and I was sitting right beside them. What would happen if they were alone?

“Go ahead, honey,” Chrissy said. “You’ll feel much better.”

I saw the mischief in her eyes. We’d talked about Marc a couple times since the night of her holiday party, but none of it was serious. This was just her playing with me.

I stood and kissed her. “Okay, I’ll be right back.”

“Take your time,” Marc said. “Relax.”

As I turned my back on them and left the restaurant, it was almost as if something was physically holding me back. Relax, I reminded myself. Relax.

We'd paid for an ocean view room and were not disappointed. The resort was only five stories, each featuring a large balcony that was appointed with beach chairs and an outdoor bar. Our room was on the fourth floor.

The doors to the balcony were open when I entered, a warm salty breeze ruffling the gauzy curtains that kept the sun out. Our suitcases were lined up along the short hall. I grabbed the largest, pulled it over to the bed, and unzipped it.

As much as I hated leaving Chrissy in the company of a guy like Marc, the prospect of putting on shorts was too tempting to pass up. My legs were sweltering in the jeans, and even my t-shirt felt grimy after all the travel.

I stripped down to my boxers before pulling out a pair of shorts and a linen shirt. As I did so, a couple of Chrissy's things tumbled out. Lacy little things that I didn't immediately recognize. My cock twitched. Unable to help myself, I laid them out—a black thong with a white lace trim, a matching bra. It had a vaguely French maid look. *Oo la la*.

And with that thought, unintentionally, came one of Marc with his French accent. I looked down at the lingerie, now imagining Chrissy wearing them, spread out on the bed. Where I stood was Marc, admiring her tight little body as she looked up at him, playing with her tousled hair.

I felt this tingling along my scalp, fuzzy, hot, and slightly uncomfortable. With it came reluctant excitement. My cock responded, starting to harden.

I pulled on my shorts and shirt before realizing how wrinkled the linen had become in the suitcase. Stubbornly, rather than concede and grab another t-shirt, I went to the closet and pulled out the ironing board.

"What are you doing, man?" I said aloud as I waited for the iron to warm up. Outside, Marc was inevitably flirting with a tipsy Chrissy—a Chrissy who had admitted to being attracted to the black Frenchman—and here I was, doing the most domestic thing I could possibly do while on vacation.

The answer was rooted in that tingling I felt at the back of my skull. I knew nothing would happen, but the danger that something could felt like a drug. My hands shook on the iron. My heart raced.

By her own admission, her daiquiris were strong, and she was on her second—if not third. Marc Chastain knew what he was doing, too. He'd gotten Brigitte to promise to spend the rest of her life with him, after all.

Compared to that, seducing Chrissy would have been like getting a cat to purr.

But that's what made him safe, right? Why would he possibly risk losing Brigitte?

I winced at the implication: why would he possibly risk losing Brigitte *for my wife*. Was that how I really felt?

I pulled my shirt on without buttoning it, and walked out onto the balcony. With the breeze, the temperature was basically the same outside as it was in. I could see us lounging out here before bed, enjoying a drink, making love with the sound of the ocean in the background.

Crossing closer to the edge, the resort's grounds spread out before me, better than a map. There was the large pool with its own bar and lagoon. Between the pool and the beach was a carefully maintained patch of "jungle," cut with winding paths and little, private clearings that afforded quieter spaces than the pool. Beyond that was the beach, which cut a white and wide swath around the bay. It truly was paradise here.

I barely saw any of it. My attention went right to the restaurant's veranda, set off to my right. I could just make out Chrissy and Marc, sitting with their backs to me, looking out at the view. Chrissy looked like she was laughing. My insides withered.

And yet despite the unease, my boxers grew tight as I started to harden. It was listening to those guys at the holiday party all over again. It was me in a room with Brigitte as she screamed another man's name. My lungs felt like paper, unable to hold enough breath. I grasped the railing.

Chrissy shook her head, mouthing what looked like, *No way!* She laughed. Marc nodded. Reaching out, he placed a hand on her arm—her bare arm—to emphasize a point. Chrissy didn't remove his hand, or even react to the touch, and it was gone as quickly as it arrived. To me, the man may as well have punched me in the stomach.

I faded back into the shade of the balcony and finished buttoning my shirt. I'd played with fire long enough. Time to get things back under control.

When I did make it down to the restaurant, though, they were gone.

Panic seized me like a wild animal clawing its way out of my chest. I swooned, grabbing the jamb of the French doors that led outside. My imagination immediately went to the worst place—Marc's room, where he

had Chrissy stripped naked on the bed, his big, black cock driving into her tight pussy.

My vision grew dizzy before I remembered to breathe.

“Everything okay, sir?” It was our server, checking on me before I hit the floor.

“Um, yes. Sorry. Just getting used to the heat.”

“I understand. Can I get you some water?”

“No thanks.” He nodded and started to leave. “Actually, my wife and the man who’d joined us...can you tell me where they went?”

“I’m sorry, sir. I don’t know. They just left though. Perhaps they went to the pool?”

“Thanks.” I practically ran out of there, headed back to the atrium lobby. I followed the signs for the pool, took the wide staircase two steps at a time, and found myself rushing out poolside.

With the sun just past its zenith, the pool was still pretty crowded. Women sunbathed topless. Bronzed skin glistened everywhere I looked. The bikinis were all skimpy and the guys seemed to fall into two camps: young and buff, or older and moneyed. Azure Cove wasn’t a family resort.

I didn’t see either of them there. I scanned the place again. And again. Not at the bar. Not lounging in the sun. Not wading in the pool. They weren’t there.

Beyond was the cultivated greenery that separated the pool loungers from the beach. At ground level, the trees looked so much more dense than from above. I thought of all those secret little clearings, thought of the benches designed to sit and have a quiet moment. Had Marc pulled her into a secluded spot, away from prying eyes? Away from me?

I thought about texting her, but our phones had no reception here. I had absolutely no way of getting in touch with her. The panic returned, this time accompanied by irrational fear. Did the resort have a P.A. system? I heard soft music filtering through the place, surely I could utilize that to call her.

I ran my hands through my hair, turning in a circle before looking back at the resort. I looked up at the guest rooms, at all those empty balconies. If he was going to seduce her, that was the most obvious of place to do it—in the privacy of his own room, where he could take his time stripping her out of her little sundress, where he could lay her back on his bed and enter her with the gauzy curtains to shield their adultery.

What the hell was I even thinking? How did my thoughts arrive here, worried that Chrissy was off cheating on me?

But I knew why. All I had to do was close my eyes and I was twenty again, walking into the bedroom as Cole fucked Brigitte. The memory decimated me—it *always* decimated me. And as always, in its aftermath was that inexplicable fascination.

Acknowledging my paranoia helped squelch it. Chrissy and Marc were not off somewhere hooking up. Chrissy wouldn't do that, and I felt ashamed that I'd even gone there.

With that in mind, I wandered back toward the lobby. I'd just go to our room. If she wasn't there now, she'd eventually be.

Now that I had a goal in mind, I crossed the lobby, already thinking about the room. Maybe even a shower. I got halfway to the elevators when I heard my name being called.

"Stevie. Stevie!"

At first, I thought that it was Chrissy, finding me at last, despite the fact that she rarely called me "Stevie" and the voice was all wrong. I turned, searching the lobby for my wife. Instead, I found Brigitte.

Only I barely recognized her despite the months of dreams and all the time lurking on social media. All the memories and photos paled in comparison to Brigitte in person.

This wasn't the way I'd imagined our first meeting. I needed more time to prepare. To shower. To recover from the panic attack I'd just had. And definitely to make sure that Chrissy was with me. I wanted to run away, but then Brigitte was crossing the lobby to me and it was too late.

I made a mental note that when I told Chrissy about this meeting later, I'd assure her that the Brigitte in real life was nothing like the one I'd held on to all these years—that she was pretty, sure, but she was still a woman susceptible to age and time. Thing was, it wasn't true. If anything, the blonde striding toward me with a thousand-watt smile exceeded the fantasy. Dressed in a short, green sundress and a pair of towering heels, even the way she moved seemed like a model.

"It's so good to see you!" Brigitte said. "You look great!"

So do you, I stuttered inside my head at first. More than her stride, or her dress, or even her killer body, the thing that I couldn't stop staring at was her eyes—the color of sunlight through green-blue glass. They transported me back to that magical summer, to the first time we'd kissed.

I took a fortifying breath and put on a smile. Then repeated the words in my head, only more confidently. “So do you! I barely recognized you, Brigitte. It’s been so long.”

We hugged. I was acutely aware of how different she felt than Chrissy—taller, bustier, even her perfume was a reminder. I felt her survey me in that embrace, too, and was glad that I’d been hitting the gym recently. Did she approve of my arms? Did she notice that I had no paunch?

“I guess that means that you didn’t recognize me at all.” Behind Brigitte came another voice, sarcastic, yet apologetically so.

It’s funny, I hadn’t even noticed that Brigitte was with anyone at all. Now that I looked, I discovered that we were hardly alone. She was with a group of women, including the bride-to-be, Lizzie Burke.

“Lizzie!” I said, slightly embarrassed that I’d completely overlooked her. We hugged. “You’re right, I *didn’t* recognize you. You look amazing.”

She did, too. She’d always been attractive in a girl-next-door kind of way—much like Chrissy. She still had that look—tall, slender, coltish—only everything had been refined with a touch of glamour.

“Thanks, *Stevie*.” Her laugh was the same laugh that I remembered from school. “Look all you want, but you missed your chance.”

Even after all these years, heat welled up under my collar. “Congratulations, Liz.”

“Thank you, Stephen.” She pulled me into a hard embrace. “Thanks for flying all this way. Means so much to me.”

“Of course. It’s hard to believe that it’s been so long since I last saw you. You haven’t even met my kids.”

“Seriously,” Liz agreed. “Let’s not do that again.”

“Deal.” I looked at the rest of the group, not recognizing any of them. “You all look like you’re headed somewhere. I don’t want to keep you.”

“But we’ll see you tomorrow night?” Liz asked.

I had no idea what she was talking about, but Chrissy had been handling our RSVPs and itinerary. So naturally I said, “You will. See you tomorrow.”

“You girls go on up,” Brigitte said. “I’ll be right behind you.”

Liz glanced at me, then Brigitte, then back at me. A smile tugged at the corners of her lips. “Alright then.”

“I’m so glad that you came out,” Brigitte said when we were alone. I hated to admit it, but hearing her say that made my heart swell. “It’s funny,

but I'd been thinking about you, even before I saw that you were coming. I was going to reach out to you, but it always felt weird."

"Really? I was kind of thinking the same thing. Fate, I guess."

"Maybe fate. Yeah," she said.

Brigitte looked at me thoughtfully. Again, I was struck by how beautiful she was. Her hair was blonder than I remembered, catching the light of the sun-filled atrium as it fell around her shoulders in loose waves.

Brigitte went on. "So are you here with your wife?"

"Oh, yes. Chrissy. Actually, we ran into your husband. They're off together somewhere. I think."

"Oh?" Brigitte lifted an eyebrow. My heart skipped. I didn't like that response. She was either jealous, or something else—the *something else* scared me more.

"We were waiting for our room to be finished, having a drink on the patio, when we saw him. I recognized him from your Facebook photos."

"You've been looking at my Facebook photos, huh?" She smiled at my nervousness. "It's okay, we've been lurking on yours. You've got a gorgeous family. Did you bring the kids?"

"Just us."

"First trip without them?"

I felt more relaxed now that we were talking about the kids. "Yeah. Well, we took one when we only had the one child, but haven't since our second was born."

"Do you miss them?"

I hadn't expected to hear such empathy from Brigitte. Being a married professional without kids, I'd expected her to be more judgmental of those who had them. "I don't miss them yet. But it's definitely weird not having someone tugging at your leg."

"Well, welcome to being on vacation, Stephen. We'll make sure to keep you distracted enough that you won't miss them too much."

"Sounds fun."

"You better go find your wife. Marc's a gentleman, but I've also seen what she looks like." I was about to ask what that meant when she put an arm on my shoulder and squeezed. That scrambled my brain. "I'll see you later, 'kay?"

She left me, her tall heels clicking across the terracotta tile. I stared at her ass, admiring the way her dress clung to it. Fate, I thought again, and

with it, the *What If* thoughts.

No, don't go there. I touched my forehead and sighed, feeling like I'd just shouldered my way through a tornado funnel. A guy pulling a giant roller bag grinned at me as he passed. "Have fun," he said.

The buzz of the pina colada was long gone. The intoxication I felt in Brigitte's presence faded. Left alone, I remembered my wife. Guilt welled up. I needed to find her. Needed to hold her and remind myself of how good I had it.

But where was she? How could I hold her if I didn't know where she was? Brigitte's warning returned: *You better go find your wife. Marc's a gentleman, but I've also seen what she looks like.* It squeezed the air from my lungs.

Back to the original plan, I headed for the room. I took the stairs to the fourth floor, rather than be forced to wait for the elevator's slow ascent. It felt good to move. I welcomed the burn in my legs as I took the stairs two at a time. Down the hall, I nearly ran. I was out of breath when I slid the keycard into the lock and heard the door beep.

Chrissy was standing inside the room, a towel wrapped around her body and another in her hair. I could smell the shower. Steam still drifted out of the bathroom. I scanned the room, half-expecting to see Marc emerge, also dressed in nothing but a towel.

"There you are," Chrissy said. "I was wondering what happened to you."

"Funny, I could say the same about you."

"How so?"

Chrissy pulled her towel off her head and raked her fingers through her damp hair. Wet, it almost reached her shoulders. It had been a month, but I was still getting used to how short she kept it.

"After coming back up here to change, I went back down to the restaurant, but you weren't there."

Chrissy looked up at me, finally understanding what I was getting at. She drifted across the room to me. "I see. You thought that maybe something happened between me and Marc?"

My pants tightened. There was that squeezing on my chest again. "Well, when I left, you two were flirting pretty hard."

Chrissy beamed, her lips parting in a delighted smile. "Disappointed that nothing did?"

“I...” The whole thing was still embarrassing to me. “That would be silly.”

“Don’t worry, honey. There’s still plenty of vacation left.” Chrissy went onto her toes and kissed me softly on the lips. At the same time, her hand moved between my legs. “Mmm, you like that idea.”

“I think that has more to do with you in just a towel.” It wasn’t exactly a lie—Chrissy did look good.

Chrissy stepped back. “Then maybe I should ditch the towel?”

With a tug, she pulled open the towel and dropped it to the floor. I looked her up and down, that stirring in my pants turning into a full on erection. Her skin was still pink from her shower, fresh and clean smelling. Her nipples were swollen. Her pussy was once again free of hair—I looked up at her, surprised. I swore she’d said she was done with waxings and had let the curls grow back in over the last month.

I looked up at her. She giggled at my confusion. “I just shaved it.” She batted her lashes innocently, adding, “For Marc.”

I stepped up to her, pulling her against me, kissing her hard. I ran my hands down her body, feeling her just-washed skin, collecting her heart-shaped ass. Our kiss intensified.

Unable to resist any longer, I touched her pussy, brushing my fingers over her smooth lips. She was wet. Either she’d been thinking of Marc when she’d done this, or the act of shaving had gotten her excited. Either way, it was almost as hot to feel her excitement as it was to feel her bald mound.

“You like that, don’t you?” said Chrissy. She pulled me back to the bed. “Show me.”

I’d gone down on her a few times since her waxing in December—definitely more than was usual—but it had been a while since the last time. I found I couldn’t resist now. Not with the tempting sight of Chrissy on the bed, her legs spread wide, her pussy glistening. I got on my knees and dove between her thighs. She was just as smooth as she’d been post-waxing. Must have been a sharp razor.

She threaded her fingers through my hair. “So Marc is pretty hot, don’t you think?”

I must have reacted, because I heard Chrissy giggle above me. She didn’t release my head to answer though.

“Charming, too. He offered to walk me back to my room.”

I groaned. I wished that I'd taken off my pants. Things were getting uncomfortable down there.

"Maybe I should have taken him up on the offer. Maybe I could have invited him in while we waited for you—oh yes, right...ha...right there."

I curled my fingers up against her g-spot as I teased her clit with the tip of my tongue. I didn't know what *there* was, so I did more of both.

"Do you think he kisses with the same confidence?" She spread her legs wider. "Mmm, that's really good, baby."

I couldn't take it any longer. I pulled my face out of her legs and rose, fumbling with my belt. Chrissy didn't complain. If anything, she looked as eager as I felt.

I yanked my pants down, my cock springing free. Chrissy grabbed it as I crawled over her, stroking it as she placed it against her cunt. Our eyes met as I eased into her, easily sinking into her slippery embrace.

"Uh, you feel huge!" Chrissy said with a half-laugh. "Is that because I shaved, or because I let Marc kiss me?"

My stomach cratered. I rammed the rest of the way home. He'd kissed her?!

Chrissy pulled my head against her shoulder, rolling her hips to meet mine. Her moans grew. I was torn between feelings of betrayal and profound excitement. I fucked her hard for both of those reasons.

"Yes, baby! Just like that. You feel so good."

I growled, taking her harder. "You kissed him?!"

"He kissed...me. Uh!"

I came before I knew what was happening, shocked that I'd barely lasted two minutes. I kept pumping my hips even as my balls emptied, trying to stay hard, trying to save face. But there was no denying it. I'd just lost it, thinking of my wife with someone else.

I was sapped after the orgasm. I collapsed at Chrissy's side, breathing hard, my mind dizzy. I closed my eyes, seeing Marc pulling my wife into his arms—seeing their lips meet. The vision seared through me, dredging up the memories of Brigitte and Seth and Cole.

"He kissed me on the cheeks. European style." She rolled to her side, facing me. "But your mind went other places. Interesting reaction."

"It's... Yeah, I don't know."

"You really thought I'd kiss someone else?" she asked.

“No. I know you wouldn’t. But...” *You could if you wanted to.* I bit my tongue before said that out loud. “I don’t think any of this is exactly rational.”

I immediately wished that I’d been more honest.

“True.” She kissed me. “I liked what it brought out, though. That was fun.”

I colored. “Sorry about that.”

“Don’t be.” We lay there for a bit before she said, “So where were you?”

I thought about my encounter with Brigitte and felt guilty again. “First, I was looking for you. When you weren’t at the restaurant, I checked the pool. Then...I decided to just wait for you up in the room.” I decided to leave out the part where I freaked out. “But on the way to the room, I ran into Lizzie and Brigitte with the other bridesmaids.”

“Oh? You saw Brigitte?”

My body grew uncomfortably warm. “Yeah. She was coming in from some bridal thing. We talked a few minutes, then they were on to the next thing.”

“So was she as hot as she is in your dreams?”

Hedge here, I reminded myself. “She’s alright. Nothing like my dreams, but the years haven’t been terrible.”

Chrissy laughed. “You’re a bad liar, you know that?” She hauled herself out of bed. “Come on, take a shower with me. Then I can show off my new bikini.”

*

Chrissy’s bikini was amazing—made of some kind of brown knit material designed for style over functionality, it was held together at her hips and between her breasts by gold rings that made me want to grab and tug. It wasn’t as skimpy as many of the swimsuits on display at the resort, but it was also clearly outside of Chrissy’s usual comfort zone. That was a good thing.

By the time dinner rolled around, we were wiped. We considered just ordering room service and crashing, but how both of us decided that was a waste. How often did we have the opportunity to go out as a couple, without kids to worry about or a sitter to coordinate?

The concierge recommended something close by. We changed into casual clothing and grabbed a cab. Even casual, though, Chrissy looked stunning. Her top had that cool, yogi look to it—long and sleeveless—while the skinny jeans always looked good on her. Her contacts were long gone, but I loved her in glasses.

“This has been great,” I said over dinner. We shared a creole-inspired dish and a bottle of wine to celebrate the first true date we’d had in forever.

“Yeah. We should do this at least once a year—a trip, just you and me.”

I took her hands and squeezed them. She’d put on enough makeup that I noticed. It sparkled around her eyes, and her lashes looked thick and dark. It was nice to see her make such an effort, even though she was pretty enough that she didn’t need to.

I said, “Meeting you has been the best thing to ever happen to me. How did I get so lucky?”

“We’re both the lucky ones. Thank God Brigitte cheated on you.” She bit her lip, realizing what she’d said. Even after all these years, that stung. “I’m sorry,” she said. “I shouldn’t have said that.”

“No, don’t apologize. It’s fine.”

Chrissy nudged her glass of wine away from her and reached for her water. “I’m cutting myself off. I’m such a lightweight.”

“Yes, you are.” I laughed. “But it’s fine, seriously. It happened. What’s past is past. Can’t change that. And if she hadn’t done that...well, everything would be different now.”

Chrissy was quiet a long moment, studying me. “That was *the* defining moment in your life.”

I nodded.

“That’s where the fantasy comes from,” she said, just as matter-of-factly.

She reached out and took my hand. “You don’t have to be ashamed, or afraid. Not with me, honey.”

I tried to relax. She was right. If I could trust anyone with this, it was Chrissy. “I’m sorry. I’m still trying to figure it out myself.”

“Let’s figure it out together.”

“Okay.”

Despite her earlier proclamation, Chrissy took a sip of her wine before continuing. “I think that it all comes back to Brigitte. She was your first true

love. She defined what that means. She was also...sexually adventurous, you could say.”

“Yes, but I don’t see how that’s got anything to do with it.”

“Don’t you see? When she...cheated on you—when you walked in on her with Cole—a part of you...changed. Or was redefined or something.”

“So you think I get off on the cheating?”

“Yes.”

Her blunt answer hit me like a sucker punch. I hesitated before denying it—but I did deny it. “No way. I broke up with her, remember?”

“You did. I’m not saying that you were okay with it. Just that a part of you got turned on by it. And that’s stayed with you all these years.”

I had to admit, a lot of it rang true. But still, there was one problem. “But it was still cheating. I don’t think I could ever get past that, fucked up fantasy or not. She lost my trust when she did that.”

Chrissy nodded. “Yeah, I know. I wouldn’t be able to, either.”

“Honestly, if she’d just asked, maybe I would have been fine with it.” This was the wine talking, but I didn’t stop myself. I let it play out. “You know, a quick phone call. *Hey, mind if I hook up with Cole?* Something like that.”

“You really think so?”

“I don’t know. It’s hard to say what the twenty-year-old me would have thought, I guess. But she’d already slept with Cole—more than once. I’d watched. I’d participated. And yes, I’d been turned on watching the two of them go at it.” I finished off my glass of wine. “The thirty-seven-year-old me would totally be into it.”

Chrissy stared at me quietly for the longest time, unpacking the meaning in that statement. At last, she leaned in and looked me right in the eyes. “So Stephen, mind if I fuck Marc?”

My jaw dropped. I blinked. Had she really just asked that? Had *Chrissy* just asked that? When I spoke, it sounded like my voice was someone else’s. “Is that a real question?”

“Do you want it to be?”

“Yes,” I said. “And yes.”

Chrissy inhaled sharply, held the breath, and released it in a rush. “Come on, let’s get out of here.”

I had every intention of fucking Chrissy’s brains out. I was so charged. But by the time we retired to the hotel, neither one of us had the energy for

another round. The mind was willing, but our bodies just wanted sleep.

*

The next day was our free day. The wedding was tomorrow and we had nothing to do but be on vacation. We woke up, made love before breakfast and lounged on the beach afterwards. We had lunch at a local deli a five-minute walk down the beach, and marveled at how good life on this island could be.

Oh yeah, and we talked a lot about the possibility of Marc—and the fantasy in general.

“So how long have you been fantasizing about Marc, anyway?” I asked over lunch.

“Since I saw his photo on Facebook?” She laughed when I bugged out at that, throwing a potato chip at me. “Oh, come on, I’m a red-blooded human being, and Marc Chastain is attractive.”

“Do you have any other crushes that I don’t know about?”

“Do you?” she shot back with a smirk. “That’s not really a fair question and you know it. None that you should worry about.”

I laughed. “So I should be worried about Marc?”

“Well, you *did* give me permission to sleep with him last night.”

Talking about it like this was easier than I thought it would be, but reminders like that would always spike my pulse. “So that wasn’t something I dreamed.”

“Not unless we dreamed it together. Want to take it back?”

“That wouldn’t be very fair of me,” I said.

She took on a sincere tone. “This isn’t about what’s fair or not. It’s about us. What we have. If you have doubts, tell me now.”

“So you’re actually going to go through with it,” I stated. Felt official like that.

“Well, I mean, I like having the option.” She giggled. “But, I mean, he still needs to be willing. You could give me permission to sleep with Matt Damon, but that wouldn’t bring me any closer to making it happen.”

“I watched the two of you yesterday. I think you got pretty close all by yourself,” I said. “So what is it about him?”

She leaned in and whispered, “I’ve never been with a black guy before.”

“Really? As a bleeding-heart liberal, aren’t you supposed to be color-blind?”

Chrissy shrugged. “Color blindness is passé. We have a black president. It’s okay to talk about race.”

“How enlightened. I think you just want to know whether what they say is true about black men.”

Chrissy blushed. “Well, he’s kept Brigitte satisfied, so he must be doing something right.”

“So this is really a thing that we’re doing?” I asked.

“Only if you’re comfortable with it.”

I took a deep lungful of ocean air. “We’re on vacation. Let’s live a little.”

*

After lunch, we headed to the pool. The sky was cloudless, the sun shining down at us in the high, blue sky. Perfect weather for doing nothing but relaxing. We weren’t the only ones with this idea, and when we arrived at the poolside, it was packed. As we carried our towels and sun gear around, looking for a spot to sit, we ran into the future bride and groom.

Liz looked spectacular in her white bikini, but that wasn’t surprising. The real surprise was her fiancé, Cornell Mann. I’d expected a broad-shouldered prepster with combed blond hair and a dimpled chin. I couldn’t have been more wrong. Cornell was of Indian descent, dark haired, dark skinned, and very far from the upper-crust New England stock I’d imagined. Stripped down to just his swimming trunks, though, I saw that I’d at least been right about the broad shoulders thing. And there was no doubt that he was a great match for Liz.

It occurred to me just how preoccupied I’d been with Brigitte and my fantasy this trip. The fact that we were here for Liz’s wedding was so much of an afterthought to me that I hadn’t even bothered to look up the man who was about to marry a good friend of mine. That made me an asshole.

“Hey, Liz,” I said. “You remember my wife, Chrissy?”

“Of course. Nice seeing you again. Love your hair.”

Chrissy touched her shorter cut. “Thank you. I’m still getting used to it.”

“I know what you mean.” Liz’s dark hair was fashioned into a bob, longest at her chin, short around the back of her neck. “Still trying to decide if I like it this short.”

As the women discussed hair, Cornell stuck his hand out to me. “Nice to finally meet you, Stephen. Thank you for flying all the way out here.” He spoke with a slight British accent—so I felt a little better about the preppy pretense thing.

“Congratulations, Cornell. You’re a lucky man.”

He put his arm around Liz in that possessive way that some men did and I hated. “I know it,” he said. “Liz is the best thing to happen to me.”

The women shared a look, but Liz just snuggled into him. “It’s true,” she said. “I am.”

“So you two ready for the big day?” Chrissy asked.

Cornell looked at Liz with a smile. They looked so lovely together. Liz said, “We’ve been planning this so long, it’s kind of weird that it’s tomorrow.”

“It’ll go fast, too,” Chrissy said. “Remember to take a moment and enjoy it.”

Something caught my eye behind Liz and Cornell. I looked just in time to see Brigitte break the surface of the water. She rested her arms on the edge of the pool, slicked her blond hair back, and found me looking at her. She smiled, waved, and then hoisted herself out of the water.

It was my dream all over again, although her bikini wasn’t turquoise but white with bright flowers printed across it. Water cascaded across her voluptuous curves. Her full breasts strained against the bikini top and she flipped her hair out of her face. Her stomach was flat, her belly button pierced with a silver bar. The bikini bottoms sat low on her wide hips, the gap at her hip bones tantalizing me.

My jaw may have dropped open as she sashayed over to us. This time, Chrissy really *did* drive her elbow into my side. “You’re drooling, dear,” she mumbled.

I quickly looked at Chrissy, who was staring just as hard at my ex-girlfriend. Here was the woman she’d considered her competition over the last few months, and in person, Brigitte was about as intimidating as she could have been.

“Hey, there, Stevie.” I winced at the pet name. “And you must be Chrissy. It’s so great to finally meet you. I’m Brigitte.”

As Chrissy shook Brigitte's hand, the awkwardness of the moment was almost palpable. "Hi, Brigitte. Nice to meet you, too."

She sounded upbeat, but I knew my wife well enough to tell she was totally faking it.

"You two looking for a place to sit?" Brigitte went on, oblivious.

"It's pretty crowded," I said. "We might go down and hit the beach again instead."

"Nonsense. Here, take my spot. I was about to head out, anyway. We've got a few wedding things to get to."

"You sure?" I asked. My eyes traveled with her as Brigitte moved to a lounge. She grabbed the towel and mercifully wrapped it around herself.

"It's either you take it, or some stranger," she said.

Liz and Cornell were collecting their things, too. "Enjoy the afternoon," Liz said. "Relax and rest."

As they were leaving, Brigitte turned back to us. "We'll see you tonight, right?"

It was Chrissy who actually answered for us. "We'll be there."

"Great! See you then."

"Well that wasn't awkward at all," Chrissy said with a forced chuckle. She turned to me. "*The years haven't been terrible*, huh? She's basically any wife's worst nightmare."

I played dumb. "You think so?"

Chrissy glared at me. "That's right, Stephen. Your dream girl is now officially my nightmare."

"She's not my dream girl."

Chrissy laughed. This time, it felt less strained. "Actually, she literally is your dream girl, remember?"

"I'm sorry."

She sighed. "It's fine. I mean, I should have guessed. I saw her photos. I met her husband. She's a genuine Barbie Doll."

"I love you. You know that, right?"

Chrissy laughed. "Sometimes, you can be such a man." She pulled off her cover-up, revealing her own bikini-clad body. "This just means I'm going to have to up my game."

Chapter 9:

The List

Later that night, Chrissy demonstrated exactly what she meant. Since this was a destination wedding, we were all invited out to a “rehearsal dinner” gathering at one of the clubs in town. Mostly, it was an excuse to go out and party—something Chrissy and I hadn’t done in forever.

Chrissy went all out for the evening. I couldn’t take my eyes off her ass, squeezed into a pair of skin-tight white pants, and an awesome, black cowl-necked tank top that I’d never seen before.

“You look great,” I said, running my hand up under the tank top to feel the smooth skin of her lower back.

“I think I should have kept the contacts in.”

Since we were going to be out so late, she’d wavered on whether to switch to glasses or not. I encouraged her to take out her contacts and put on her stylish, dark-framed specs. “I think the glasses make you look sexy.”

It wasn’t a lie—not even a white one. Something about her with her hair pulled back and those glasses turned me on.

“Uh huh. You say that until we see how glammed up the bridal party is.”

Fretting about her choice of corrective eyewear was easier than thinking about the real source of anxiety for the evening: Marc would be there. We’d dodged an encounter earlier in the day, by the pool, but he’d be there tonight for sure.

“You ready?” Chrissy asked.

“Yeah. You?”

Her eyes looked huge. “I’m nervous.”

“Me too. But remember, only you and I know about the fantasy. Just go with the flow.”

“And if the flow leads me back to Marc’s room?”

My mouth dried up. I took a measured breath. “Just let me know ahead of time.”

Chrissy nodded. “Come on, let’s party.”

Cabana House was more of a bar-turned-club than a club in the traditional sense. Walking in, I could almost imagine how it must look during the day—tables set out where the dance floors were, adorned with candles and tented drink menus, servers taking orders, tourists putting them in. By eleven, though, the tables were gone, the lights turned low, and a DJ spun house music through the transformed space.

It felt like we were stepping into another world. Neither of us had been to a club in a long time, and certainly not starting past ten at night. I thought I'd be tired, but the prospect of the night, coupled with the wall of sound we stepped through, buoyed me.

We searched the floor for our wedding party, finding them in a small, roped off area. I recognized Brigitte right away, wearing the kind of dress I didn't even bother fantasizing that Chrissy would wear. It was short, lacy, and fit her like a glove.

Marc stood next to her, looking every much her match. Where Brigitte was pale, he was dark. Where Brigitte was slim, Marc was toned. I thought of how good the two of them must look having sex—I couldn't help it. They were like the epitome of masculinity and femininity.

Chrissy pressed up next to me. "Yeah, definitely should have stuck with contacts." She squeezed my hand. "And a dress, too."

"No way," I reassured. "I told you, I love the glasses."

"Well, whatever. Takes the nerves off. No way can I compete with that," Chrissy said.

Now that was something that I hated to agree with, but did. I felt a weight lift from my shoulders, especially when I watched Marc's hand move down and caress Brigitte's ass.

We approached. Brigitte turned, seeing us, and waved. Her full tits spilled out of her tight blue dress. "Hey guys!" Brigitte shouted.

We passed the velvet stanchions into the reserved area. Marc turned as well, giving me a quick once over before moving his attention on to Chrissy. The way his eyes traveled up and down her reintroduced that weight back onto my shoulders.

"Hey, there," he said, first to Chrissy, then including me. "Prosecco?"

"Please," Chrissy said.

Marc handed her a flute, then me. "You look great," he said to her. "Love the glasses."

I shot her a meaningful look, but she was too busy smiling at Marc. My gut squirmed. I turned to Brigitte. “Are we the last to get here?”

“Actually, you are. But you’re just in time for my toast.” She stepped aside and raised her glass. “Okay, I want everyone to stand but the future bride and groom.”

The murmur of conversation died down as the small gathering rose. In their midst sat Liz and Cornell, looking slightly awkward to be suddenly forced into the center of attention. Liz wore a cocktail dress almost as small as Brigitte’s—hers in white, of course.

“Everyone, a glass to tomorrow night, when Liz finally loses her virginity.”

The group laughed. An older woman, who I guessed was Liz’s mother or aunt, looked embarrassed, as did Liz. Someone said, “Our innocent Elizabeth,” full of sarcasm.

“Seriously though, I do have a few words of advice for your wedding night. As tempting as it will be, don’t drink more than a glass or two of wine. Either of you. Not even the sexiest white lingerie in the world will do a thing if you two are passed out.”

Liz glanced at her mother, her face red. “Bree, stop please.”

Brigitte ignored her. “And you don’t need to stay to the bitter end. We’ll understand if you guys want to slip away.”

I could attest to that, too. Chrissy and I hadn’t “consummated” our vows until the morning following the wedding. By the end of the night, we were just too exhausted.

Liz’s mother gave her daughter a significant look. “She’s right, dear.”

The gathering erupted into laughter. Liz buried her face in her hands. “Oh, God... Can we dance now?”

“First...cheers to the bride and groom!” Brigitte said.

“Cheers!” I was surprised when everyone threw back their drinks in one gulp, but followed along. Guess sobriety could wait until tomorrow.

Drinks empty, Chrissy waved at the group. “Hey, all, I’m Stephen’s wife, Chrissy.”

Most had no clue who I was, either, so I added, “And I’m Stephen. We know Liz.”

I felt Brigitte’s eyes on me at that—that my connection was Liz, not her—but ignored her. There were nods and waves all around. Someone said, “So can we dance now?”

Brigitte smiled. “Yes, now we can dance. But I get dibs on the bride-to-be.” She grabbed Liz by the hand and pulled her toward the dance floor. Others followed. I was about to do the same with Chrissy, but Marc beat me to it.

“Dance?” He asked her, not me. Chrissy had the grace to look in my direction. I put on my most supportive face and nodded, even though my stomach was twisted up.

“Have fun, guys,” I said.

She leaned down and kissed me. “Oh, I will.”

My insides tightened even more. I watched her being led past the velvet ropes and out into the crowd, Marc right behind her, his hands already on her hips. Then I sank into a spot along the wall.

“Your wife’s really, really hot—I believe that’s what you Americans say.” I turned to see Cornell slide into the vacant seat beside me. “Sorry if I’m out of line.”

And just like that, the tingling jealousy I’d felt twisted into something arousing. “She totally is.”

“So you used to date Brigitte? Back in the day?”

“We went out for a summer back in college. I don’t know if you’d call it dating.” On the dance floor, Chrissy fell into sync with the bassy house music—music perfect for bumping and grinding. It was distracting to watch.

“You guys ever get together since then?”

I shook my head, although I only processed half of the conversation. I was too fixated on the way Chrissy moved against Marc. Their legs were intertwined, his hand low on her waist. He said something to her, leaning close to whisper into her ear. She smiled, replied, laughed. I knew it was all innocent enough, but my heart pounded watching it.

“Huh,” Cornell said. “You know I’m cool, right? Like, Liz and I play, too.”

“What?” He wasn’t making any sense.

“With Brigitte and Marc. It’s kind of how we all met, actually. I’d hooked up with Brigitte a few times—we met through work. She’s amazing—well, you know—and then she introduced me to Liz. Did you ever hook up with those two together?”

He might as well have been speaking a foreign language. I could barely follow. “Liz and Brigitte?”

“It’s one of the most incredible things I’ve ever seen, dude. Those two really know how to put on a show.”

I blinked. Then searched for Liz’s mom, only to find her out on the dance floor herself, getting close with one of the groomsmen.

Cornell had already moved on. “Anyway, just thought your wife and Marc looked pretty comfortable together. Figured...you know.”

“That we what? Are swingers?” I was so shocked, I forgot to moderate my voice. Luckily, the club was loud enough that no one heard.

“Guess you’re not into that, then.” He slapped me on the back and stood. “Well, in that case, you better watch out for Marc. He’s got his sights set on your wife, and that guy knows how to play the field almost as well as me.”

I searched the dance floor again, finding Chrissy and Marc. She had her back to him now, her hands in the air and her ass pressed up against him. He held her hips as she shook and shimmied. Was he hard? Could she feel it?

He had his sights set on her, after all? Our fantasy had felt safe because it seemed far-fetched. So many factors would have to fall into place, even if Marc was attracted to her. Then again, I should have known Brigitte was into the swinging scene. It made total sense.

Realizing that we were playing without a net, I decided that I needed another drink. Luckily, I didn’t have to go far. In addition to the now-empty bottles of Prosecco on the central table, there were bottles of liquor and mixers.

Brigitte returned from the dance floor as I finishing splashing Coke into a tall glass of bourbon. I noted that her cleavage glistened with perspiration before tearing my eyes away.

“Hey there. Same old Stevie.”

“I mean, you’re kind of offering.” It was the kind of thing I’d once been able to tell her without the booze. Now, it definitely required the booze.

Brigitte’s sultry laugh encouraged me. “Done dancing so early? That doesn’t sound like the Brigitte that I know.”

“Didn’t want to get between true love.” She looked out to where Liz was wrapped up in Cornell’s arms.

“He told me that you introduced the two of them.”

I swear that Brigitte's eyes sparkled. "Did he tell you how I introduced them?"

"Something about how you and him used to hook up."

Brigitte's smile was wide. Her teeth were as white and even as I remembered. "He tell you that the first time he met Liz was for a threesome?"

"Not...not exactly," I stammered.

Brigitte leaned in, almost imperceptibly, but it was enough to draw attention back to her cleavage. "Does that shock you?"

"Same old Brigitte?" I sounded less assured of myself than when Brigitte delivered the same line.

She leaned back and let go of one of those hearty laughs. "Marc told me that he had fun with your wife yesterday."

The statement went through me like a bullet.

"He had nothing but good things to say. Nice job."

"Thanks."

"He's added her to his list," she said.

I had the distinct feeling that I was being baited, but asked the question anyway. "List?"

Brigitte nodded, as if I'd asked her to confirm that I'd heard correctly, not for clarification about what the hell she was talking about. "Why did you come to this wedding, Stevie?"

"I'm friends with Lizzie." My answer was automatic. So was the heat beneath my collar.

"And when was the last time you spoke to her? Not Facebook. Not Christmas cards. But actually spoke on the phone?"

My face lit up, giving me away. "I guess it was as good as any reason to take a trip to the Virgin Islands."

Brigitte smiled, leaning back. "Now *that* I'll buy. But I don't think it's the whole truth."

I shrugged, trying to act nonchalant.

"Don't worry, I'll get it out of you some time. I'm good about stuff like that."

I ignored her statement. "So what *list* did Marc add Chrissy to? Should I be worried?"

"Depends on how much you've changed since school," Brigitte said with a sly smile. When I shook my head, still confused, she went on. "Marc

and I have an understanding. We're both very sexual people, so when we decided to get serious, we didn't want to put limits on who we slept with."

It was amazing that this woman could say all that without a moment of hesitation. Where I would have been stammering and stuttering, weighed down by shame or embarrassment, Brigitte handled it like she was discussing the logistics of divvying up house chores.

"But we also wanted to be as open and honest with one another as we could. It's a tricky thing to do—without taking the spontaneity out of the thing." She looked at me meaningfully. "I learn from my mistakes."

Cole. She was talking about Cole. So maybe she really did think she wasn't cheating on me in the first place.

"So we came up with this idea of a list. A green light list. We'd each have *approved* partners. Only rule was that they had to be approved ahead of time, and the other partner had to be okay with the new addition."

Wow. It was so crazy, and yet totally in character with Brigitte. Then I put it all together. Chrissy was now on that list. The blood drained right out of me. I shot a look back at the dance floor, unable to immediately spot my wife.

"He added Chrissy to the list?" I said, searching, searching.

Brigitte's voice was a whisper against my ear. "And I approved her."

When I turned my head, Brigitte's face was inches from me. I could smell her perfume, could see the flourish of her eyeliner. She rested a hand on the inside of my thigh. "And if I still know you, that turns you on, doesn't it?"

Her hand began to creep up my thigh before I shut my legs. "Brigitte..."

"What? She didn't tell you how she sucked Marc's cock yesterday after you left them alone?"

Her words exploded through my mind, decimating my world. I stiffened. I gasped. I fucking moaned. I'd never felt so devastated, yet so aroused, in my entire life. And Brigitte was right there to observe, her light blue eyes missing nothing.

I searched the dance floor for Chrissy and Marc, like I'd catch them in the act.

"Relax, cowboy. I'm just fucking with you," Brigitte said. "But I'm glad that that part of you hasn't changed. I liked that part."

"What part?"

“The voyeur in you.”

“That’s your fault,” I said defensively.

“Nope. Don’t lay this one on me. You’ve always denied it, but it’s there, inside of you. I just helped you get your first glimpse of it.”

How was I having this conversation with my ex? It was like we’d somehow picked up where we’d left off fifteen years ago with barely a pause. I had to admit, I missed these kinds of bold, open discussions. Only recently was I able to have them with Chrissy.

“So you’re saying that I wanted to walk in on you with Cole?” There, I’d said it. I’d laid it all out there. Take that, Brigitte.

“You know what? I honestly did. I still do, actually, but realized that I’d...misjudged your reaction a little.” She laughed wistfully. “But even still, you watched. And a part of you *loved* what you saw. You should have stayed.” She’d been focused on something far away. Now, her eyes met mine again, looking deep inside of me. Just like that, we were kids on the bank of the lake again, basking naked in the sun. “Think of how different things could have turned out.”

I did. I *had* been. That’s what all those dreams were about, right? All the *what if* moments. Would I be making lists with Brigitte, like she and Marc? Would we be having threesomes with Lizzie? Would I be off chasing another man’s wife?

I was about to pull away from Brigitte—was about to take her hand off my thigh and tell her that the past was the past and that there was no point in revisiting it—when Liz and Cornell fell into the seat beside us.

“You two look like you’ve caught up on old times,” Liz said. “All’s forgiven, I’m guessing?”

“We were just talking about that,” Brigitte said. She looked at me. “And the jury’s still out.”

“Chris still out there with Marc?” I asked.

Cornell said, “They’re out front, taking a break. He said something about a smoke.”

At the thought of them outside, alone, my body went light. Chrissy didn’t smoke, but the idea of her sharing a cigarette with another man—especially Marc—hit that sweet spot of conflicted arousal.

Brigitte turned to Cornell and Liz. “So you two have been good, right? No sexy sexy since you got here?”

“I don’t see how that’s any of your business,” Liz said.

“Please,” said Brigitte. “It’s all my business.”

“Yes, we’ve been good,” said Liz.

Cornell added, “But it’s been killer! This anticipation thing better be good.”

Brigitte laughed. “Don’t worry, it will be. Too bad you couldn’t join us later tonight, either. It’s the maid of honor’s duty to make sure the bride isn’t alone on her wedding night, and we *may* see just how cozy the marital bed can get.”

She entwined her fingers with Liz and the two leaned close, sharing a peck on the lips. My cock rose. The women laughed.

“You two are total bitches,” Cornell said.

“We know,” they said in unison.

“So what’s up with Carl?” Brigitte asked Cornell. “He going to make it tomorrow?”

“Doesn’t look like it after all,” Cornell said.

Brigitte and Liz shared a look. Brigitte said, “So plan B?”

“The bellboy was hot, but I told you, there’s no way I’m going to have some random guy in my wedding. Think of those conversations years from now, as we go through our wedding photos.”

Brigitte laughed. “Fair enough. But what about Stevie?”

I had no clue what the two of them were talking about, but when they turned their attention on me, I knew it couldn’t be good.

“What size suit do you wear? About a 40?” Brigitte asked.

“41, but I could squeeze into a 40. Why?”

Brigitte didn’t bother explaining. To Liz, she said, “See, he’d be perfect. He’s not a stranger. And even better, he’s actually a good-looking guy, unlike Cornell’s other groomsmen.”

“Hey now!” Cornell said, although judging from the laughter, everyone seemed in on the joke. In fact, everyone seemed in on this conversation but me.

“Would someone like to explain?” I said.

Brigitte did. “Well, one of the groomsmen, this guy Carl, is a total flake. I have no idea why Cornell invited him in the first place—”

“We were college roommates. He helped me score weed.”

“Naturally,” Brigitte said with an eye roll and a smile. “You’re basically his size, want to wear a tux?”

I understood the individual words coming out of her mouth, of course, but strung together, I wasn't following. "You want me to wear his tuxedo?"

"Want to be in the wedding?" Liz said.

"Hold on, isn't this my decision?" Cornell interrupted. "I supply the groomsmen, you supply the babes."

"*We*, dear. We're a team. That's what tomorrow's all about." Liz laughed. "Besides, if you've got a better replacement, I'm all ears."

Cornell thought for a moment, then turned to me. "Want to be in my wedding?"

Chrissy joined us at that moment. She smelled like cigarette smoke, and when she bent down to kiss me, I tasted tobacco on her tongue. I was too confused by this conversation to be aroused by that detail.

"What's going on?" she asked. "Cornell wants you to be in his wedding?"

Marc was right behind her, immediately getting caught up in that one question. It seemed to amuse him.

"I think that's what they're asking. One of the guys can't make it, and he's my size—basically—so they're asking me."

She slipped into my lap. "Interesting."

I glanced up at Marc. "What about Marc?"

Brigitte laughed. "He'd never fit into Carl's tux."

Chrissy put her arm around me. "Sounds fun. Why the hesitation?"

Liz gave me an out. "Well, I should mention that the first part of the day involves a photoshoot on a yacht offshore. Then, we're all going to lounge around and soak up the sun."

"Ooh, definitely go," Chrissy said. "Soaking up the sun offshore sounds fun."

"Wedding party only, I'm afraid," Marc said. "I already tried weaseling my way onto that boat. But actually, if Stephen did go, you could keep me company. I was thinking of chartering a boat and snorkeling on the opposite side of the island."

Brigitte watched the exchange carefully, particularly between me and my wife. The idea of her spending most of the day together packed a punch like nothing I'd felt yet. It was intoxicating, yet so dangerous.

"I don't know," I said. "I don't think that's exactly what she had in mind when she signed up to be my plus one."

Chrissy smiled at me, as if to say, *Good answer*. Then, to Liz, she said, “Why don’t you call us in the morning if you haven’t found anyone else. Maybe we’ll change our minds.”

I looked at Chrissy in surprise. She giggled. “What? The idea of snorkeling sounds awesome.”

Everyone laughed.

I wanted to change the subject. “So you have fun dancing?”

“It was a blast. Marc’s a great dancer.” To Brigitte, she said, “Thanks for lending him to me.”

“He’s yours whenever you’d like him,” Brigitte said brightly. “He likes being used by pretty women.”

Chrissy blushed. She turned to me. “I was just going to say that I think the long day caught up to me. And maybe the booze. I’m feeling run down, and think I’m going to head out.”

“Okay. Let me just hit the head and—”

“No, you stay,” Chrissy said. “Get caught up. Marc, Cornell, and a few of the other guys were heading back anyway. I’ll catch a ride with them.”

I tried reading her—the way the corners of her lips curled up, the unblinking stare behind her glasses, the way she brushed her hair over her ear. Was this a test?

“Are you sure?” I asked.

“Totally.” She leaned in and kissed me sweetly. “Have fun.”

“Good night, love,” I said. “See you in a bit.”

“I won’t wait up for you. Night, hon.” She glanced quickly at Brigitte and added, “Be good.”

I watched her leave, Marc at her side. He didn’t go so far as to place a hand on her back, but he may as well have done as much. They were leaving together. She was on his list. She had a crush on him. And I’d given her permission to fuck him last night.

I almost followed, but my body seemed paralyzed to act. I formulated the excuse—*You know what? I’m feeling the flight, too*. But the words didn’t come. Then Chrissy was out the door, laughing at something Marc said, and I was alone.

“She seems like a cool chick,” Brigitte said, drawing me back into the moment.

Well, not quite alone.

“Yeah. Very.” Did Brigitte know what was going on? Did she suspect that her husband had left to fuck my wife? Or did their green light list arrangement mean he didn’t need to inform her?

“How did you two meet?” she asked.

“It’s actually very sweet,” Liz said. “They met at a beat poetry reading.”

Brigitte looked at me and laughed. “Stevie went to a poetry reading? Seems unlikely.”

“It was an accident,” I said. “I was just ducking in there to get a coffee.”

“Makes more sense,” Brigitte said.

“And then he saw her and it was love at first sight,” Liz finished.

This felt weird. Brigitte was the only other girl that I’ve loved, so talking about my next great romance seemed wrong, for some reason. If Brigitte thought so, I couldn’t tell.

She said, “She seems like the type of shy girl who’s got a lot more going on under the surface.” Brigitte’s smile was terrifying. “Does she, Stephen?”

I thought about Chrissy leaving with Marc. Cornell was there, along with some other guys, but they’d split off when they arrived back at the hotel. Cornell would hit the bar, maybe, Marc would offer to walk Chrissy back up to her room. One thing would lead to another—

Brigitte cut into my thoughts before full panic could set in. “Hey Stephen, want to dance?”

I wanted to get out of there, but what kind of message would that send Chrissy? Hadn’t we discussed this? Wasn’t this my fantasy? If I chased her down, would it remain just a fantasy forever?

Brigitte rose, offering me her hand.

“Lead the way,” I said.

I wasn’t a huge dancer, but I wasn’t one of those husbands who preferred watching from the periphery, either. I liked dancing. I’d just always done it with Chrissy. We learned together, both trial and error at various weddings, then more formally through some ballroom dancing classes. But I didn’t know Brigitte’s style—dancing wasn’t a huge part of camp life that summer, and we only went to a couple frat parties together before breaking up. There was also some guilt about dancing with her at all

—but all I had to do was think about Chrissy with Marc and the guilt was gone.

Only that was kind of the problem—all I could think about was Chrissy with Marc. Dancing with a hot blonde like Brigitte who knew how to move in her tight dress should have been all I could think about, but all I could do was look at the door, wondering when I could leave and find out what was really going on.

“Bored of me already?” Brigitte asked. She circled her hands around my neck, pressing her curvy body to mine.

“Sorry. I’m just not used to being out so late.”

“Or maybe you’re thinking about what Marc is doing to your wife right now.”

Her words squeezed the wind out of me. I gasped.

She grinned, turned her back against me, and pressed her ass against my crotch. In her heels, she was practically taller than me. She had to feel me there, my erection pressed between her buttocks. She shot a smile over her shoulder, but kept grinding against me like that.

“Yeah, you’re definitely thinking about them.”

“Bree...”

“Don’t worry, Marc’s a gentleman. He’d never do something that she didn’t want.”

I stepped away from her, fighting to regain composure. I took a lumbering step in the direction of the door before Brigitte hooked her arm in mine and swept me back to the VIP area.

“Did he say something?” I asked. This felt enough like a dream that I wondered when I’d wake up.

“No. Did *she* say something?”

“No.”

“Then maybe they’ve gone their separate ways.”

“You’re an evil bitch.”

I mostly meant it, but either Brigitte took it as a joke, or was fine with the label. She just laughed. “Oh, come on, Stephen, don’t forget who you’re talking to.”

We arrived back in the VIP section before I could compose my objection. Liz was sitting alone, rubbing her feet. “Taking a breather?” she asked.

“Yeah, for the same reason,” Brigitte said. “These heels are killing me.”

“I don’t know how you wear those things all the time,” Liz said. “Mine are an inch shorter than yours and my feet have been screaming at me since dinner.”

Brigitte laughed, stretching her legs out in front of her. Her heels were, indeed, tall. Blue like her dress, they had narrow heels, open toes, and a band about her ankle.

That was another thing I’d missed out on dating her at camp—heels. As impractical as they were ordinarily, they were an impossibility around the lake. But I loved the look of heels, and Brigitte’s were hot as hell.

“You kind of get used to them.” Brigitte laughed at her own statement. “It’s kind of industry standard for me, though.”

“Designer dresses and chic heels. What a uniform, huh, Stephen?”

“Hard life,” I said. “Jet-setting to Paris and Tokyo.”

“Going to swanky parties,” Liz added. “Rubbing elbows with designers and models.”

Brigitte shook her head with a laugh. “You two wouldn’t be saying that if you only knew. It looks glamorous, but it’s tiring to maintain.” With her eyes wide, she said, “Looking this good takes work.”

I couldn’t stand this inane conversation anymore. I stood. “I need to go.”

“You sure?” Brigitte asked. “If you want, I’m sure I could convince Liz to invite you back to the honeymoon suite. What do you say, Liz? Want an audience?”

My breath caught. Outside of porn, I’d never seen two women get it on. And these two were exceptional women. But I couldn’t. Not with Chrissy out there with Marc.

“Sorry, I...I need to go.”

“He’s still such a Boy Scout,” Liz said.

Brigitte’s gaze never wavered from me. “I wouldn’t say that. Have a good night, Stephen.”

“I’ll see you tomorrow. Have...have fun.”

The women giggled together as I practically ran from the club. Luckily, a cab was right there to pick me up. Checking my watch, I was shocked to see that it was 1:30 in the morning. When had Chrissy left? How long had they been gone?

They. Oh, God. Panic tore up my insides.

“You okay, mister?” the cab driver asked in heavily accented English.

“Sorry, yeah. Just tired.”

He didn’t look convinced, but drove on. I had no idea what my plan was here. Was I going to stop them? Is that what I really wanted? Was it even fair? After all, I’d told Chrissy that I was okay with it.

Or was I going to watch? To see another man take my wife. To watch some other guy make my Chrissy scream.

I was hard. So, so hard. My blood pumped gasoline. My brain was dizzy with it. I don’t remember paying the cab driver. I don’t remember crossing the lobby and waiting for the elevator. One moment my stomach was cratering as my cock was rising, the next, I was practically running down the hall to our room.

I heard the moans through the door before I’d fumbled to get out my card. Chrissy’s moans, muted yet unmistakable. I dropped the card as a spike of cold reality rammed through me.

Fuck. Fuuuuck! Was this really happening? Was this really happening again?!

I bent down, my spine humming. It crawled up the back of my neck and across my scalp. My vision narrowed. My hand shook so much that I had trouble fitting the keycard into the slot. On the other side of that door, Chrissy cried out again, her moan cranking up my buzz.

I took a deep breath. It didn’t help. I opened the door.

Her moans came louder. My stomach sank. I put a hand to it, clutching it, only to brush the tip of the hardest erection I’d had in as long as I could remember. What the fuck was wrong with me? I shoved the confusion down deep. I stepped inside.

The day that I’d walked in on Brigitte returned, as vivid as if it had been yesterday. Brigitte had been screaming in our bedroom as Cole powered into her, taking her in that physical, relentless way of his. I loved seeing her like that, although it took me all these years to admit it. Was that what I was about to see? Was that what I wanted?

I didn’t know what the fuck I was going to do, but I shut down that thinking, too. Instead, I took one last breath. One last silent step. And rounded the corner.

I blinked, confused. At first, I didn’t know what I was seeing, although my imagination tried filling in all kinds of things.

There was Chrissy on our king-sized bed with just the flat sheet over her body. She was on her knees, her head pressed into the mattress, her ass up. One hand clutched the pillow, the other was out of sight, down beneath her body.

But she was also alone. Or so it appeared. Her body rippled beneath the sheets, and for a tense moment, I half-expected to see someone emerge from under them. But there were no other limbs, no other shapes, nothing but Chrissy and one of her hands working her pussy.

The only other time I'd seen her play with herself was several months ago, when she did it on the dining table right before me. But this was different. This wasn't for show. This was all her, and damn, was it hot.

Also, kind of disappointing. I knew this was probably the best possible explanation to what I'd heard through the door, but a dark and confusing side of me wished I'd walked in on more.

Chrissy moaned again. Her body shook faster. She released her pillow with her left hand, snaking it down under the sheets to join her right. She rolled her head away from me, but I could see her reflection in the sliding doors. Her eyes were shut tight. Her mouth hung open as her cries grew louder.

What was she thinking about? Who was she thinking about? The *who* had me shivering all over again.

"Yes." The word came breathily, haltingly. "Yes, fuck me... Uh!"

So she was fantasizing about someone else. Me? Marc? And what was I supposed to do? Announce myself? Leave? Watch? I was seized with the same indecision I had when I'd walked in on Brigitte, only now, the circumstances were all different...right?

On the bed, Chrissy lifted her hips higher as she crashed through her orgasm. Her shoulders glistened with the sheen of her light sweat. Her body quaked. She clenched her teeth to stifle her cries. It was a sound I knew so well, yet now sounded so strange.

When her orgasm had run its rapturous course, Chrissy slumped into a heap of heaving flesh. She didn't open her eyes, but I saw her wide smile in the window's reflection. Suddenly, standing there felt very perverted. I took a step back, as if leaving.

Chrissy must have detected the movement. She froze, her eyes flying open. "Stephen?!"

"Hi." I felt embarrassed for the both of us.

Chrissy buried her face in the pillow. I approached the bed. When I sat on the edge, she turned and peeked at me through the curtain of her strawberry blond hair. "How long were you there?"

"Long enough to get hard." I ran my hand down her back, beneath the sheets. "You're so sexy."

"I'm so embarrassed!"

"Why? I love that you do that. That you couldn't help yourself." I bent down and kissed her neck. "You were thinking about him, weren't you? About Marc?"

Chrissy rolled onto her side. The sheet caught for a moment on one of her hard nipples before getting tugged away. Even though I'd seen my wife topless countless times, I still looked.

She laughed. "Really?"

"I can't help it. They're right there." I reached out and caressed them, tracing small breasts and rubbing my thumb across her pale nipples. "You left with him. You made me think you were with him."

"Did I? I'm sorry if you got that impression."

I pulled off my shirt. "So nothing happened?"

She continued with the coy act. "Well, I danced with him some."

"I saw. Did his hands stray?" My pants went next, leaving me naked and erect.

"You mean did he know I wore a thong tonight?" She blinked. "Maybe. Did you like watching us?"

"You know I did."

"And you thought I left to screw him?"

I shivered. "Yes."

She pulled my cock close enough that she could dip down and lick it. "And how did that make you feel? Were you coming back here to break us up?"

"No." When I said it, I realized that was the truth.

"Good."

I moved down the bed, pulling the sheet away from her body. She said, "To answer your earlier question, yes, I was thinking about him when you walked in."

I unveiled her ass, skimming my hand over the rounded rise. I pushed my hand between her buttocks, seeking out her silken pussy. Chrissy gasped as I slid my middle finger inside of her.

“I’m wet...because I was thinking about Marc fucking me,” she said. She rolled onto her knees, lifting her ass to grant me better access. “Does that make me naughty?”

I moved in behind her, taking my cock into my left hand as I continued to finger her with my right. “Did Marc tell you about his list?”

I pulled my fingers free and placed my cock against her slit, using my swollen glans to tease her clit. Feeling her so smooth against my cock felt incredible.

She had trouble speaking. “No.”

“He and Brigitte have a list of people they could sleep with. Kind of like our celebrity one, only with real people.” I pulled back, gasping at the slippery sensation of my shaft along her shaved sex. “Guess who got added to Marc’s list today?”

I pushed inside her, drawing a sharp moan from my wife. I surveyed her body below me, drinking in the sweep of her bowed back, her narrow waist, the way her hips flared out to her perfect ass. It was a sight that Marc wished he could see one day. Maybe he would tomorrow.

“Uh, Stephen! You’re so hard.” She pushed her hips into mine. “I don’t know who’s more excited.”

“This is how you imagined him fucking you, isn’t it?”

Chrissy moaned.

“How did he fuck you?”

Her answer came on the end of a gasp, barely audible. “Harder.”

“Harder? Like this?” I grabbed her hips, taking control of the fuck. I shoved her away as I withdrew, yanked her against me as I slammed into her. “Rougher?”

Chrissy had never been into rough sex. She’d even complained a few times when I’d let my passion get ahead of me. She wasn’t complaining now. Her cries grew louder.

“Yes! Like that, baby. Just like that.” She reached down between her legs, like she’d done when it was just her, her fingers touching her clit as I fucked her. She wasn’t playing to my fantasy. She wasn’t faking this. Behind her closed eyes, she had another man’s cock inside her.

I rammed home one last time, unable to hold back. My balls seized. For a split second, I saw Marc’s thick, black cock buried to the hilt inside Chrissy’s pale cunt. The image burned inside my skull.

I threw my head back, stared at the ceiling, and let the world turn to fire. It pulled in every direction, an explosion going out and out until nothing was left of me, of my thoughts, of my fantasies.

I slumped over Chrissy, who was panting just as hard. Her body was as slick as mine. I managed to kiss her shoulder, tasting her salty exertion, before rolling off and letting the soft mattress envelope me.

Chrissy didn't move at first, her face still buried in the pillow, her ass slightly raised. Eventually, she rolled onto her side, a smile plastered all over her face. Her hair stuck to her cheeks and forehead. I brushed it back so we could look each other in the eyes.

"So about tomorrow..." I began.

"Yeah?"

"Should I tell Liz I'll be in her wedding?"

"And leave me alone with Marc?"

"You did say you wanted to go snorkeling. Now's your chance." She'd actually mentioned wanting to go snorkeling before we made reservations for this trip, but I'd told her that I wasn't interested in floating on my stomach, looking down at some fish.

"Okay, I'm game." Chrissy reached out and ran her hand across my smooth chest. She spread her fingers out across my heart, feeling the beat quicken. "But just so we're crystal clear, what we're really talking about is me having sex with Marc."

I stared at her, my heart climbing up my throat. I could hear it thumping, louder and louder. This was it. That's exactly what we were talking about.

When I didn't say anything, she said, "Want to think about it first?"

"No." I rolled her onto her back and climbed on top of her. I was hard again. "I think we're done thinking about it."

She gasped as I pressed into her, filling her once again.

Chrissy's smooth legs wrapped around me. She dug her heels into my ass, and pressed her lips against my ear. "He kissed me tonight,"

"No more games, Chris." I punctuated the statement with a hard thrust.

"This isn't a game. He did kiss me. Right outside our door."

My cock surged. I imagined the two of them, as they were on the dance floor, only closer. Kissing. Tongues diving.

"He's a good kisser," Chrissy said. "He's got a nice, big...tongue."

As I drove in and out of her, I realized that tomorrow, she'd have another man's cock inside her. She could be in this very bed, in this very position. "Did he...did he want to come in?" I managed to ask through the exertion.

"Actually, he invited me up to his room." She raked her nails down my back, latching onto the nape of my neck. "I thought about it, but wasn't ready."

I strained to speak. "Are you ready now?"

"Yes."

My balls tightened.

"And Stephen..."

I pressed one last time inside her. Took one last ragged breath.

"I plan on being very, very bad."

Everything tipped—the world, my place in it, what I considered safe and stable and secure. Chrissy had been that anchor. Now she was going to spend tomorrow with a man who'd already tried to sleep with her twice.

I erupted inside her as things continued to tumble away. She clenched down with her heels, forcing me deeper. Her nails bit into the back of my neck. Her breath a tattered moan against me. She wanted it. She wanted Marc. She wanted something new and strange.

I collapsed onto her, a sweating, heaving mass. I'd run races and not felt so winded at the finish line. My cock softened inside of her, but I remained where I was, determined to savor every last second of this moment.

"So tomorrow," Chrissy said.

I shifted until we were face to face. I could make out her freckles, each and every one of them. I could see the flecks of amber in her brown irises. "Tomorrow," I echoed.

I rolled off her. We crawled beneath the sheets, holding one another in the darkness of the hotel room. For the longest time, we just listened to one another's breathing as waves rolled up the beach, somewhere in the distance. Far from home, this was the safest place for us to do this—yet there was nothing safe about it.

When Chrissy spoke, her voice was quiet and uncertain—but not from exhaustion. "You're not just letting me do this to sleep with Brigitte, are you?"

I'd be on a boat with her while Chrissy was off with Marc. I was on Brigitte's list. I'd be lying if I said that it hadn't crossed my mind, but it also wasn't at the top of it. "I'm not. This is about you and Marc."

I felt her shake her head in the dark, her hair swishing against my shoulder. "No, it's not. It's about you and me."

I smiled and couldn't stop. "I love you, Chrissy Warren."

"I'm pretty lovable, aren't I?" She shifted close, an arm around my midsection. "Night, sweetheart. We've got a big day tomorrow."

Chapter 10:

Pre-Party

The Caribbean sun was bright, the gauzy curtains offering little shade as the morning of the wedding dawned. Lying in bed, I ran through last night. Had I really given Chrissy permission to fool around with another man?

The shower was running as the fog started to clear. I don't remember having had much to drink, but my dry mouth and aching head begged to differ.

Sunlight filled the room, bright and cheerful. Today was the day that my wife would fuck another man. I flopped back into bed, regretting it immediately as my head protested.

The shower cut off. The shower curtain screeched open. I heard Chrissy humming as she stepped out and began to towel off. Could I really do this? Could I really share her? Yes, definitely.

I picked up the hotel phone and called down to the front desk. "Could you connect me to the bridal suite?"

"Certainly. One moment, sir."

The phone rang and rang. I looked at the clock. It was 8:35. Had they already left for the big day? Surely they weren't sleeping.

"Hell...hello?" It was Liz.

"Morning, Liz. Ready for your big day?"

She gasped, followed by a loud, "Yes!"

My heart skipped a beat. "Liz?"

"Sorry...ah...little pre—preoccupied."

In the background, I heard Brigitte say, "That Stephen?"

"Mmm hmm."

"Give me the phone." A muffled moment later, Brigitte came on the line. "Morning, Stephen. You sleep well?"

I heard something else—a buzzing sound that had to be a vibrator. Liz gasped. I shifted, adjusting my hard on. "Not really," I said.

"You missed a fun night after you left. You should have joined us." Liz moaned again. "You still can, if you want."

The bathroom door opened and Chrissy stepped out. She was completely naked, not even bothering with a towel, her skin pink and scrubbed clean.

“I think I’ll pass, but thanks. Reason I was calling was to tell you that Chrissy and I talked about it. I’m in for the wedding.”

“Great! Be down in the lobby at eleven. Bring your suit. I’ll have your tux for you.”

Click.

Chrissy nodded. “So that’s that?”

I licked my lips, drinking in her nudity. Marc would enjoy that view before the day was done. I nodded. “She said to meet her in the lobby at eleven.”

“What about me? Where should I meet Marc?”

“I don’t know.”

Chrissy went to the suitcase and started rummaging through it. “Call her back?”

“I can’t. She sounded...busy.”

“Oh.” Chrissy looked puzzled for a moment.

I added, “She and Liz sounded like they’d slept in.”

Chrissy finally got it. “Ohh!”

“Maybe give them a few minutes. I’ll call after I take a shower.”

“Sounds good.”

*

When I got out of the shower, Chrissy was talking to someone on the phone, wearing just her thong. It was arousing to watch her doing something so mundane dressed like that. I stared, my cock stiffening. She laughed at whoever she was talking to—a part of me had assumed it was room service—twisting her finger through her hair. I froze at the girlish gesture, my ears perking up.

“Sounds amazing,” she said, sunshine in her voice. “Yes, I can be ready in fifteen minutes.”

She sensed me, looking up and smiling. “Uh huh... Uh huh...” She crossed over to our garment bag, hanging in the closet, and pulled out a pink sundress. She held it in front of herself, looking at me for approval.

I'd seen her wear it before, but it had never looked so short. Thinking of Marc admiring her legs and ass in it had my heart fluttering. I nodded.

"Boat ride to the coral reefs, snorkeling, then lunch on a secluded beach?" She looked right at me. The confirmation was for me more than anything else. "I can't wait. See you in a few."

Chrissy ended the call, setting it back into its cradle.

"I better get moving. We leave soon and I haven't even done my makeup." She pulled the dress on without bothering with a bra. That wasn't completely unusual—Chrissy didn't really need a bra—but I got the feeling that she was sending me a message.

She swept by me before I'd had a chance to regroup. She smirked, reaching up and closing my slack jaw with a giggle. "He said to pack a bikini, and a change of clothes. Could you do that for me while I get ready, hon?"

I took a steadying breath. When that didn't help, I wondered if maybe I was still dreaming. I'd had some crazy ones over the last few months, and this certainly qualified as crazy. But I didn't wake up, so I went to Chrissy's suitcase to look for a change of clothes.

So much of what she'd packed was new to me. I pulled out a tank top and a pair of white shorts—they were small and short, and I could only imagine how good they'd look on Chrissy's bubble butt. I set them aside and shifted to the lingerie side of the suitcase. Again, I didn't recognize half of what I pulled out, but every scrap of lace, satin, and silk was slinky and exciting. I settled on a white g-string. I always thought that the idea of bra straps visible around a tank top was sexy, so I added the matching bra to the pile.

Finally, there was the matter of the bikini. I knew that Chrissy would read into my choice. There was the brown knit one she'd worn yesterday, still hanging on the balcony. It was modest, yet still sexy. She'd also packed an older suit that I recognized—green with a Hawaiian print, it covered quite a lot for a bikini. The third bikini had my heart racing before I'd even laid it out.

The red string bikini looked like it was built more of ties than actual material. While it wasn't a thong or anything trashy like that, it was the tiniest bathing suit I'd ever seen Chrissy wear. I ran my thumb along the triangular top of one of the cups.

"That one?" Chrissy said behind me. I jumped.

I rubbed the material between my fingers. “Yes, this one.”

She took it from me and deposited it into a day bag. “I was going to model it for you first, but I guess Marc gets that honor now.”

She watched my reaction through her long lashes, searching for any signs of hesitation. I didn’t give that to her. “You’ll have to send me a pic.”

Chrissy blushed. Or maybe she’d just put on blush. Her makeup sparkled around her bright, brown eyes. She added the short-shorts, tank top, and lingerie to the bag, rooted around for a cover-up for her swimsuit, and added a makeup pouch. She spoke as she worked, careful not to look at me.

“Listen, I’ve been thinking a lot about this. About what I’m about to do. I know this is your fantasy, but...” She paused and released a smiley laugh. “But Marc is *hot*. There’s no other way to put it. And I hate myself for being as excited as I am, but I’m really excited, Stephen.”

Her honesty scared me to death, but I appreciated it. “Don’t hate yourself. The point is to have fun.”

“Oh, I will. Don’t worry about that,” she said.

Again, my chest constricted.

“But hear me out, first.” She took a deep breath. “If you want to sleep with Brigitte, you can.”

“What? No, I wouldn’t—”

“I’m being serious. If things happen to go that way, and an opportunity presents itself, you should do it. It’s only fair.”

She had to be saying this to assuage her own guilt. Chrissy wasn’t a jealous person, *per se*, but she’s never once even indicated that she shared my fantasy. “This isn’t about what’s fair. You said it yourself last night—this is about us. Does the idea of me with Brigitte turn you on?”

Her voice was small. “No.”

“Right. And that’s the difference.”

She set the sunscreen in the bag, stared over her shoulder at me, and smiled. “Okay.” Then: “I’m taking the sunblock, so you’re going to have to scrounge for your own.”

I laughed. “Fair.”

Grabbing the bag, she stood up, took a deep breath, and looked at me. This was my last chance to back out. All I had to say was, *I changed my mind*.

I pulled her into my arms and kissed her, long and sensually. I tasted her lipstick. She'd dabbed on perfume. And she'd done it all for Marc.

"I love you, Chris. Have fun."

"I love you, too. See you later...Stevie."

Sliding into her sandals, she left me alone in our room. Alone and totally fucking tortured.

*

When the door clicked behind her, my first instinct was to follow her out and stop her. It was so strong that I actually had my hand on the knob before I stopped.

No, I couldn't do that. This wasn't just about me. Chrissy wanted this just as much as I did. It was a scary thing to admit, packed with all kinds of insecurities that I didn't want to consider, but the idea was also intensely exciting. I'd been dreaming of Brigitte and her bad girl behavior, and it was as exciting and sexy...but also totally expected. Chrissy...Chrissy was a *good girl*. She was the responsible side of our partnership. She made sure our bills were paid on time. She made sure we bought fruits and vegetables at the market when I was browsing the potato chip aisle. She cried when she accidentally ran over a squirrel last year.

Now that same woman wanted to fuck a virile, black stud.

I wanted to vomit. I wanted to beat off. Instead, I changed into a pair of cargo shorts and a t-shirt and wandered out onto the balcony.

Resort life was just beginning to stir. The pool was mostly empty, the pool bar closed. A handful of surfers caught waves out on the beach, which was mostly unoccupied. The most crowded spot was the restaurant veranda, where breakfast boomed, but I suddenly had no appetite.

I scanned the bay. A few sailboats dotted the blue water. I couldn't find the boat launch or pier, though. Wherever Chrissy and Marc—not to mention me and the wedding party—were launching from, it wasn't somewhere visible from the balcony.

A wave of nausea rolled through me. I'd just sent my wife off to fuck another man! Would things ever be the same?

The corners of my vision grew fuzzy. My head felt light. I forced myself to calm down before I hyperventilated. *Breathe man. Breathe.*

It was only 9:30—practically an eon before my eleven o'clock meeting with Brigitte. I wasn't about to sit around the hotel room as I went over and over the *what ifs*. First order of business, get some food in my stomach. That way, if I was going to throw up, I'd have *something* to throw up.

Just joking. (But not really.)

The hotel restaurant crowd had thinned by the time I made it down there. This day in paradise had begun for most. I ordered eggs and toast, unsure how much my sensitive stomach could handle. Coffee was probably not a good idea, either, but after the late night last night, I needed it.

I reviewed my situation over breakfast. Chris was off with a man who not only wanted to sleep with her, but had received permission from his own wife to do so. On the other hand, I was hanging out with the ex-girlfriend that I'd been having sex dreams about for the past six months—who'd also gotten permission to sleep with me. And if I was honest with myself, I was more than curious to have another experience with her.

All of it left me so profoundly conflicted. I hated myself for being turned on by any of it, but couldn't deny that all of it turned me on.

And the worst part was that I had no way of talking it over with the one person in the world to whom I could talk about this stuff. I couldn't even say hello if I wanted to. With our cell phones out of plan, we were totally out of touch.

After breakfast, I took a walk along the beach, my shoes in hand, my feet splashing through the warm surf. It was a walk that I'd hoped to take with Chrissy. Now, I was alone, and she was probably boning her black lover.

"Stop," I said. Miraculously, I did. For a few minutes anyway. Then the cycle repeated.

That's how the morning went. No matter what I did—walking on the beach, lounging by the pool, trying to read my book—something always reminded me of Chrissy and Marc. I kept thinking that this was a dream, that it *had* to be a dream, and that any minute, I'd wake in my bed with Chrissy at my side.

But I didn't wake up. This time, the dream was real.

When I entered the lobby a few minutes past eleven, Brigitte was already ready for the wedding in the short, coral bridesmaid dress. In fact, the whole wedding party was dressed for the wedding but me, who'd come downstairs in my swimming trunks.

Seeing all those tuxes and gowns, I felt like I'd stepped off the elevator naked. I thought someone had mentioned bikinis.

Liz looked stunning in her white gown, strapless and classic despite the very contemporary setting. The tuxes were just as traditional, complete with patent leather shoes and shimmering coral vests to match the women's dresses.

But it was Brigitte who stole the show. It was as if the off-the-shoulder dress was designed specifically for her body. I'd seen a photo of her in it already, but that hadn't done her justice. The sight was the first thing in the last few hours that got my mind off whatever Chrissy was doing with Marc.

Her heels clapped sharply across the terracotta tiles as she approached. Her hair and makeup had been applied professionally earlier that day, which just made her look even more like the dream version of Brigitte. This was the woman Marc came home to every night. This was the woman I could have had.

"Hey, Stephen."

"Hey. Did I get the wrong memo? I'm a little underdressed."

She smirked. "Photos first, then fun." Kissing me on the cheeks, she said, "You can change into your tux on the yacht."

"Now those are words I never thought I'd hear directed at me."

Brigitte laughed. That felt good. "Come on. Time to live a day in the life of a guy who does."

We made our way to the pier, which was about a ten-minute limo drive away. I officially met the others in the wedding party. Besides Cornell and me, there were two other groomsmen. Harry and Jay seemed like nice enough guys; albeit, we had nothing in common. Harry worked on Wall Street, and Jay was a defense lawyer. They moved in different circles than me. Not that I hung out with a blue collar crowd or anything—I worked in IT consulting and Chris was in marketing—but where I was right at home talking about iPhones versus Androids, these guys talked about the features of different special edition BMWs. It's not that I didn't like them or anything, and we got along fine. We were just different. I married a girl with a Midwest accent. They dated women who looked like Brigitte.

Liz's bridesmaids seemed more my speed. Colette, a freckled redhead, was a school teacher, and Meg was actually married with kids. They also looked like real people—Colette carried a little extra weight, and Meg was a cute little Chinese woman.

Glasses of champagne were ready for us as we entered the limo. It was going to be that kind of day. I'd need to fortify myself.

"So you dated Bree back in school?" Harry said. "Nice, bro."

"You know I can hear you, right?" Brigitte said from the other end of the limo. "But yes, it *was* nice."

The guys just grinned at me knowingly.

Stepping out of the limo, Brigitte linked arms with me and led me down the pier. Either the bubbly was hitting me hard, or it was Brigitte against me, but I was already feeling warm all over. "So have you talked to Chrissy?" she asked.

And like that, the warm feeling got a little too hot to be comfortable. "I haven't. No reception."

"Oh," Brigitte said, surprised. Then a wide smile stretched across her face. "You must be really curious then."

"A little," I said. Now there was an understatement.

"Well, let me just say that they're getting along really well."

My heartbeat skipped. "You...how?"

"International roaming," Brigitte said.

"Technically, St. Thomas is part of the U.S.," I said, although my heart wasn't into the rebuttal.

"Take it up with AT&T." She squeezed my arm. In front of us was a sizable yacht, gangplank extended. "So here we are. Let's get you into your tux."

"What did you mean about them *getting along*?"

Brigitte's smile could have meant anything. My imagination cycled through all the possibilities—from the platonic to the sexual, and everything in between.

"You really want to know?"

She led me down into the main cabin, a spacious room with a nautical theme, a bar, and a bed. I looked at the bed warily, then back at Brigitte.

"You can leave your bag in here. It'll be safe." She moved to the closet, where she pulled out a tuxedo, still wrapped in plastic. "Good thing

we had these shipped here. Otherwise, Liz would have had to go with one less groomsman.”

She tore open the plastic, then stopped. “What are you waiting for? Strip.”

“I can dress myself.”

Brigitte chuckled. Tossing the tux on the bed, she crossed over to me. “But that’s not as fun.”

Reaching for the base of my t-shirt, she tugged it up. I grabbed my shirt from her, finishing the deed. I wasn’t going to let myself be undressed like a child.

“Very nice, Stephen. You’ve kept yourself up.” She ran her fingers over my chest. “Such a DILF.”

“DILF?”

“Dad I’d like to f—”

“Got it,” I said. Shirtless in Brigitte’s presence suddenly felt very, very wrong. “Seriously, I can dress myself.”

“Okay.” Brigitte sat on the bed and smiled up at me. She pulled out her phone.

“You’re not going to leave me alone, are you?”

Brigitte shook her head. “I’m fine right here. Besides, didn’t you want to know about how Chrissy and Marc’s day is going?”

My ears perked up, along with my cock. “Stop teasing. I know what you’re doing.”

“And what’s that?”

Semi-aroused, my bulge was visible through the trunks. Brigitte noticed with a sly smile.

“You’re trying to get me jealous so that I...I don’t know. Sleep with you or something.”

Brigitte released that hearty laugh of hers. “You think I’m making this all up? Is that what you think?”

I knew she wasn’t, but stubbornly, I nodded. “Yeah, I do.”

“Then I shouldn’t show you these pics he sent me?” She appeared to swipe something on her phone. “These two make a very sexy pair.”

I stood uncertain. Were these more games? “Fine, let me see.”

She pulled the phone back before I could get a peek. She looked down at my bulge. “You really ought to start getting changed. We don’t have that much time.”

“Fine,” I said. I hooked my thumbs in my trunks and pulled them down, releasing my cock. I was swollen enough that I hung between my legs proudly. “This what you want to see?”

Brigitte’s eyes lit up. “Nice chubby there, Stephen. That for me?”

Before I could process what was happening, she aimed her phone at my cock and snapped off a photo.

“What are you doing?”

“Sending a pic of my own,” she said.

“No, you can’t!”

“Just did.” She turned her phone to me, showing that she had, indeed, just texted a photo of my cock, semi-erect, to her husband—and my wife. The photo didn’t show my face, but Chrissy would know immediately that it was me. Beneath the photo, Brigitte had written, *My view right now*.

As I watched, Marc sent a reply.

—well that was fast

Followed quickly by:

—enjoy!

“Why did you do that? He’s going to show that to Chris. She’s going to make assumptions.”

“But that’s what you want, right? You want to give her an excuse to be bad.”

My jaw clenched. “Tell her that it’s not what it looks like. Tell her I was just changing into my tux and you walked in.”

“I could do that, but are you sure that’s what you really want?” She took the phone back and scrolled up, turning it to me once again. This time, it showed a photo of Chrissy and Marc, sitting on the end of a boat. He had his arm draped over her, and she was in her red bikini that left so little to the imagination. They wore their sunglasses, of course, but I didn’t need to see her eyes to see that she was having a good time. “Good looking couple, don’t you think? That’s what they told the captain of the boat they hired—that they were a couple out to see the reefs.”

My cock twitched, and since it was hanging freely between us, Brigitte saw. She rose, and in her heels, her full height was even with me. “So tell

me truthfully, Stephen, do you really want me to clarify the situation? Because from my perspective, the situation is already pretty clear.”

“I...” I groaned. “This is so wrong.”

“Why? Marc isn’t going to try and steal her. He’s just looking to have a good time on vacation, and I must say, in that red bikini, your wife’s looking like a great time.”

“We’re not...we’re not like you guys.”

“Why? Because you’ve got kids back home? Because you what? You’re normal? Stevie, I know you, remember? And I know what you’ve got buried deep inside of you. Just accept it. Chrissy seems more than ready to.”

“What do you mean?”

“Oh.” She picked up the phone again and swiped to the next photo. “This.”

And there, on her phone, was the same photo of the two, sitting on the boat, only this time, they were kissing. And it wasn’t a soft peck on the lips, either. Their mouths were open and their tongues swarmed. Chrissy had her hand on his shoulder, holding it for support, her diamond ring catching the sun against his dark skin.

“So what do you want me to do?” Brigitte asked. Her hand had gone around my cock, slowly pumping it to life.

I closed my eyes, found some last reservoirs of willpower, and pulled away from her. “Help me get dressed.”

Brigitte raised an eyebrow, incredulous that she was being rejected. I chalked it up as a small victory and grabbed the tuxedo trousers. Brigitte eyed my cock one last time before I zipped it out of sight.

*

I reviewed my situation as we emerged onto the wide deck to begin photographs. Land was far enough away that I couldn’t make out individual people without the aid of binoculars. We’d be out here for most of the early afternoon, trapped on a private booze cruise. Meanwhile, my wife was hanging out with a guy she not only had the hots for, but had already made out with. She also probably thought that I was fucking the guy’s wife, with his and her permission, who also happened to be the ex-girlfriend that I’d been dreaming about recently.

A lot of things had to fall into place to get me here, but here I was. When a mimosa was shoved into my hand, I decided to make the most of it—not that I was going to have sex with Brigitte. The stubborn side of me had already decided that she wasn't getting any. Rightly or wrongly, I blamed her for this situation, so she was getting punished.

We took what felt like a million photographs. Seemed like every possible combination was covered—the groomsmen together, the bridesmaids together, each groomsmen with Cornell, each bridesmaid with Liz. On and on. Since I was paired up with the red-haired Colette on the walk-out, we took some together as well.

"You and Bree were inside alone for an awfully long time," she whispered as the photographer posed us this way and that.

"She was helping me with my tux."

Colette smirked. "I bet she was. She seems very helpful."

"Oh, you don't know her?" For some reason, I just assumed everyone knew everyone else. This made more sense with the Lizzie I knew back in school, who seemed to be friends with everyone.

"Only about a little more than I know you. But I can read body language, and I know your history."

"I'm here with my wife."

"I know that, too. I met Chrissy last night. Great woman." She smiled for the camera. "Think she's having a good time with Brigitte's husband?"

Colette knew about that, too? Did everyone on this yacht?

"It's okay. I'm pretty liberal minded, and I love hearing Liz's stories about Brigitte, Marc, and Cornell. I may teach kids, but I'm not totally naive."

"That's a wrap," the photographer said.

Colette relaxed her smile. I did too. "Besides, Marc is hot. I'd totally fuck him, with or without my husband's permission." She added, "And there's no way that I'd get his permission."

"You're married?" The revelation would have made her easier to talk to if she hadn't also just admitted to being a willing cheater.

"Ten years. He had to stay home to work, though. Can you believe it? His loss."

"Definitely."

Brigitte corralled us after that. "Sweet. Now that we got the photos out of the way, it's time to start pre-partying. Hope you all brought your bathing

suits. We'll hang out here for a couple hours before heading back in."

She turned and headed for the master cabin with Liz before pausing. "You coming, Stephen? You left your suit in our room."

I felt all their eyes on me. My face had never felt so hot.

*

Down in the cabin, Liz turned to Brigitte. "My face hurts from all that smiling," she said.

Brigitte laughed. "And we've only just begun."

Brigitte went straight to her phone, which she'd left charging. A smile broke across her face as soon as she checked it. My chest tightened.

"*Tell Stephen thank you for me,*" she read. "Hey, Stephen, Marc says, *thank you.*"

I was struck dumb. They'd done it. They'd fucked.

"Want details?" She tossed me the phone. "It's not a blow-by-blow, but it's enough."

I nearly dropped it, fumbling it between my hands. Brigitte started unlacing Liz's wedding gown as I stared down at the phone like a bomb about to explode. I dropped down onto the bed and took a deep breath before looking.

—sorry you couldn't go snorkeling. was beautiful

—lunch on the beach. don't we make a good looking couple?

That was followed up by another photo of the two of them smiling up at the camera—this time an obvious selfie with Marc's thick arm extended forward.

—she's so cute, but you were right, babe. she's got a dirty side to her

—you owe me a tenner. she's totally shaved

I must have read that line ten times before I moved on. They were just words on the screen, right?

The next text wasn't time stamped for another hour.

—taking the long way back to the resort. like the view?

The photo was one of Chrissy, standing at the prow of their small vessel, facing the ocean. She was naked, her arms clutching the railing, her hip cocked to one side as the breeze caught her hair. The jolt that ran through me was numbing.

—home sweet home. ready for round two. hope your day's just as fun

That text was fifteen minutes ago. There was nothing else. I felt hollowed out, a shell of Stephen Warren. Blow on me and I would have crumbled.

“You okay, Stephen?” Brigitte’s voice was gentler than I would have expected.

“I’m...fine.”

When I looked up, I got another shock. As I’d been riveted reading the text messages on Brigitte’s phone, the two women had stripped out of their dresses and were down to their underwear. Liz wore classic bridal lingerie—white corset, garters, stockings, lacy white bra and panties. Brigitte wore a satin bra and thong that was coral to match her dress.

“You sure?” she asked.

Liz looked at the seat of my pants. “At least part of him appears fine.”

I was erect, yes. My face burned, but it was true and I couldn’t deny it. I took the phone, tapped on Marc’s name, and pressed *dial*. It began to ring.

“What are you doing?” Brigitte asked, stepping in my direction.

“I don’t know. Checking to see if they’re okay?” I really didn’t know why I was calling. I was beyond rational thinking at that point. Part of me still clung to the belief that this was all some elaborate, fucked up game, and hoped that this phone call would prove that. Or disprove that. Or, fuck, I didn’t know!

The phone rang enough times that I figured no one would answer. I started to hang up, relief flooding in.

Then, someone did.

“Hey, babe.” It was Marc, but he barely registered through sound of a woman’s cries.

“Oh, my God!” Yup, that was Chrissy and her Michigan accent moaning as Marc fucked her.

“It’s, um, Stephen, actually,” I said.

“Oh, hey man.” He paused, although Chrissy’s moans didn’t slow. “Want to talk to Chris?”

I didn’t know the answer, but my gut was to say no. Too late, I heard him pass the phone down to her. Her moans filled the receiver so much that I had to pull away. Brigitte and Liz heard it.

“Hey—” Her greeting was broken by a sharp cry. “Hey, Steph—eee!”

“Hey, Chris. You okay?”

“Oh, my God, yes! Yes!” I didn’t know if that was her response to me, or to Marc’s cock, which in my head outclassed my own by a large margin. I decided that she was talking to me.

“Okay, good, just making sure.”

“Oh, Stephen, I’ve been such a bad girl.”

“So I hear.” I felt strangely calm, despite the fact that my entire world was being re-structured around me.

“Uhhh, yes!” she cried. “Right there. Right—there!”

I wanted to touch my cock so badly, but remembered I wasn’t alone. Brigitte and Liz slid in on either side of me, their heads pressed close enough to hear the action down the line.

“Thank you so much for letting me...spend the day with Marc,” Chrissy said. “He knows how to treat a lady.”

Brigitte laughed quietly.

I said, “Sounds like it.”

“His cock’s not so bad either, is it?” Brigitte said.

I glared at her, mouthing for her to stop, but it was too late.

“Brigitte?”

Liz spoke next. “Hey, Chrissy. You get used to the size yet?”

Chrissy sighed. “Took some time, but now I am, yes.”

“Doesn’t it feel amazing?” Brigitte asked.

“So amazing.”

My gut clenched. She knew I was listening, right? She must have set the phone down. There was a muffling sound, followed by her heavy breathing. I tried to compose something to say, something to regain some semblance of control.

“I am so horny,” Liz said beside me. “I need a cock. Now.”

She reached for my zipper, and had her fingers wrapped around my cock, but I composed myself. “Liz, no.”

“Why not?” she whined. “Your wife doesn’t seem to have issue with fucking around.”

I heard a slap on the other end of the phone, followed a sharp moan from Chrissy. Was he spanking her? My guard dropped for a second and Liz took advantage. She slipped down to her knees and fished my cock out.

I gasped as Liz’s mouth wrapped around me. The phone fell from my hands. My body shuddered. This was wrong. I knew that I couldn’t do this—shouldn’t do this—but Liz’s mouth felt so good as she bobbed up and down my length.

Brigitte picked up the phone. “Chrissy, are you there?”

Brigitte watched Liz blow me as she waited for my wife to respond. I knew that expression—she couldn’t wait to join in. “Enjoying some black cock, Chrissy? Sounds like it.”

Brigitte pushed her free hand into her panties. She took a deep breath. “Listen, you mind if I borrow your husband for the afternoon? He’s got such a good looking cock.”

I stiffened, but my protest was held in check by Liz’s expert mouth. I knew my wife. She’d tell Brigitte yes out of a sense of balance. She’d let her guilt make this choice.

“Thank you, baby.” Brigitte looked up at me like a predator. “Put Marc back on please.”

She waited.

“Hey, babe... Enjoy her, because later tonight, you’re going to make it up to me.” She laughed at whatever was said. “I’m sure you will. Just go gentle. She’s not used to one so big.”

Brigitte looked down at my cock, passing in and out of Liz’s mouth.

“Although it’s not like she’s accustomed to small.”

Brigitte reached back and released her tits from her bra. Her tits sagged a little more than when she was a twenty-year-old, but still looked magnificent. She slipped off the bed, circled around behind Liz, and sank to her knees.

“Send me those pics when you’re done. Hearing this has been great, but I’d love to see... A video? A video would be even better.” She leaned in and kissed Liz on the back of her neck. The bride-to-be still had her hair up, so it was easy. “See you later, babe. And I want you to make that slut scream.”

Tossing the phone down, she looked up at me. “Ever had a double blowjob?”

She didn’t wait for an answer. The women moved with choreographed precision. Liz released me, kissing down my shaft to my balls. Brigitte took her place, sucking me aggressively. I shuddered, throwing my head back.

The sensation of two warm mouths on me was too much. Any sense of protest was lost in the heady fog of the blowjob.

Brigitte pulled back. Liz filled the void, going back to work on my shaft as Brigitte pumped me.

“I’ve been waiting for this,” she said. “Ever since Liz told me about your RSVP, I’ve known that this moment would come.”

She stood, hooking her thumbs into her thong. I watched her, entranced, as she tugs the straps down her hips. Her stomach was flat and fit. I followed the V from her hip bones down to her mound as the thong slid lower and lower.

She said, “You’re even sexier than you were back then. I can’t wait to fuck you.”

She revealed her pussy, and where I’d been expecting a landing strip, she was now as bare as Chrissy.

Chrissy. My wife. She didn’t want this. And...and I couldn’t do this to her.

“You’re going to have to wait a lot longer,” I said. Somehow, I found the willpower to push Liz away. The brunette resisted, but I managed to crawl back and stand. Brigitte looked incredulous.

“Really?”

“Really.” I scanned Brigitte’s hourglass nudity as I stuffed my cock back into my pants. Could I really walk out on that? “Sorry to disappoint.”

I grabbed my swimming trunks and got the hell out of there. I was all kinds of fucked up—my wife was getting her daylights fucked out of her—but denying Brigitte, after her careful orchestration, felt like a win.

I ducked into a bathroom, changed into my swimsuit, and waited for my erection to subside. This was going to be a long fucking afternoon.

*

Those two hours could have been relaxing if I hadn’t just received irrefutable proof that Chrissy had finally crossed the line. Everything else

paled when compared to that—Brigitte in her floral-print string bikini, the way the sun glittered off the deep, blue ocean, even my first-ever dual blowjob.

I was hard and spent most of my time trying to keep my cock down. At least I wasn't the only guy having that issues. I noticed Harry at the very least slip away to the bathroom only to emerge more in control.

As the yacht made its slow course back to shore, I was filled with equal parts excitement and pure dread. What would I find back in the hotel room? What would I walk in on?

Brigitte gathered us one last time as the pier came into view. "One last toast before Liz and Cornell become married and boring. Liz, I love you like a sister... Well, maybe a little closer than a sister." We laughed. "I wanted to tell you how happy I am for you. There's not a man on this planet that is worthy of you, but I suppose Cornell comes close enough. And Cornell, she's special. Don't fuck this one up."

"Yes, ma'am," he said.

"To the two of you."

"And to getting laid," Liz added.

"Here, here!" Cornell agreed.

Brigitte rolled her eyes, but was the first to raise her glass and shout, "Cheers!"

*

Back on the mainland, Brigitte walked with me towards the elevators. "How are you feeling?"

"Tired," I said. "And a little tipsy. I can't believe it's only three in the afternoon."

"Drinking in the sun all day will do that to you. Take a nap. You need to have your strength for later tonight."

"Oh yeah?"

"Yeah." The elevator doors opened and we got on, just the two of us.

"I don't think I'm going to be able to take a nap," I said. "Too much on my mind."

"Well, I'd invite you up to my room, but as the maid of honor, I've actually got no time." She touched my face affectionately. It was a

testimony to just how much I did have on my mind that her suggestion barely registered. “Try to rest. You’ll feel better. Promise.”

The elevator stopped on five. Brigitte kissed my cheek. “Be down on the beach at least an hour ahead of time.”

Last night’s apprehension had nothing on this moment, right now. Each step seemed to make the hall even longer, the walls even tighter, my heart race even faster. I both wanted this walk to last forever, yet had to hold back the urge to sprint it.

I stepped up to the door at last, my ears perked up, listening. I didn’t hear moans, but that didn’t mean anything. They could still be in there, sleeping together. God, somehow the thought of Chrissy snuggling with another man was so much worse than her moaning on the end of his cock.

I slipped the keycard in quietly and opened the door. The quiet of the room yawned out before me. I stepped into its thickness, my heartbeat thundering in my ears.

It was empty. The bed was made, the sheets turned down crisply in the way that only professional housekeeping could achieve. The doors to the balcony were open, a breeze rustling the curtains, but the balcony was also empty. She wasn’t here.

Okay, so maybe *this* was worse than walking in on them snuggling. At least if she was here, I’d have a chance to see her, to kiss her, to ask her if we were good. Instead, alone in my room with no way to contact her, the isolation was crippling.

I searched for signs of her—of them. I went into the bathroom. The towels were neatly folded and hung. The open bottles of shampoo and soap lined up. Counters were wiped down. It all looked like a...well, like a hotel room.

Sighing, I stripped out of my clothes and entered the shower. I had sunblock and sweat caked on me, but I was trying to wash away something much less tangible: panic.

What if Chrissy fell in love with Marc? He was charming. What if he changed her expectations of what a lover could really be? What if today marked the end of our marriage? Maybe I should just cut ties now. I could pack my bags. I could change my flight and be out of here by nightfall—

No. What the fuck are you thinking, man? You made this mistake already and somehow, you ended up with Chris, you lucky asshole. Don’t make the same mistake twice.

I shut my eyes and faced the shower spray, letting my conscience, or whatever, wash over me. It was right. I'd been here before, and had run the other direction. Maybe I could have worked it out with Brigitte, maybe not, but it wasn't *Brigitte* that I needed to work it out with anymore. It was Chrissy, and with Chrissy—for Chrissy—I'd never stop trying.

Of course, all that romantic bullshit came crashing down when I exited the shower, dried off, and found the torn foil of a condom wrapper behind the toilet.

I picked it up, my body numb, my brain lagging a second behind. I ran my thumb across the gold foil, tracing the label—Trojan Magnum XLs. Of course they were. I pulled on a robe without bothering to belt it and wandered out into the bedroom, wrapper still in hand.

They'd been here. They'd *fucked* here. I looked at the bed, seeing Chrissy on her hands and knees, her ass up, as Marc fucked her from a standing position. *Oh, my God*, she moaned in my imagination.

No, not imagination. Memory. I'd heard them. I'd listened. Was this where they were when I'd called?

Oh, Stephen, I've been such a bad girl.

I drifted by the bed like a ghost, heading for the patio. Was that my imagination, or could I smell sex in the air as I passed?

Outside was better. All I could smell was the salt on the breeze. I looked out over the resort grounds once again, wondering if I'd see Chrissy and Marc somewhere. I didn't find them, although I could see the wedding being set up down on the beach. Brigitte was directing hotel staff to form a semicircle of white, folding chairs that looked out on the ocean.

I looked at the clock back inside. Two hours before the wedding began, which meant one hour for me to kill. I slumped into one of the cushioned loungers on the balcony, intending to rest my eyes for a minute or two.

The next thing I knew, I was asleep.

Chapter 11:

The Wedding

I didn't dream. After becoming so used to wild, sexual dreams over the last few months, I *didn't* dream. It was weird. So weird, in fact, that when someone shook me awake and I opened my eyes to Chrissy peering down at me, for a second, I thought that this entire trip had been a dream—that we were back home and things were back to where they were.

But then I noticed how Chrissy's freckles had come out in force, the way they always did when she got sun. She had a flower tucked behind her ear, and her hair was curlier than normal. I could hear waves hissing up and down the beach.

"Wake up, Stephen. You're late."

I blinked. "What time is it?"

"Twenty minutes to five. And you're not even dressed."

It took another five seconds for the time to sink in. The wedding started in twenty minutes—*the wedding that I was in*.

I bolted up. My robe fell open, revealing my nudity. Chrissy looked, giggling. She reached for my cock—which was hard from the afternoon version of morning wood. "You have some naughty dreams?"

I looked at Chrissy, remembering what *she'd* been up to all afternoon. If my nerves hadn't been frayed by the abrupt wake-up, or I wasn't in danger of fucking up Liz's big day, this is where we would have some show and tell. Still, I couldn't just leave it alone.

I grabbed her and pulled her close, kissing her passionately. She tasted minty fresh. She'd brushed recently, and when I considered why she must have done that, I kissed her even harder.

"Are we good?" she asked.

She was here. She was still my Chrissy. And that kiss was proof that Marc hasn't replaced me. "Yeah, we're good."

"Good." Chrissy giggled.

"So where were you?" I said. "I came home and you weren't here."

She kissed me again, softly this time. "Someone had to take care of the groomsmen. I was hoping you'd be there, too, but that's your loss."

My face went white. Or it felt like that, anyway. But again, my cock betrayed me, and this time, it was in Chrissy's hand as it did so, practically throbbing.

"Seriously?" she said. "You really thought I'm the kind of girl who'd go for a gang bang?"

She hadn't? "Um. Not sure anymore."

"And it turns you on, thinking of me with all those guys." Chrissy giggled. "This weekend has certainly been one of self-discovery, hasn't it?"

"No. That's...that's not a kink of mine."

She released me, clearly not buying it. "Come on. There's even less time to get ready now."

We moved into efficiency mode. I rooted through my suitcase for a new pair of boxers and socks as Chrissy laid out the tux.

"Well, at least it's not too wrinkled," she said. "No time to worry about the crease in the legs."

I got a chance to look at her for the first time as I yanked on those trousers. She wore a new dress that I'd not seen before. While it wasn't short and tight like the dresses Brigitte always wore, it was definitely a departure from Chrissy's comfort zone. The strapless, chocolate brown dress cinched high on her waist, just below her breasts. It wasn't tight on her diminutive body, but it did end about three inches above her knees, offering an incredible expanse of her dancer's legs.

"Come on, Stephen, no time for that." Chrissy's smile indicated that she only half meant it.

"I love that dress."

Her smile turned wicked. "So did Marc."

I gasped, a wave of heat racing through me.

"Tell you about it later. After the wedding. Now seriously, let's get you dressed."

*

"There you are!" Brigitte said. She looked pissed. To Chrissy, she said, "Thanks for getting him. Jesus, we've got three minutes before this is supposed to start."

I felt terrible for oversleeping, but tried to make the best of it. "I was just acting on doctor's orders."

Brigitte glared at me, but the smile formed anyway. “Get up there with the other guys. I’ll go tell Liz that we’re ready.” She turned and strode away without looking back.

“I’ll take my seat,” Chrissy said. “You can thank me for saving your ass properly later.”

“Thanks.”

The scene had been fully set since I’d looked down just before my unplanned nap. The chairs were set up—seating for about thirty guests. A wooden walkway covered in rose petals created a central aisle that stopped at a dais. On the dais was the wedding official—an actual minister, which surprised me—and off to the right stood Harry, Jay, and Cornell. If they were annoyed with my lateness, they didn’t show it.

“Glad you could join us, man,” Jay said as he shook my hand.

“Sorry about that. This afternoon took it out of me.”

Cornell grinned. “I bet it did.”

“So what am I supposed to do here? Follow the lead? Stand. Sit. Walk out?”

“You got it. It won’t be a long ceremony, don’t worry. Make sure you smile for the photos the whole time. You walk out last, with Colette. Then we party.”

“I can do that.”

I looked out over the small gathering. A string quartet was set up in the back. An older couple sat in the front, just before us—Cornell’s parents, I guessed based on their Indian heritage. I saw Liz’s mom, too. The rest of the crowd was younger—friends of Liz and Cornell’s. For a destination wedding, it was pretty well attended. I recognized a few of the faces from school. Some had barely changed since we’d graduated. Others were barely recognizable. I wondered what they thought of me, now 37.

Chris sat in the second row on the bride’s side—not that there really were sides. Beside her sat Marc, wearing a bright blue shirt beneath his crisp black suit. No tie. He couldn’t have looked the part of “stylish man attending beach wedding” any better, and sitting right next to Chrissy, they looked good together. My chest tightened.

Chrissy waved at me, her eyes darting to Marc. I offered a weak smile in return. It wasn’t like Marc had his arm around her or anything. Other than proximity, they didn’t appear to be a couple. But they had the connection of lovers, intangible yet so apparent. At least to me.

The wedding anthem filled the air, driving back my thoughts. I looked down the aisle to see Liz approach, looking radiant in her wedding dress. Her father—presumably, since I’d never met the guy—held her arm, but all eyes were on the bride, and her eyes were all for Cornell.

I remember my wedding with Chrissy. It had been more traditional than this one. Much bigger. We had organ music playing the wedding march, rather than a string quartet. We had lousy weather. My mom had been an overbearing bitch all day. Traffic had held up about a third of our guests.

But most of all, I remember that smile—the one that Liz had for Cornell in the moment—the one that Chrissy offered me now, when I found her in the crowd. It was radiant. It muted all the crazy in the world down to something manageable and said, *This thing we’re about to do? Let’s do it together.*

I, Cornell Mann, take thee, Elizabeth Burke, to be my wedded wife...to have and to hold from this day forward...

I, Elizabeth Burk, take thee, Cornell Mann, to be my wedded husband...to love and to cherish...

...for better or worse...

...till death us do part.

I listened to the vows, but heard Chrissy and me. My wife wiped a tear from her eye. She looked at me the whole time, and more than ever, I wished I’d turned down the invitation to be a groomsman. I wanted to be at her side, holding her hand, not up here on stage.

“You may kiss the bride.”

There were cheers. There were whistles. We watched Cornell pull Liz into his arms and plant a borderline inappropriate kiss on her lips. Watching the two of them make their way down the aisle together, I felt hopeful for their new life together—and maybe realized for the first time that I’d been skeptical of it.

Harry left. Then Jay. Then me, collecting Colette on my arm.

“That was beautiful,” she whispered once we’d stepped off the walkway and into the sand.

“Yeah. So what now?”

Brigitte came up to us. “Well, since we already did photos, you two are off the hook. Reception’s on the restaurant veranda. Go and have fun!”

“Easiest wedding I’ve ever been part of,” I said.

Brigitte laughed. "Speak for yourself."

*

I found Chrissy with Marc after that. They were waiting for me at their seats, although they were now standing like everyone else. The photographer was setting up a shoot for the parents.

"You need to stay for this?" Chrissy asked.

I glanced at Marc. They weren't standing arm-in-arm or anything, but they were close enough that my blood pressure rose.

"Nope. I'm off the hook."

"Great. Let's get some drinks."

I looked at Marc, not sure what to say to the guy who'd spent the afternoon in bed with my wife. He helped, sticking his hand out to shake. "Hey, Stephen, you look good in a tux."

There was meaning in that handshake, although I didn't know what. Chrissy watched it, too, and when we released our hands, she folded her arms around me and hugged my side.

"He does look handsome, doesn't he?" she said.

"I'll see you two at the reception. I'm going to hang back and see if Brigitte needs any help."

I wanted to thank Marc for giving me some alone time with Chrissy, although my fear was already fading. She was still at my side, still the smiling, cheerful woman I'd married. I hadn't lost her.

We walked along the wooded path between beach and resort, our fingers interlaced. "It was a nice wedding," Chrissy said.

"Yeah. Liz and Cornell look happy."

"They do." She squeezed my hand. "How about you? Happy?"

Happy was definitely not the appropriate word, but I couldn't think of a better one, so I nodded. "I can't believe...this afternoon."

I could feel Chrissy looking at me as we walked on. "Me either."

"Did you have fun?" I looked, meeting her thoughtful gaze.

"Yes." She sounded meek. "I was a bad girl."

My pants tightened. "I heard."

Her voice was practically a whisper. "Oh, you have no idea."

"Then give me an idea."

“He did things to me.” She shivered. “And I can’t wait to do them again.”

That tightness in my pants grew painful. “Like?”

Chrissy grew red. “I can’t explain it.”

I squeezed her hand. “Try?”

“Okay. Um...he was just so dominant. It was just so...”

“Different?” I offered.

Chrissy giggled. “Understatement, but sure.” She paused. When she spoke next, her tone was neutral to the point of being unnatural. “How was your afternoon? You have fun?”

I heard the delicacy in her question. “I did, but mostly I was thinking about you.”

“Uh huh, right. I’m sure Brigitte helped keep you distracted.”

“Nothing happened. We didn’t...not like you and Marc.”

“I saw the pic.”

The dick pic. Of course. I stopped myself before I explained. “Did it make you upset?”

“Maybe a little. But don’t worry, I got even shortly after that. Now come on, let’s get drinks.”

I lagged behind her, unable to get my feet working. She seemed to put an extra swing in her hips, and while the dress was far from tight, it still made her ass look great. I ran my fingers through my hair, found my breath, and followed.

*

I nursed that first glass of wine, and noticed Chrissy doing the same. Subconsciously, maybe, we’d taken Brigitte’s advice about good wedding night sex to heart. It wasn’t our wedding night, but we were damn sure going to have good sex.

The reception was about as perfect as the wedding had been. The string quartet had relocated to the veranda, where it played as the sun set on the ocean. Cake was cut. Toasts were made. Dinner was plated and served. The bridal party was set up at a head table, so once again I had to sit apart from Chrissy and watch her flirt with Marc. And this time, the flirting seemed more flagrant.

“You okay?” Brigitte asked, making sure she had the seat next to me.

“With?”

She looked at me flatly, not believing that I didn’t know exactly what she was talking about. “Yeah, I am, actually. More than I thought I would be.”

“You haven’t stormed off yet and refused to accept her calls, so that’s a positive.”

It was a tease, but it cut deep. “You know that was different, right?”

“Or maybe you’re different,” she said.

Sure, of course I was different. That was exactly the thing. Brigitte wasn’t, and while she may have had me wrapped around her finger back in my early twenties, she didn’t carry the same power anymore.

“Chrissy’s different, too.”

Brigitte swirled the wine in her glass. “I have a video that says maybe not so different.”

I took a hard breath, my body buzzing.

“Want to see it?” She had me, and judging from that sly smile, she knew it. “Maybe later,” she said.

As we rolled through the speeches and the cake cutting, the first dances and the rest of the wedding formalities, I thought about what Brigitte had said. I thought about who I was back then, who I am now, and what I was comfortable with. I’d walked out on Brigitte when she’d slept with another man. I would have done the same thing had I been dating Chrissy back then. But Chrissy never would have done that—she never would have made the assumption that I’d be okay with it. She possessed a level of empathy that Brigitte didn’t have—not back then, and not now.

And that was the real difference—Chrissy wasn’t Brigitte, and I didn’t want her to be like Brigitte. The thought of my wife with Marc was hot as hell, but it also scared the shit out of me because it meant that in some way, she was turning into my ex.

I found Chrissy on the dance floor with Marc. I felt queasy watching them, so comfortable in each other’s arms. I hated the way she stared up at him. I could recognize infatuation when I saw it, and Chris had that for another man.

“Hey, Steve, how’s it going?” I turned to Cornell, who stepped up beside me. He had a glass of water in his hand. He held it up. “I’m taking Brigitte’s advice. Dude, I’m so horny right now I feel like I’m going to explode. I don’t want to pass out on my big night.”

I nodded, trying to care about his problem. It was hard. “Wouldn’t want to do that.”

“So I just wanted to say that I know about you and Liz...”

Suddenly he had all of my attention. Shame struck me like a fireball. It was a testament to the craziness of the day that Liz’s almost blowjob barely registered as a memory.

“I went to college, too,” Cornell continued. “I know that you two were close and that things happen. I want you to know that I’m cool with it. Water under the bridge.”

He was talking about our hookup back in school. Did he even know about earlier, on the yacht? I decided not to mention it.

“Hey, it was a long time ago,” I said. “I’m glad she found a good guy. She deserves it.”

“Thanks, man.” He shook my hand, then mingled on to the next group.

I found that the glass of wine I’d been nursing was empty. To get a refill or not, that was the question—mostly because it was the easiest thing to occupy my time. What the hell, last night in the Virgin Islands, I figured I’d indulge. I headed to the bar.

Colette was at the back of a long line for drinks. “Where have all these people come from?” I asked the redhead. “It didn’t look like this many when everyone was seated out on the beach.”

Colette laughed. “Yeah, I think we’ve got a few wedding crashers. But who cares, some of them are pretty cute.”

I thought about her husband back at home, completely oblivious to the fact that his wife was sizing up total strangers. I put myself in his shoes and it made me feel sick. Casual infidelity like that wasn’t something that came naturally to me, even knowing that my wife had spent the afternoon fucking another man.

“I guess so.”

“You’re pretty cute, too, you know,” she said, looking me up and down.

Colette was pretty, for sure, even with the extra ten pounds, but she wasn’t even a temptation. “Thanks. Chris tells me that all the time. I never believe her.”

The hint was subtle, but Colette picked up on it. “Well, she’s lucky.”

We spent the next couple minutes awkwardly waiting to get to the front of the line and refill our drinks. Colette went for a strong whiskey-

ginger ale while I opted for another glass of wine. Surprisingly, Colette didn't immediately fade onto the dance floor. Instead, she held up her lowball glass.

"To being on vacation," she toasted.

I clinked glasses with her.

"I know you probably think badly of me, but remember, you don't know anything about my life."

I didn't, and now that she called me out on it, I felt ashamed. "I'm sorry. You're right."

"It's okay. I'm not saying it's right or anything." She looked out onto the dance floor. "But I take my vacations seriously. And I'm pretty sure that my husband does, too, if you know what I mean. We've been together for ten years, so this works for us."

I nodded. I didn't need to agree with a thing to understand it. "What happens on vacation stays on vacation. Got it."

"Hey, no one's a saint." She checked me with her hip. "I know you and your wife aren't."

My face lit up. Did she know? Were we that obvious? "What's that mean?"

Colette just smiled. "Have a nice night, Stephen. It's time for me to find someone to make mine nice, too."

I watched her move onto the dance floor, where cheesy wedding pop had gotten the floor moving. I felt sick. Reviewing the facts, I'm not sure why I'd thought we'd been sneaky at all. The whole wedding party saw Brigitte, Liz, and me go back into the yacht's cabin. They knew that we'd taken more time than was necessary to change. And Colette knew that Chrissy had been with Marc. It didn't take a genius to jump to some easy conclusions.

I felt exposed and didn't like it. I went into the back, in search of the bathrooms—to throw up, to splash water on my face, I didn't know. I passed the first door, which was occupied, and locked myself in the second. The restroom was well appointed and private, complete with a fancy sink that looked more like the fountain at a Buddhist temple than anything functional.

I settled in before the sink, staring at my wan face when whoever was in the neighboring bathroom pounded loudly on the wall. My head snapped over as if I could see through the drywall. The bang didn't come again, but

now that I was aware of something going on, I heard it: the steady, panting breaths of sex. Someone was getting bathroom sex, right next door.

I glanced up, seeing the air conditioning duct high in the ceiling. There was the source of my sound. I smiled to myself. We were in a hotel. Bedrooms were only an elevator ride away, yet here were two people who couldn't wait for it. Considering how on edge I was, I couldn't really blame them.

"Damn, you feel so fucking good."

I froze at the man's voice. I recognized that voice with its soft English accent. Cornell Mann.

"I can't believe you made me wait for it." I heard a grunt, followed by what must have been a slap. Or a spank. "This is what you get for the incomplete BJ just before the ceremony."

I grinned to myself, thinking about our earlier conversation. *I'm so horny I could explode*. Liz had kept him at bay since they'd arrived, but I had to chuckle at that last sentiment. Looks like I wasn't the only one she'd left hanging. Sounded like she was finally getting her due.

The sounds of fucking grew harder. I exited the bathroom quietly, not wanting to alert them that I'd been there. My heart was pounding, but now for a completely different set of reasons. I wanted to find Chrissy. It was time to reclaim my wife.

I made it out into the main space of the club when Liz came up to me. I blinked, confused, thinking maybe this was a sister that I hadn't met until now, for some reason. But she still wore her white dress, her veil still pinned in her dark hair.

"Liz?"

"Hey, Stephen. Have you seen Cornell? I can't find him."

My stomach sank. The blood ran out of my face. "I haven't," I said. Technically, it wasn't a lie. I hadn't *seen* him. But some gut instinct told me to withhold the truth.

"Huh, weird. I was hoping to slip out of here a little early." She wiggled her eyebrows at me.

I faked a laugh. "Ready to give up your virginity?"

Liz laughed. "After the last week of abstinence, it'll probably feel like I'm a virgin."

"I bet." Who was Cornell with in the bathroom? I assumed Brigitte, but when I looked past Liz, I spotted her dancing with Marc. Then a much

colder idea dawned on me. It numbed my body. Could he be with Chrissy?

“Hey, listen,” Liz said, resting a hand on my arm. “About earlier...on the yacht.”

Her words arrived as if on an audio delay. I processed them slowly. “Yeah?”

“I should apologize for that. I...I don’t know what came over me.”

“Um...don’t worry about it.” It wasn’t really an appropriate reply, but I was too busy thinking about Cornell in the bathroom, slamming his cock into my wife. I checked the dance floor again. She wasn’t there. Panic started penetrating the numbness.

Liz was wringing her fingers together. “Could we maybe just forget that ever happened? I mean, Cornell doesn’t need to know.”

Reality caught up to me. The lag was gone. This was real. “Sure. Our secret. And Brigitte’s.”

Liz released a breath. “I’ve already talked to her. Thanks. Now, time to find my husband.”

“Maybe check the veranda?” I said, pointing in the opposite direction of the bathrooms. Their marriage was off to a rocky start, but the last thing I wanted was a scene that potentially involved my wife.

“I checked there, but yeah, maybe I missed him.” Off she went.

I considered storming in on them. For the first time in my life, I really considered violence a viable option. I took a long, deep breath, checking the dance floor again. Chrissy was definitely not out there, but neither was Colette, or Meg, or any number of women attendees.

Fighting back the panic, I picked my way out onto the veranda, taking my own advice. Of course, she wasn’t out there, either. I moved to the railing that overlooked the grounds. The pool was empty, but still lit up from submerged lamps. That could have been a photo right out of the catalog.

Brigitte appeared at my side. I practically jumped. “Peaceful, isn’t it?”

“Feels like the calm before the storm,” I said.

Brigitte looked at me questioningly. “You okay?”

I almost told her about my suspicions before I realized who I was dealing with. She didn’t care. If anything, she would probably try and convince me that deep down I thought it was hot. I didn’t, did I?

“Want to see that video now?” she asked.

I stared at her, puzzling out what the hell she was talking about. Then it hit me. She had a video of Chrissy fucking Marc. Or something like that. Suddenly, that act became so tame.

“Yeah, show me.”

“How ‘bout we go somewhere more private.” She glanced up at the balconies of the resort rooms. “My room’s free. At least for a little while longer.”

I looked back into her large, blue eyes, and saw the instrument of my destruction. Did Brigitte even realize how she’d shattered the comfortable life I had with my wife? Probably not. Not that it mattered any longer. What was done was done. Now, I just wanted to revenge fuck her.

“Lead on.”

Chapter 12:

The Video

Brigitte and Marc's room was on the top floor of the resort. It was also substantially larger than ours, featuring a kitchenette, an in-room jacuzzi, and enough floor space to host a small reception here alone.

She led me through the room and out to balcony, which was also much larger than those on the lower levels. Because it was on the top floor, it opened up to the star-filled tropical night sky. She shut the doors behind us, then moved to one of the white wicker benches that sat on the far side of the balcony. She patted the spot next to her and held up her phone.

The bravado I'd felt just five minutes before fled. This was wrong, no matter what Chrissy was currently doing. And that was the thing, I didn't know that it was her in the bathroom. For all I knew, she could have been looking for me at the same time. Or maybe she'd swung back to our room to grab something. From what I understood about Cornell and Liz's lifestyle, they weren't strangers to, well, strangers. It made sense that another of his former lovers was here.

But uncertain how to get out of this situation, I drifted to Brigitte's side and took a seat next to her. The wicker crunched beneath me. Brigitte smelled good.

"I've only got one clip, but I think you're going to like it." She handed me her phone. I hesitated. This was it. I wouldn't be able to un-see this. Glancing down, I saw an image of Chrissy leaning on the doorframe of the hotel room, dressed in nothing but her red string bikini. How could I resist that? I took the phone from Brigitte and hit play.

"Hey, there," Chrissy's recording said. *"Filming this, are you? Put that thing away."*

"For your husband," Marc responded, his voice louder, closer. He was holding the camera. *"Want to pass along any messages?"*

Chrissy giggled. She focused right on the camera. *"Hello, Stephen. This is your wife, just wanting to say thank you for this afternoon."*

She detached herself from the doorframe and approached the camera. Her nipples were hard enough to pierce the flimsy bikini top.

"And what did you do this afternoon?" Marc asked.

The camera dipped enough to reveal that Marc was stretched out on a bed, his legs bare. Chrissy crawled onto the bed, right up between Marc's legs. Wide-eyed, she whispered, *"I slept with another man."*

Marc's hand reached out to touch Chrissy's cheek. She'd pulled her hair back in a ponytail, although a couple sassy bangs had escaped. *"You had a nap with another man?"*

Chrissy laughed softly, shaking her head. *"We didn't do much sleeping."*

He stroked her cheek. She nuzzled against the touch. *"What then?"*

She looked right into the camera, her demure expression falling away. *"I sucked his cock."*

"Did you like it?"

"Mmm hmm."

"She's so cute," Brigitte whispered. I'd forgotten she was there at all, watching with me. "So innocent."

The camera shifted again as Chrissy reached out and wrapped her hand around Marc's swollen cock. That had to be a trick of the angle. It looked huge in Chrissy's hands.

"Well, maybe not so innocent."

To the camera, Chrissy said, *"I can't seem to get enough of this cock. Isn't it beautiful?"*

She lowered her head and ran her tongue along the side of it. It wasn't even fully erect, I realized, watching it flop in her hand—although her attention was quickly changing that.

"Tell your husband what else we did."

Chrissy lapped at Marc's growing erection a few more times before glancing up at the camera. She reached behind her back, pulled the bow of her bikini top, and freed her breasts. She never looked away from the camera, even as she pulled the top off and tossed it away. She wanted me to watch her. To see how comfortable she was with this guy.

"I fucked him."

Marc chuckled. *"You sure did. Stephen, your wife has such a tight, little cunt. But she got used to me. Didn't you, Chrissy?"*

"Oh, yes." She swirled her tongue along the crown of Marc's cock. *"I'm going to be sore tomorrow."*

"Tell your husband how good it felt to fuck me." Marc's words arrived like body blows that I kept taking over and over. *"Tell him how I made you scream."*

Chrissy bit her lip, hesitating before heading down this path.

"Tell him, baby. Trust me, he wants to hear about what a slut you were. It's what all men secretly want."

I didn't think that was true, but there was no sense in arguing with a recording.

"It was really good," she said, almost shyly.

Brigitte beside me stirred again, once again reminding me that I wasn't alone. "You two are perfect for one another. Sweet on the outside, naughty on the inside."

She placed a hand over my crotch, finding my cock hard. I didn't push it away, even as she began stroking me through the tuxedo pants. I reminded myself of what Chrissy had done, not only with Marc, but with Cornell—and right in the bathroom, right beneath my nose. We'd talked about Marc, but Cornell was too far.

"Keep watching," Brigitte said as she lowered my zipper. I didn't stop her. Two could play this game. "I'll provide the extra sensory support."

"Did you come when I fucked you?" Marc asked on film.

"Oh, my goodness, yes."

"Is it making you wet thinking about it now?"

Chrissy stroked the big, black cock in her hand. *"Yeah."*

"Touch yourself."

Chrissy reached between her legs. I had just enough angle to see her slide her fingers between the bikini bottoms.

At the same moment, Brigitte fished out my cock, the rigid flesh hitting the warm night air.

I looked at her. She was watching me. Studying my reaction. "We're about to get to the good part," she said.

"Are you wet?" Marc asked.

"Yeah."

"Wet for this cock?"

"Yes."

"Then suck it, baby. Show your husband what a slut you are for it."

On screen, Chrissy's mouth enveloped Marc's cock at the same time that Brigitte started stroking mine with her hand. I nearly dropped the

phone. I squeezed down on it, staring intently at the video as Chrissy started bobbing along Marc's length.

"Stephen, your wife knows how to suck dick," Marc taunted. "I may have to keep her. I could take her to Paris. Show her around..."

I squirmed. Brigitte matched her handjob to Chrissy's bobs.

"What do you say? Would you like to see Paris, Chrissy?"

Chrissy didn't answer, although the lack of denial spoke just as loudly as anything else. She kept sucking his cock—hands-free, I noticed. One hand supported herself over Marc's glistening body; the other remained out of view between her legs.

"We'd do a little sightseeing. Go out to some of the best restaurants in the world. Maybe a little dancing. And then I'd fuck you all night long."

Again, Chrissy didn't answer with words, but I didn't miss the way her brow furrowed. Or the moan that caught in her throat. Leaving her for most of the day had been hard enough, I'd never be able to survive her taking a trip without me. Just the thought of it was crippling. And yet—

"That excites you," Brigitte said. She kissed me on the neck.

"No," I said, shaking my head.

"I'd make sure you weren't lonely," the blonde said. "We could have a lot of fun keeping each other company."

"You're taking pleasure in this, aren't you," I said.

"Maybe." Her smile infuriated me. I clenched my jaw, grinding down on my molars. My anger only seemed to widen Brigitte's smile. "What?" she asked.

I started to reply when she kissed me. Her tongue pushed past my lips, taking me by surprise. At first, I was too shocked to do anything but sit there and take it. When I gathered my wits, I pushed her away from me.

We stared at one another, each breathing hard. The slurping sounds of Chrissy's blowjob barely registered past the challenge in Brigitte's eyes. *Do it. Fuck me. Take all your frustration out on me.*

My blood pumped like fire in my veins. I grabbed Brigitte and pulled her close, channeling that fury into my kiss. I ran my hand up the back of her thigh, pushing up her dress. She followed my lead, reached beneath it and pulling her thong down. She shoved me into the back of the wicker bench. It snapped and protested beneath us, but held. She straddled me, reaching between us to grab my cock.

Marc's recorded voice cut through the veil of lust. *"Is my little, white girl ready to take my come?"*

The phone was sitting on the cushion next to us, the lurid sight of Chrissy's blowjob playing out to conclusion. She had both hands bracing herself on the mattress as she plunged her head over his lengthy, black cock, swallowing more of him than I thought physically possible.

"This is my favorite part," Brigitte said.

Chrissy pulled her head up and grabbed the spit-slick knob in her hand. She stroked him rapidly, her eyes locked on Marc, just off camera.

"I love how into it she is. Look at the hunger." Brigitte placed my cock against her pussy, slick and smooth. I held my breath, anticipating the warmth of full penetration.

"Beg for it." Marc was the one speaking, but the order may as well have come from Brigitte. She shifted her hips, stroking my cock with her wet pussy. She was so smooth down there, her skin like warm satin.

"I want you to come," Chrissy whispered.

"Not good enough."

"Give me your come."

I gasped, riding the edge of my orgasm. I fought it, but knew that I wouldn't last more than ten seconds if Brigitte fucked me.

"Better. Try again."

Chrissy jerked him with both hands, twisting and stroking the dark shaft in a blur of motion. *"Please come for me. I want your come."*

"Where?"

"All over my face. All over my tits."

My eyes were wide, frozen to that small screen. Was that really my wife saying those words? All I could do was stare as she jerked him off, her eyes fixated now on his cock, ready to blow. I was ready to blow. I felt my cockhead dip inside. Close. So close—

"No," I said.

Brigitte was incredulous. "What?"

"I can't." I pushed her back. It felt so good, and she so deserved it. They all did. But I couldn't.

"Oh, fuck, baby! Here it comes!"

I didn't look, although I wanted to. I was locked in a battle of wills with Brigitte, and I knew that if I faltered for even a moment, she'd have me.

Brigitte began to speak when—

BZZZ! BZZZ!

I blinked, at first confused. Had I been dreaming this whole time? Was that the alarm clock, once again stealing a moment?

But Brigitte didn't disappear, and I didn't suddenly find myself in bed next to my wife. No, this was real. The video on Brigitte's phone dissolved into a photo of a smiling Liz. I groaned. The bride was calling.

Brigitte shifted away from me, sitting on the edge of my thighs. She picked up the phone, looking as puzzled as I was. "What's up, girl?"

I couldn't hear the other end, but it didn't sound good. Liz sounded upset about something. Brigitte slipped off my lap completely. "Slow down. Slow down. What's this now?"

I flopped back in the chair, staring up at the stars. With my pants open and my cock flagging, I felt exposed like I hadn't before. I pulled my trousers back up, then loosened my tuxedo shirt.

My balls throbbed. I'd been jerked around all day. If I didn't get some relief soon, I was going to have to take matters into my own hands after all. I pushed my hands through my hair. They came away damp.

"Be right down." Brigitte hung up the phone and regarded me.

"Everything okay?"

"It will be, yeah. But I'm going to have to leave you for a bit. To be the good friend and all."

I nodded. The moment had passed and things threatened to start getting awkward. I rose with her, ready to follow her out the door.

"Where do you think you're going?" she asked.

"Um... Hadn't really thought about it. Back to the reception to look for Chris, I guess."

Brigitte shook her head. "No, you're staying right here."

"But my wife—"

"Oh, you'll see your wife soon. I only wish I could have been here to watch with you."

My body went cold. So this had been a set-up all along. "They're coming here?"

"Oh, yes." She approached me, once again wielding the full force of her sexuality. She touched my chest. "And you're going to stay out here and watch. Stay silent and observe how much of a slut your wife can be."

"Bree—"

She put a finger to my lips. “No arguing. Do it. Trust me. You’ll like what you see.”

She kissed me softly and left me alone. I almost followed. Almost. Only I didn’t. How could I? Wasn’t this my dream scenario? I’d just been robbed of the climax of Chrissy’s POV blowjob. I wasn’t going to be denied again.

So I ducked inside long enough to turn up the lights a notch. I wanted the glass doors to be completely reflective. Satisfied, I slipped back outside, leaving the doors open about a foot—enough that I’d be able to hear.

Then, I sat on a chair close to the doors and waited, my heart crawling up my throat.

Chapter 13:

Outside Looking In

My watch said that ten minutes had passed when the door to the hotel room finally opened. To my brain, it felt like an eternity. Normally, I would have killed that time playing Candy Crush or reading the news on my phone. But I had no phone. So instead, I was stuck with my thoughts.

Chrissy had spent the day fucking another man. She'd snuck away with a different man no more than an hour ago. What had I awoken in her? Had it always been there?

I thought of Victor, Chrissy's psych TA. What had that been like? She hadn't spoken of him as anything more than a fuck buddy. I hadn't really considered the implications of that until now. It meant that she was capable of having a fuck buddy—a guy she was interested in only for his cock. *My wife* was interested in a guy only for his cock. It was hard to couple that idea with the idea of the woman I'd spent over a third of my life with, but I'd just watched a video that helped.

Please come for me. All over my face. All over my tits.

When had she ever pleaded with me like that? Until I heard her, I wouldn't have thought her capable.

Then there was Cornell's overheard conversation in the bathroom, which took on a whole new meaning.

This is what you get for the incomplete BJ just before the ceremony.

When I'd thought that he was talking to his new bride, the statement had a playful quality to it. Knowing that it was Chrissy he was boning changed everything. Chrissy had sucked his cock earlier? She'd teased him? It was hot—I was beyond the self-denial for now—but it also stung.

I loved that Chrissy was exploring this sexual side of her. Here was a new side of my wife—one that I'd fantasized about but never expected. She'd always been pretty, but she'd never embraced it. Not like Brigitte. Here she was embracing it, and it was fucking awesome.

Hearing her on the phone with Marc, watching that video, those things still made me feel nauseous, but I actually considered that healthy. As soon

as that stopped, it probably meant one of two things: I was starting to get desensitized to the fantasy, or worse, I was starting to care less about it.

But for this to work, it required trust. That was what Brigitte didn't understand, in the end, and why she's with Marc and I'm with Chrissy. I thought Chrissy had understood, too. Then she went off and fucked Cornell in the bathroom. I was more disappointed than heartbroken. I thought that she got me better than Brigitte did, that she understood this fantasy almost more than me, but apparently she didn't.

Inside the room, the door opened. A woman tittered. Chrissy.

Chrissy stepped through the door. Something looked different about her since I'd seen her earlier tonight. She looked more sexual. Her hair was more mussed maybe. She glowed. Was that because of the bathroom sex? Or maybe it was just my imagination.

"You are so bad," she said.

"You're one to speak." Marc followed closely behind her, a hand on her back. That hand sent a shiver up my spine.

"That's all your fault. I'm a good girl."

"With a very naughty one underneath." Marc shut the door and pulled her to a stop. "Take off your dress."

My breath caught. Chrissy stared at Marc over her shoulder, pausing. That moment's hesitation felt good to me. She wasn't totally under his control. She was still my Chrissy.

Then she reached across her breasts to pull the zipper down her side. The chocolate brown dress skimmed down her body.

I gasped at the sight. The lacy bra and panties were new, although I'd spotted them in her suitcase earlier. Brown, to match her dress, the bra was strapless and the panties were closer to a g-string than a thong, the strings joining at the top of her ass in a loopy bow. Her legs looked amazing, bare and sculpted, helped not just by hours of yoga, but by her heels. Those were new, too, and I swear she hadn't been wearing them earlier. During the ceremony, all the women wore flats due to the sand. Had she changed for Marc? That needled, but like all things tonight, in a good way.

"What a body," Marc said. "You really have two children?"

He stepped up to her, running his hand up her arm and down her back. I held my breath, expecting her to hesitate again, to push him away. She did none of that. When he pulled her against him, she welcomed the kiss.

Watching their tongues dance like that was harder to watch than watching Chrissy suck his cock. The POV blowjob was purely sexual. This kiss suggested a level of intimacy that I should have been prepared for, but wasn't.

Marc's hands looked huge as they cupped Chrissy's ass—his dark skin stark against her pale white cheeks. Chrissy placed a hand on the back of Marc's neck. The other snaked between them, covering his crotch.

Marc broke the kiss. "You've been thinking about it, haven't you?"

Chrissy nodded. "Ever since this afternoon."

"Who am I to deny a lady?" He set his hands on her shoulders. She took the hint, dropping to her knees and immediately going to work on his belt. "I wish we'd done this that first afternoon. Think of all the time we've wasted."

Chrissy looked up at him as she freed his cock. It was swollen, but not even half-erect—and still looked huge. I squirmed with insecurity.

"But then I wouldn't have seen any of the island," she said. She wrapped a hand around his shaft—her left hand, her wedding ring flashing.

"We still saw some of it during the morning."

"That was before you seduced me." He began to grow as she pumped him.

"Like you didn't want it. In that red bikini, I was powerless."

"Funny, nothing about you seems powerless." With that, she took his dark meat into her mouth, pumping her head halfway down the veiny shaft.

As Chrissy bobbed her head in his lap, Marc began stripping out of his suit. He tossed the jacket into a chair, then worked open the buttons of his shirt. I'm not into guys, but that didn't mean I didn't immediately see what she meant by her statement. Marc's physique was anything but powerless. He was built like a running back—broad shoulders, thick, corded arms, a muscular chest that I would have assumed was doctored had he not been standing right there. I'd suspected he was fit, but seeing it was intimidating. No wonder Chrissy was so infatuated.

She helped him out of his pants, although the only time her mouth left his cock was to push it against his stomach and work his balls.

"Fucking hell, *mon chéri*. I love what you do to me."

"I love doing it," she said. She sucked him back into her mouth. This time she went deeper, taking more and more of him. When it passed the halfway point, I knew she had to have part of it in her throat.

She yanked her head back with a gasp, stroked her saliva along the length, and plunged it back into her throat.

“You’re a fast learner, my little slut. Not everyone can do that.”

Chrissy repeated the action again and again, deep-throating him, pulling back to breathe, then swallowing more. I knew her well enough to figure out what was going on. She had something to prove. She didn’t want him to just think about her as a fast learner, she wanted him to think of her as the best. And with Brigitte, she knew that she had some fierce competition.

Marc didn’t stand idle as she blew him, though. Once she got into a rhythm, he brushed her hair away, took control of her head, and started guiding him along his length. If there was one sure fire way to spoil a blowjob from Chrissy, that was it. Only with Marc, she didn’t protest. If anything, she got into the act even more.

“Suck that cock, baby. Take it deep.”

From my angle, and thanks to the way he held Chrissy’s hair out of her face, I could see everything—the way her lips stretched around the dark shaft, the way her cheeks sank with the power of her sucking, and most startling of all, the way she stared up at him as if in adoration, her eyes never wavering.

He yanked his cock free. Chrissy whined, reaching for him. “Not yet. I need to conserve, *mon chéri*.”

Chrissy challenged him. “Not man enough to get it back up?”

“Probably. But after three times earlier this afternoon, I want to make it special.”

Chrissy rose. “Aw, such a romantic.”

Marc pulled her close, his hand palming her ass again, squeezing it hard enough to draw a gasp. With her lips inches from his, he said, “Romance wasn’t what I was going for.”

They shared another hungry kiss, and again, I wondered how that act was so much harder to stomach. She’d just had the guy’s cock lodged in her throat, and it was a kiss that had me squirming.

He unfastened her strapless bra, mid-kiss, and picked her up and carried her to the bed. Chrissy was petite, but I could never manhandle her the way Marc did. It was like she weighed nothing.

He tossed her onto the mattress. She hit it with a cry. She looked up at Marc, fixated on his looming, ebony body as he stood over her. Did she

realize that she was spreading her legs for him, or was that purely subconscious?

“Did sucking my cock make you wet?”

Chrissy nodded.

“Show me.”

Her g-string hadn’t covered much anyway, so all she had to do was pull it aside. Her lips looked swollen, glistening with her excitement.

Marc looked down at her, wrapping a hand around his erection. “Touch yourself.”

Chrissy pushed a finger inside her pussy, spreading her legs wider.

“Two fingers.”

Chrissy obliged, pulling the g-string aside even more to accommodate the second digit. Her thumb circled her clit, exposed and ready to be touched.

“Tell me what you are thinking about,” Marc said.

“You.”

Jealousy tightened in my gut. They stared at one another, shutting everything else out. Shutting *me* out. I held my breath, loving every moment.

“Be more specific.” He stepped closer.

Chrissy removed her fingers from her pussy, reached out, and wrapped them around Marc’s dark cock. She rubbed her pussy juice into the dark shaft. “I want you to fuck me.”

My head felt hot. Things fluttered. I realized that I was rubbing myself through my tuxedo pants and stopped. I was too close. Too on edge. I didn’t want to come right then—not when things were just getting started.

“Say it again,” Marc said.

“I want you to fuck me.” She stroked his cock, but didn’t take her eyes off of his. “I want to feel this beautiful, black cock in my married, white pussy.”

Outside, I shuddered, nearly losing it. So the interracial thing *was* a turn on for her.

“Take off your panties.”

Chrissy shivered, releasing his shaft to once again lay back. With a quick lift of her hips, the g-string was a scrap of lace on the floor, and she was naked before another man except for her heels.

Marc licked his lips, stroking her nudity with his gaze. His chest rose and fell with each heavy breath, a lion surveying his prey.

It felt like a hand had reached inside my gut and made a fist. I sat at the edge of the chair, frozen, watching.

Marc took hold of his cock, sinking a knee onto the bed between her legs. Chrissy's breasts heaved with her rapid breathing. I didn't breathe at all. I had just about the perfect angle to see Marc position his cock against my wife's pussy. She spread her lips, encouraging him to take her.

And took her he did. He rose over her, sliding his hips home. His cock sank into her pussy.

"Yes!" Chrissy cried out as he penetrated her. She reached around, grabbing his buttocks to encourage him. "Ngh! You're so huge!"

I rose up, not quite to a stand—those windows were near mirrors, but they might still be able to detect movement outside—but enough to get a better view. The image of Chrissy's smooth, white pussy stretched around Marc's thick, black shaft burned into my brain. That she was shaved bald and he was manscaped to almost nothing made it even more obscene.

Then I realized that he wasn't wearing a condom. He was fucking her bare back, nothing but his cock in my wife's unprotected pussy. The revelation registered like a concussion, ringing harshly through my skull.

"Oh, fuck!" Chrissy moaned. "Oh, fuck me!"

"I can do that," Marc said. Climbing up onto the bed, he planted his legs wide and pulled her legs around his torso. Inverted, Chrissy looked up her body at him as he took control of her body. He held her by the ass and lower back, lifting her almost entirely off the mattress as he fucked her. That angle must have sent his cock along her g-spot. Chrissy went crazy.

The angle also gave me an even clearer view of the penetration. Her pussy stretched with each thrust. Each withdrawal was a reminder that his cock was unprotected.

"Your cunt feels so fucking good. You're so tight." Even unintended as it was, I felt the taunt like a physical blow.

Chrissy reached up her body, fingering her clit. She wasn't gentle with her self-pleasure, I was shocked to see, practically slapping her mound as he pounded her. Had they been like this all afternoon? Jesus.

"That's it, my little, white whore. You like this? You like my cock?"

"Yes."

"You want it harder?"

“Yes!”

He pulled out of her and ordered her to turn around. “On your knees, on the bed.”

She obeyed immediately, getting onto her hands and knees, her ass raised, facing away from him. They were in perfect profile for me—about as ideal an angle as I’d get to watch him mount her doggy style. Marc stepped up behind her, slapping his cock against her ass.

“Remember, it can go deep from this angle,” he said. *Remember...* God, they’d fucked like this already.

“Do it,” Chrissy said.

“What’s the magic word?”

“*Fucking* do it?”

Even I chuckled at that one, despite the charged atmosphere.

“Feisty,” he said. “I like that.” He dragged his cock down the crack of her ass, set it against her pussy, and buried the tip into her with a quick shove. Chrissy grunted, clenching her teeth as she took it.

“You asked for it hard,” Marc said, more explanation than apology. Chrissy just moaned in reply.

Here was my wife at her most vulnerable—most raw. Behind her was a man built for sex, who could keep a nymphomaniac like Brigitte satisfied, and my Chrissy was keeping up with him. He didn’t hold back, fucking her long and hard, pounding her in a way that I’d never dared. Her moans built with each thrust, louder and louder, rising to crescendo.

Before it came, Marc reached down and grabbed her by the arms, pulling her upper body off the bed. He held her by the elbows, forcing her back to arch and her body to remain upright, all the while driving into her over and over. Her cries bled into one another, continuous, guttural. Her ass and tits bounced with each forceful thrust, so hard that I thought he was going to break her.

Her orgasm broke first. Her body seized up. Her moan became a scream. “Yes! Come! Come inside me now!”

I hadn’t been watching Marc. His face was twisted up, pained, his teeth clenched. He’d reached his climax, too. He was filling my wife with his come.

Seeing this other man explode inside my wife was the single most horrifying, yet most intensely erotic event of my life up until that moment. My stomach roiled. I very nearly came without needing to touch myself.

Sinking back into the wicker chair, I felt like a bomb had leveled the city around me and somehow, I'd lived through it.

Inside, on the bed, Marc gently laid Chrissy on the bed. Their bodies glistened with sweat, turning their nudity into something out of a glossy men's magazine.

"Well, hello there." Brigitte's voice sounded out, and for one confusing moment, I wondered how she'd snuck through the room and back onto the balcony. "Looks like I arrived just in time."

Then I realized that she wasn't out here with me, but inside the room with Chrissy and Marc. Chrissy appeared too out of it to process Brigitte's arrival. Marc turned with a grin.

"Perfect timing," he said.

Brigitte crossed her arms across her chest and pushed the dress off her shoulders. A quick shimmy and it was a limp pool around her heels. I gasped. She wore nothing beneath her dress. Her nudity would never be anything short of breathtaking. I didn't know where to look. At her mammoth tits? At her hips, perfectly proportioned to her lean body? At her endless legs?

She stepped forward, meeting Marc halfway. They melted into a kiss. They looked good together—her creamy white skin was the perfect contrast to his dark ebony. Marc still towered over her even in heels, but even that felt well matched. He cupped her ass. She encircled his cock.

When they broke the kiss, she lifted his fingers to her lips and sucked. "Tasty. You left a treat for me?"

"I did."

Brigitte licked her lips, looking past her husband. Looking right at Chrissy. She gave Marc one last squeeze and walked to the bed.

My heart skipped a beat, but this was a completely different sensation from the conflicted excitement of her time with Marc. As I watched Brigitte kneel at the foot of the bed, I felt no jealousy. No anxiety. No gut-wrenching queasiness. Instead, I was on the edge of my seat, enthralled, my head buzzing.

This wasn't happening, and even if it did, it would end quickly. Chrissy had humored me a few times when I mentioned my typical male fantasy of two girls, but I never got the sense that it was more than just that—her humoring me.

Brigitte pulled Chrissy's legs open, spreading her thighs. Chrissy let it happen, still foggy from Marc's wild fuck. I swear Brigitte looked in my direction as she touched Chrissy's pussy, but she immediately refocused on my wife. Chrissy gasped, shifting into a more comfortable position, her eyes still closed. She didn't realize who was between her legs—she thought it was Marc, back for more.

I rose to my feet, part of me wanting a better view, part of me ready to intervene when she inevitably freaked out. Either way, I held my breath for her, bracing for that moment of revelation.

Brigitte dipped forward, her head disappearing between Chrissy's thighs. Despite standing, I couldn't see everything that happened—not through the curtain of blond hair. It wasn't necessary. Chrissy arched her back, splaying her legs more. She reached down, her fingers finding soft hair where she was expecting Marc's.

She stiffened with a gasp. Her eyes flew open. I took another step closer, ready to rush in there. To do what, I had no clue, but I was ready to do something.

Brigitte looked up at her, but didn't move away. Instead, she doubled down on the oral ministrations, adding her fingers to the mix.

Chrissy stared in horror for one tense moment. Then her eyes fluttered shut. Brigitte pressed her fingers deep, forcing a groan from Chrissy. She flopped back onto the mattress, the hands in Brigitte's hair encouraging the other woman rather than pushing her away. I couldn't believe it.

Marc rounded the bed, climbing up next to Chrissy. He palmed her breast, tugging at her nipple. She turned to face him, kissing him without pause. I could almost feel her need to reassure herself that she still liked guys.

Marc directed her further up the bed, allowing Brigitte to lay out on her stomach. Chrissy opened her legs as wide as they'd go, giving Brigitte full access. And full access did she take.

"This your first time with another woman?" Marc asked.

Chrissy nodded, her brow furrowed, her orgasm building.

"Bet you never thought it could be this good."

In response, Chrissy moaned, her body heaving backwards into the sheets. Marc dipped low, sucking on her hard nipples. He pulled back with a pop. "Pay close attention to what she does, baby. It's only fair to return the favor."

Chrissy gasped, but I couldn't tell if it was because of the oral sex, or at the prospect of going down on another woman.

Brigitte lifted her head, despite Chrissy's protests. "You're right. She tastes really good."

"Share it with her," Marc said.

"But she's so close." Brigitte's words were sincere, but her tone wasn't. She crawled over Chrissy. Marc sat back, watching Brigitte run kisses up Chrissy's naked body. She spent extra time kissing and licking my wife's nipples. I got a good view of that thanks to the way Chrissy laced her fingers through Brigitte's blond hair, pulling it out of her face.

"God, you do that so well," Chrissy sighed.

"You have such cute little tits," Brigitte said. She finished her ascent up my wife's body. "I can see why Marc has been talking about you nonstop since you met."

"Really?" Chrissy asked.

Brigitte kissed along Chrissy's clavicle, up her neck, right up to her ear. I had to strain to hear her response. "Baby, he's wanted to fuck you since he saw what you looked like on Facebook. I'm so glad you two decided to come to this wedding."

Before Chrissy could say another word—probably another *really*—Brigitte kissed her. It could have been anticlimactic after the oral sex, but it wasn't. Watching my wife open her mouth to another woman fulfilled one of my longest held fantasies. And oh my God, what a kiss! Chrissy didn't hold back. She wasn't shy. She kissed this other woman just as passionately as I'd watched her kiss Marc.

Brigitte broke the kiss at last, pulling back enough to look Chrissy in the eyes and stroke her damp hair. It was Chrissy who spoke first. "You're so beautiful. How could he ever want me?"

At first, I assumed that the *he* was Marc. But when she turned her head and looked towards the balcony, towards my hiding place beyond the sliding glass doors, I understood how charged her question was. I took another step closer, this time not to come to her aid, but to go in and reassure her.

Brigitte grasped the complexity, too. She brushed Chrissy's cheek. "You've got no idea how sexy you really are, do you?"

There they were, the two women in my life who'd captured my heart. The past meeting the present had never been so sexy.

Chrissy regarded Brigitte. “I know I’m not a cow, but I don’t have what you have. You’ve got the hair, the boobs, the legs—”

“And you’ve got Stephen. Did you know that I tried coming onto him—several times, even—but he turned me down every time?”

“Really?” Chrissy’s eyes went wide, once again looking in my direction.

This time, I acted, pushing the door open enough to step inside and lean against the frame.

“Really,” I said.

Looking at those two, layered on top of each other, soft curves and pale flesh, I had no regrets. Brigitte was a bombshell, a wet dream, but Chrissy was the one I’d want to go home with every time.

Brigitte looked from me to her and smiled. “I don’t get turned down very often, but now I understand.” She kissed Chrissy’s neck. “I’m just glad he gets off on sharing.”

Brigitte shifted up Chrissy’s body, straddling her waist. Marc moved into the void, his intimidating cock once again at full length. Brigitte looked back at him and nodded. “Other than fucking first timers, this is Marc’s favorite thing to do.”

Marc set his cock against Chrissy’s pussy. This time, though, I got to stare into Chrissy’s eyes as she did it. She offered a weak smile. I hoped mine was more reassuring. And then he was inside her, three strokes and he was balls deep. Chrissy’s eyes went soft as he split her.

Brigitte leaned down, kissing Chrissy’s neck. Their lips met again, the kiss loose and wild, broken up by Chrissy’s gasps and cries. Marc pulled out of her, shifted up, and buried his cock in Brigitte’s primed cunt.

She nuzzled her forehead against Chrissy’s, maintaining better composure than my wife as Marc accelerated into the fuck.

“Oh, I missed this!” Brigitte cried. “Don’t you love how big he is?”

“Yes,” Chrissy said.

Brigitte shifted higher, bringing a heavy tit to Chrissy’s mouth. My wife latched on, suckling the swollen nipple like she did this all the time. I shifted in the doorframe, not daring to touch my cock for fear of messing my pants.

Marc shifted back to Chrissy, taking her by surprise. Her moan emerged muffled around Brigitte’s tit.

I'd had some crazy dreams over the last few months, but this surpassed them all. Best part? Chrissy was here, and we did this together.

"That's it," Brigitte said. She raked her fingers through Chrissy's hair, shoving more tit flesh into her mouth. "Just like that with your tongue. Flick it. Faster. Fast—er!"

Marc pulled out of my wife, cock glistening and unsheathed for a moment. Grabbing Brigitte's hips, he pushed her pussy against Chrissy's, forcing them to mash mounds. Both women cried out, my wife having to tear her lips away from Brigitte's nipple. Marc positioned himself against Brigitte's cunt and slammed home. The trio moaned as one—a tangle of dark and light skin, glistening with perspiration.

Chrissy went after Brigitte's other breast, her mouth open enough that I could see the rapid flickering of her tongue on the other woman's hard nipple.

Marc switched again, easily sliding into Chrissy. Back and forth he went, faster and faster, as the women ground their pussies together. Clit on clit, Marc's balls swinging heavily against both of them, the debauchery was nearly complete.

Brigitte threw her head back, moaning, close to orgasm. Chrissy grabbed her head and yanked her into a deep, torrid kiss.

I thought about joining them, but there was nowhere for me to join. So I stayed put, watching, not wanting to upset the balance. And really, watching was what I preferred. It had been that way with Brigitte back in the day, and it was like that now.

Chrissy broke the kiss as her orgasm tore through her. Brigitte was there, too, pressing her body against Chrissy's, tits compressing, pussies grinding. Marc pushed Brigitte over the edge, then switched to my wife with swift, rapid pumps.

Chrissy joined Brigitte a moment later, filling the room with her screams. The cries rushed through me like something physical. My knees went weak. My chest tightened. My balls nearly seized up.

I turned away, looking behind me, where the moon rose high and pale over the dark ocean. I took a couple deep, steadying breaths to regain composure. Slowly, I stepped back from the imminent climax.

Brigitte had climbed off of Chrissy, who was breathing heavily, eyes closed, hands in her hair. Marc had pulled out, still frighteningly erect. He stood back, shoulders hunched, his chest rising and falling.

When he spoke, his voice took on a gravelly quality. “Stephen, want to watch your wife eat pussy?”

The question was packed with so much meaning. He was asserting his dominance. Chrissy wasn’t his to give, yet that was exactly what he was doing.

She looked at me, her eyelids heavy. She’d given up control as much as I had.

I nodded. To her. To Marc. To myself.

I’m not sure that Marc would have stopped even if I hadn’t given the nod, but getting it, he acted swiftly.

He nodded at Brigitte, who smiled like it was her birthday. She crawled up to the head of the bed. Leaning back into the stacked pillows, she spread her legs wide. She was all long limbs and big boobs. She was a goddess, and she knew it. Yet it was the smaller woman crawling between her legs that I remained fixated on.

“Look at that pretty pussy,” Marc said behind my wife. He touched her ass, reassuring her that she had a nice, strong male close by. “Bare, just like you. Naughty, don’t you think?”

Chrissy hesitated. She stared at Brigitte’s sex, then up at Brigitte.

“Touch it first,” Marc said. “Tease this slut.”

Brigitte gave her the slightest of nods. Chrissy reached out, touching another woman’s pussy for the first time in her life. Her touch was tentative, exploratory. This was the figurative toe in the pool. Too warm? Too cold?

She first traced Brigitte’s mound, where I’d remembered she’d once kept a landing strip. Slipping it lower, touching the blonde’s clit. Brigitte gasped. Encouraged, Chrissy did it again.

“Just like that,” Marc said. “Touch her like you touch yourself.”

Chrissy thumbed Brigitte’s clit a little harder, a little more fervently. Brigitte moaned.

“Now taste her. Do what you’re doing with your fingers with your tongue.”

Chrissy dipped in, her hair dropping over her face. Brigitte moaned harder, arching her back, her eyes fluttering shut. Marc pulled Chrissy’s hair back, giving us both a clear view of the action. She was doing it. Chrissy was eating another woman’s pussy!

Marc moved in behind her, cock in hand. She may be having her first bisexual experience, but he was there to remind her that she still needed

guys.

“That’s it, Chris. Eat that cunt. Love it.”

Chrissy groaned as she felt him press against her pussy, but didn’t stop licking. He eased into her. Still, she kept her tongue flashing and slashing across Brigitte’s sex. This may have been her first time, but whatever she was doing was good enough for Brigitte. The blonde moaned louder, filling her hands with her tits and squeezing her nipples.

“Oh, yes, she’s good at this,” Brigitte moaned. “That’s it, baby. Right there. Yes!”

Satisfied that his direction had been followed, Marc started fucking Chrissy harder. The thrusts, in turn, set the pace for Chrissy’s pussy eating. She had to fight through the moans, at the shuddering thrusts. The threesome fell into a frantic, yet harmonious cadence. Marc, their brawny maestro, challenging them to work harder, wilder.

“Her moans feel so good,” Brigitte said.

“Then let’s make her moan some more,” Marc said. Without warning, he pressed his thumb against Chrissy’s anus.

Chrissy practically screamed. The vibrations set Brigitte off. Tugging hard on her nipples as she arched back, she released a throaty moan that I hadn’t heard in over fifteen years. I missed that sound, but not as much as the sound of Chrissy’s orgasm.

A moment later, I was treated to it. Marc didn’t let up the pressure on her asshole, keeping his thumb in place as he rammed his thick black cock home.

“I’m close, baby,” Marc said. “You want to feel it inside you?”

Chrissy didn’t respond. She couldn’t. Not in words. Instead, she pulled off of Brigitte’s pussy, her face squeezed into a grimace, and Chrissy erupted.

“Yes. Yes, babe!” Marc pumped her one last time before burying his cock to the hilt. He grunted, his powerful body shuddering. Chrissy screamed.

I don’t know how I didn’t come. I actually realized I’d started touching myself through my pants a second before my balls seized. How I held off, yet still looked at the stretch of sweaty flesh before me, I don’t know. I sure as hell wasn’t looking away, though, premature ejaculation or not. Who knows when the next time is I’ll ever see Chrissy splayed out between two new lovers.

The trio was coated in sweat—not just a sheen, but glistening beads of perspiration, like they’d just climbed from the pool. Chrissy rested with her knees under her, her cheek pressed to Brigitte’s thigh. She still wore her heels, which was somehow sexier than her being nude. Brigitte did too, I noticed a moment later.

Chrissy’s eyes fluttered open, seeking me out by the door. The simple gesture was exactly what I needed. I’d been a spectator rather than a participant, but that look included me.

I could have joined them. Here’s where things could have easily escalated. We’d moved from voyeurism and interracial sex to threesomes and bisexual explorations. Why not add an orgy on top? Clearly Marc and Brigitte were game for it.

But it wasn’t our fantasy. While it would have been fun, it would have complicated an already complex situation.

“I’ll see you back in the room,” I said. My voice didn’t shake. That was surprising. “Have fun, and thanks for the show.”

Chrissy watched me go with a puzzled look on her face, trying to make sense of the situation. I gave her a smile that I hoped conveyed how much I loved her, and how much I wanted her to enjoy herself. Inside, though, I had to force one foot in front of the other toward the door.

Chapter 14:

Reclamation

Once outside the room, I somehow managed to feel completely free and completely terrified all at once. I'd just left my wife naked in a room with a couple of sexual predators. When would I get her back, and in what shape?

But I pushed on, striding down the hall, taking the stairs down to my floor.

I wanted Chrissy to be right behind me. I wanted her to call out for me to slow down, to reassure me that we were still good. But the "damage," if you wanted to call it that, was already done. She'd fucked Marc. She'd fucked Brigitte. She'd fucked Cornell in the bathroom. If she chose to spend the rest of the night up in that room, what difference did it really make?

I entered my room alone. The bed was still crisply made. The doors to the balcony were still open from when I'd rushed inside after my nap. It felt empty. *I* felt empty.

It made a difference. I couldn't fool myself—if she stayed up there, it would be a long night. Still, this crazy, disturbing part of me was turned on by the idea.

I poured myself a glass of water and moved out onto the balcony, surveying the Virgin Islands nightscape for perhaps the last time. Most people would smell that salty air, hear the hiss of the surface, and see the moon reflected in the dark waters of the ocean, and think of paradise. Three days earlier, I was one of them. Now, this scene would forever be coupled with the thick, queasy excitement that came as I watched another man fuck my wife.

"Beautiful, don't ya think?"

I had never been so happy to hear Chrissy's voice. I turned, and there she was, standing in the door frame, her little body buried in a bulky hotel robe. She glowed, and not just in a post-sex way. She'd been in my life for so long, it was easy to take her for granted. Tonight was a reminder of how lucky I was to have her in my life—to live with her, to have these adventures with her, to grow with her.

I answered her earlier question. “Never seen anything quite like it.”

Chrissy slipped out of her robe, her pale body naked in the moonlight. How could any woman ever compete with such beauty? How could I have thought Brigitte came close?

We crashed against one another, mouths smothering, tongues tangling. She tugged at my clothes, popping the tuxedo studs.

“I need you.” Chrissy spoke the words, but the feeling was mutual. Together, we yanked my pants down, kicking them off, before resuming the frantic kiss.

She tugged at my cock. I grabbed her ass and pulled her over to the wicker bench—an exact copy of the one on Brigitte’s balcony.

She placed my cock against her pussy. “Do it.”

I did, pressing into her. She felt different. I could immediately tell the difference. She was wetter than ever. There was less resistance. She’d been stretched by a day of fucking Marc’s black, wonder cock.

And yet she was Chrissy, without a doubt. There was no one who felt quite like her. No one who smelled like her. Who tasted like her. Who sounded like her. The woman who wrapped her legs around my back and urged me to fuck her was my dream girl. How could I have thought otherwise?

“I don’t know what’s going on in your head,” she said, “but you need to stop thinking and start fucking.”

“Yes, ma’am.”

“Don’t *ma’am* ME—”

In one quick thrust, I was balls deep in her. I’d been tentative at first, worried that I’d hurt her. She didn’t need that now, and I was done being gentle.

“You feel so good, baby,” she said as our bodies slapped. “I love how you feel inside me.”

She’d spent all day fucking another man—a man with a cock considerably larger than my own. That was bound to stir up some insecurities. Was she comparing? How could she not be?

Rather than give in to them, though, I rolled up my sleeves—figuratively—and fucked her harder. I couldn’t compare to Marc’s size, but I knew my wife better than any man in the world. In that moment, she needed to be reminded of that.

She ran her nails down my back, pulling me closer. “Harder,” she cried. “I need you, baby. I *need* you.”

I gritted my teeth, her demand fueling my thrusts. Still she wanted more. Heels on my ass, hands on my shoulders, she pulled me into her, crushing me to her body. The wicker bench groaned and protested beneath us. She urged me faster.

“I wish you could crawl beneath my skin, baby. I wish you could be closer. Closer. Ah, closer!”

Her heels bit into my lower back. She craned back, eyes squeezed shut, teeth clenched. I took long, forceful stabs into her. My orgasm swelled around me, a roar in my ears. The bench snapped again. This time, it didn’t hold. Chrissy opened her mouth, screaming my name, screaming her orgasm, screaming in surprise as the bench collapsed beneath us.

We landed in a pile of sweaty flesh, sharing a laugh that grew until my sides hurt. “Think that this counts as an incidental?” Chrissy said, brushing her hair from her face.

I said, “This vacation is turning out to be expensive.”

“We’ve never broken furniture before. I say it’s totally worth it.” She reached between my legs, encircling my cock. “You’re still hard.”

“That’s not a problem, is it?”

“I’d say it’s a good problem to have. Move to the bed?”

“Sounds a lot more comfortable.”

She stood, offering me her hand. “So you fucked him here, earlier?” I asked.

“Yeah. After the snorkeling trip. Why?”

“I don’t know. I found a condom wrapper.” I pulled the sheets aside and climbed onto the bed. She straddled me, taking things slower, now that the adrenaline was gone. As I watched my cock sink into her pussy, I could remember Marc’s doing the same. “You didn’t use one just now.”

“Yeah. We talked about it. He’s safe.”

“He’s a swinger,” I said. I wasn’t mad, but it didn’t seem like Chrissy to be so irresponsible.

“Exactly why I know he’s safe. They get their tests done every month. He’s clean. He showed me.”

“And you just couldn’t resist it, could you?” I teased. “You wanted to feel that black cock bareback.”

Chrissy blushed. “And I bet it turns you on, doesn’t it?”

“I’m weird, aren’t I?”

“You’re amazing, Stephen. I’ll take you as you are, weird or not.” She leaned down, kissing me softly. We made love quietly after that, enjoying one another’s bodies with the sound of the ocean setting the mood. It was different than the frantic fuck outside, but just as good.

At last, Chrissy spoke. “So you really didn’t have sex with her? After all those dreams?”

“I almost did. I came so close.”

“So why didn’t you?” Chrissy asked.

“She wasn’t what I wanted. Not really. Not in the end. You’re my fantasy, not her.” I stared at her, wanting her to understand the importance. “But apparently that’s where we’re different. That was pretty awesome, watching you two.”

Chrissy blushed. “Yeah. It was pretty awesome.”

“I had no idea that you had that fantasy. You always rolled your eyes whenever I mentioned it.”

“That’s because I didn’t know about it, either,” Chrissy said. “It just kind of happened, and I went with it.”

“Think you’ll *just go with it* again?” I said.

“Maybe.”

That was hot.

“I like that you did that. That you can still surprise me.” I thought about Cornell and her. Was that just another way she’d surprised me, or had she gone too far? I was done bottling things up and keeping them to myself. If we were going to do this thing, we were going to talk about *everything*. “I know about you and Cornell.”

Chrissy slowed her hips, staring at me without speaking. My heart fluttered. Had she intended to keep that a secret? The possibility turned my insides into mush.

“Tell me more about that,” she said at last.

“First of all, I’m not upset. Not really. When I realized that it was you and Cornell during the reception, in the bathroom, a...a part of me actually got excited.” My heart raced. I rushed on. “But we didn’t talk about Cornell, and after everything that happened between me and Brigitte, and how it ended...”

“It upset you,” Chrissy said.

“More like it disappointed me, I suppose.”

Chrissy touched my face. “After all of our talk about trusting one another, I should have known that sneaking off with the groom to give him an extra special wedding gift was too much.”

Put like that, I hardened inside of her, despite everything. “Yeah, it was too much. Despite...that. I don’t know, I’m messed up.”

Chrissy giggled. “Nah. Just complicated. And sometimes, our bodies want things that we know are wrong. It’s human nature.”

“Is that what happened to you?” I asked, even though I didn’t want to.

“With Marc, yes. With Brigitte, absolutely.” She brushed my forehead, running her fingers through my thinning hair. She looked so pleased with herself. “But not with Cornell. You know, that wasn’t me in the bathroom with Cornell, right?”

“What? No...what?”

Chrissy laughed. She rose up, resting her hands on my chest, and resumed the lazy love making. “You missed quite a scandal, actually. Cornell was definitely getting it on in the bathroom, but not with me.”

“Who?”

Chrissy paused for dramatic effect. “Harry.”

“What?” I swear I’d heard her say *Harry*.

“Harry Whitehurst, the Best Man.”

“But it sounded like he was having...” My eyes went wide. “No fucking way.”

“Yes *fucking* way.” Chrissy giggled. “Liz had no idea he swung both ways. She was...pretty upset, actually.”

I thought of the phone call Brigitte had received, and the way she’d rushed off. Brigitte wouldn’t have left such a perfect setup unless it was serious.

So Chrissy hadn’t fucked Cornell. Relief rushed through me, pure and unadulterated. I didn’t feel the disappointment that I had when Chrissy made me think she’d kissed Marc, way back when we first got here. No, this was confirmation that Chrissy really did get me, after all.

“So what happened?”

“I don’t really know. Brigitte came down and tried calming her. I think I heard her tell Liz that there were definitely benefits to the new...discovery.”

“You mean Marc is—”

“No. I asked him about it. He said as politely as possible that he *was all about the pussy*. That might even be a direct quote.”

“You’re not expecting that from me, are you?”

“Well, you did just watch me go down on Brigitte...”

My face went white. My cock wilted inside of her. Chrissy burst out laughing.

“Don’t worry, I don’t expect you to do anything that you’re not comfortable with.” She kissed my chest, squeezing my cock with her pussy. “Although sometimes, it’s those uncomfortable things that are the most exciting.”

We were no longer talking about exploring me and other guys.

“You know what I find interesting about the whole bathroom mix up? That could have been game over for you. For many guys, it would have been. As soon as Marc and I entered the room, you could have stormed in there and ended it. But you didn’t, and only brought it up now.” My face went hot. She was right. She added, “You even got a little turned on, thinking about it. Even now.”

“That was a mistake.”

“Perception is reality, and for a second there, your perception of me was pretty out there.”

“Would it make any difference if I told you how relieved I am that it wasn’t you?” That was the honest truth.

“Oh, I already know that. But still, a small part of you got turned on by it.” She undulated on me in quiet contemplation. “So when we get back home, and some guy hits on me while we’re out, I can drag him into the nearest bathroom and fuck his brains out?”

“Chris...”

“Or maybe the next time Tom Park asks me to dinner, I tell him yes?”

“Your client?”

“Slender, handsome Asian guy?” Chrissy said with a lazy smile. She fucked me more enthusiastically. “That’s the one.”

“He’s asked you to dinner?”

“It’s all very professional, but yes. Dinner meetings. But we’re all adults here. We know what he really wants.” We were adults, but this was the first time I’d seen my wife come off as so...worldly.

“You’ve never accepted?”

“Until now, I never knew that I could.”

My stomach tightened. Chrissy bent down, touching my face. She looked me right in the eyes. “Now I know better.”

I came. I didn’t mean to—especially not at that moment, when Chrissy would read all kinds of things into it—but I came hard.

Chrissy stilled her hips as I filled her. She was multi-orgasmic, but today had already pushed her to her limits. She pulled me to her lips, our kiss passionate and loving and totally amazing.

When I was spent, I was *spent*. I had nothing left to give. Chrissy relaxed where she was, draped over me, our sweat cooling. The last thing I thought before drifting asleep was that there was nowhere I’d rather be.

*

I woke in the morning to an empty bed. I panicked. Had Chrissy slipped out in the morning to rejoin Marc and Brigitte for one final round? My cock hardened. It hurt, sore from yesterday.

Then I heard the shower running. She was still here. Relief flooded through me. Had this become the norm, for my imagination to jump to the most scandalous of conclusions?

I was sore all over, and I’d mostly been an observer. Chrissy must have felt broken. I crawled out of bed.

In the bathroom, I heard Chrissy humming. I pushed the door open, steam billowing around me. The shower door was fogged up, but I could just make out the shape of Chrissy’s body. I could tell she was just scrubbing her legs—nothing overtly sexual—but it was still sexy to see her move under the spray.

“Stephen, is that you? I don’t have my contacts in.”

“Want me to be someone else?”

She slid the door open, inviting me in. “Today? No.”

We didn’t make love in the shower, although we did spend a lot of time making out, and I don’t think I’ve ever been scrubbed so clean in a while.

“I think I’m going to keep it like this,” Chrissy said, touching her bare mound. “Call it my souvenir from the Virgin Islands.”

“Which were anything but *virgin*,” I added.

“Ba dump bump,” she said. “Was wondering when you’d make that joke.”

“Pretty predictable, huh?”

Chrissy giggled. “One thing this weekend taught me—you’re definitely not predictable.” She hugged me. “And I love it.”

After the shower, we had a late breakfast in the resort restaurant—which was once again a restaurant. Neither Brigitte, Marc, or the newlyweds were present, but we ran into Colette, who filled us in on the night before.

Just as Chrissy had said, Liz caught Cornell in the bathroom with the Best Man. There was a scene. Brigitte arrived and smoothed things over. It was rumored that Harry joined the married couple in the honeymoon suite, but no one had seen any of them since last night.

“How about you two?” Colette asked. “You guys disappeared early, too.”

Colette was digging. Had she seen Chrissy leave with Marc?

“Let’s just say we’re going to miss the balconies,” Chrissy said.

“Great view,” I added.

Chrissy choked back her giggle.

Colette glanced between us, then shrugged. “Well, it was nice meeting you. Have a safe flight.”

As we checked out—and settled the bill for the broken furniture—we ran into Brigitte and Marc. Brigitte looked as stunning as ever in a short sundress and heels, her blond hair perfectly wind blown.

“Headed home?” Brigitte said.

Chrissy looked at me meaningfully. “We are.”

Brigitte hugged Chrissy first. “It was *so* nice to meet you. I’m happy that Stevie met such an awesome chick.”

I held out my hand to Marc. The man had rocked my wife’s world yesterday, it seemed the least I could do. He took it, shaking it a little too firmly, then grinned. “She’s definitely awesome, my man. Thanks for sharing.”

“Wasn’t just my decision,” I said.

“Oh, I know. Don’t worry.” My stomach squirmed. He hugged Chrissy, kissing her on either cheek. “So Paris? What do you say?”

Chrissy blushed. “Only if Stephen comes. We’re a team.”

Marc looked at me. “That could be arranged.”

“Marc, stop messing with him,” Brigitte said. She took me into her arms, squeezing me tight. She smelled good, felt great—she was exactly the

woman I expected her to grow into. Yet she was no longer my dream. “It was good to see you, Stephen. Let’s not let another eighteen years go by next time.”

“I’ll follow you on Facebook.”

Brigitte laughed. “Okay. See you around.”

And with that, we boarded a taxi, boarded a plane, and returned to our normal life.

Epilogue

My client visit had gone exceptionally well. They were so happy with our product that I was able to get an earlier flight home. I was expecting to have to stay the night again, alone in a hotel room in some strange city, miles from Chrissy. I hated the thought, so I happily paid the premium to switch flights.

The months after Liz's wedding had been amazing for us. Liz and Cornell might have been the newlyweds, but Chrissy and I were acting like we'd just tied the knot. In fact, I don't think that the sex was as good back when we did get married. We may have fucked a lot, but we didn't understand one another like we did now.

I didn't call home to tell Chris that I was on my way. I sort of didn't have time, between packing, taxiing, and running for my terminal, but mostly I liked the idea of surprising her.

It was pushing ten at night by the time the airport shuttle pulled up outside my home.

The lights were on, I was surprised to see. Even on a Friday night, at this hour the kids were usually asleep and Chrissy was up in bed, struggling to read her Kindle.

I entered the house. I knew something was up as soon as I saw that while the lights were turned down low, they weren't off. I walked down the hall, unwilling to believe the situation, despite the way my heart climbed up my throat.

In the living room, on the coffee table, were two empty glasses of wine. I gasped, but before I could move over to them and investigate, I heard it—heard *her*.

“Ah!”

It was muffled, but unmistakable—Chrissy's moan from upstairs. It raised the hair on the back of my neck. It raised my cock, too. I crept up the stairs, an intruder in my own home. Her moans grew louder. They were definitely in our bedroom—*they*. Chrissy could be efficient, but she wasn't one to double fist glasses of wine alone.

“Tell me what you want.” A man's voice. Any hope that she was just vigorously playing with herself vanished.

“You.” Chrissy’s voice was tight.

“To what?”

“To...to fuck me.”

“Try again.”

“I want you to fuck me with that beautiful cock.” Chrissy’s whine blurred into a rising moan, growing louder and louder. I could hear their skin slapping. I felt so queasy, yet so turned on.

The door opened silently, and there they were. Chrissy was on her back, her legs wrapped around an Asian guy, cut like Bruce Lee. He fucked her roughly, pile-driving his hips into her. She looked so good like that. So insatiable.

As if detecting me, she opened her eyes as I stepped inside the room. There was no shock in her face. No surprise or shame. She just smiled at me, languid and sweet. *Welcome home*, she seemed to say. She reached out her hand, inviting me to join.

I mouthed, *I love you*, then waited for the inevitable.

RAH RAH RAH! screamed the alarm.

I turned it off and smiled, looking at the ceiling. Chrissy stirred beside me, rolling over to drape an arm over me.

Since the Virgin Islands, I’d mostly stopped dreaming of Brigitte. Chrissy had taken her place as my fantasy girl.

“I had that dream again,” I said.

“The early flight home?” she asked. We didn’t keep anything from each other anymore.

“Yeah.”

“It’s pretty silly, you know. You don’t even travel.”

“Details, details.”

“Also, there’s no way I’d ever sleep with someone behind your back. After Cornell, you should know that.”

“I do.” I pulled her close and kissed her. “And seriously, don’t read too much into it. It’s just a dream.”

“Of course, of course.” She laid her head on my chest. I stroked her hair. It was bliss.

After a moment, Chrissy said, “Hey, I may be home a little late tonight. Tom Park asked if I wanted to grab a drink with him. I told him yes.”

“Are you serious?”

“I can hear your heart race. Glad I can still do that to you.”

“Hey, you’re the woman of my dreams. Literally. Of course you can.” She turned to look up at me, her smile as sweet and languid as it had been in my dream. I said, “But seriously, did he ask you out?”

“I don’t know. Maybe it was just a dream.” She kissed my chest. “I’ll text you later today when I know for sure.”

Finis

Acknowledgements

I wish that I could claim that *Dreaming of Another* was emerged after waking, Samuel Taylor Coleridge style, inspired by a dream itself and written in a day. Alas, while there may have been an initial dream, no opium was involved, nor was this novel composed in a single sitting. Despite the lack of psychedelics, though, this one was fun to write. I had a premise and a vague notion of what I was building towards, but the rest just wrote itself.

Well, that's not being fair. I have plenty of people who helped along the way, so let's get to the thanking!

This time, I'll start with the most important people: you! Yes, you, holding your Kindle (or iPad, or, gasp, book!). I write for my own pleasure, but I won't lie, it's nice to know that you guys like my books enough to keep coming back. So thank you. Seriously, you're awesome.

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And...let's see...let's thank...E.L. James. Why not. I've not even read *50 Shades of Grey*, but whatever. She helped bring erotica into the mainstream, and all of us should be thanking her for that, regardless of what you think. And who know, maybe I'll even see that movie one of these days.

Thanks again for reading, and don't forget to leave a review wherever you bought it (unless you hated it, then you can just object in silence).

*Weave a circle round him thrice,
And close your eyes with holy dread
For he on honey-dew hath fed,
And drunk the milk of Paradise.*

About the Author

I'm just a guy who writes what I like to read: steamy, explicit erotica that's just crazy enough to be true. I write romantic erotica. I write about characters that I like, and endings that feel natural. I write stories where husbands watch their wives get naughty. I write about MILFs and erotic games and loss of innocence. I believe in a world where men read and appreciate erotica, and hope to contribute to it word by word.

Find me online at www.kennywriter.com, or follow me on Twitter at [@kennywriter](https://twitter.com/kennywriter). I also operate eroticaformen.com, which may or may not look like crap right now.

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